



THE PHAISTOS DISC:
**A LUWIAN LETTER TO
NESTOR**



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Fred Woudhuizen
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PREFACE*

Fred Woudhuizen

A treatment of the text on the Disc of Phaistos is nowadays considered beyond the confines of scientific research: whatever one's approach, it simply cannot be taken seriously. This suspicious attitude no doubt results from the flood of contributions by would-be decipherers, who all claim to have found the key to unravelling the contents of the text – with widely diverging results, to say the least. It surely poses an Herculean task to try to refute them one by one on the basis of scientific criteria. Nevertheless, it cannot be denied that the disc itself came to light as a result of scientific activity, *in casu* the excavations of the palace of Phaistos by the Italian School at the beginning of the previous century, and that for this very reason it forms an object for scientific debate.

From a methodological point of view, there are only three possible lines of approach: the hieroglyphic script on the disc is related to one of the two comparable forms of writing in the eastern Mediterranean region, Egyptian Hieroglyphic to the south of Crete (1) or Luwian Hieroglyphic to the north of Crete (2), or it constitutes an insular development devised in splendid isolation (3). Scholars working along the last mentioned line of approach often try to establish correspondences between signs from the disc and possible counterparts in the Cretan Linear scripts of class A and B. When putting either of these three lines of approach into practice for experimental purposes, it soon turns out that similarities with the Cretan Linear A and B scripts and with Egyptian Hieroglyphic are unproductive, whereas those with Luwian Hieroglyphic are prolific.

We – the members of the Alverna Research Group – challenge the reader to go to the library, take a copy of Emmanuel Laroche's *Les hiéroglyphes hittites* (Paris 1960) from the shelf, and start reading for her- or himself. As Frans van 't Hek and André Beemsterboer – two absolute laymen in the field of Luwian hieroglyphics – experienced (when following in the tracks of their teacher, who had identified the glyphs D 11 and D 39 on the disc as the Luwian hieroglyphic symbols of winged sun-disc and lightning, respectively)¹ in the beginning of the eighties of the last century, the first word which turns up is B 11 *á-sú-wi-x*, which easily emends to *á-sú-wi-ya* "Assuwian" – as we will see a crucial word for historic interpretation. Working along this line of approach, everybody can decipher the text on the Disc of Phaistos and soon will be confronted, like we were, with a fascinating letter to Nestor – king of Pylos according to Homer.

In the following collection of papers, then, the Disc of Phaistos is subjected to a highly detailed study, starting, after a short general introduction, with a discussion of the technical aspects by Winfried Achterberg. On the basis of a careful

* As a team the Alverna Research Group is very obliged to Roald Docter and Frits Waanders for making substantial improvements in the manuscript. My personal thanks are due to Wim van Binsbergen for a grant from the Erasmus University of Rotterdam, which facilitated my contribution to the present project.

¹ Best 1982, 56.

epigraphical examination, it can be established what the direction of writing is and which of the two sides of the disc was imprinted first. Accordingly, all interpretations of its text which read from the inside to the outside or start at the B side can be discarded. Next, Jan Best makes an attempt to determine the date of the Disc of Phaistos on the basis of its archaeological find-context. One thing he makes clear is that the date of c. 1800–1600 BC to which the disc is traditionally assigned, happens to be entirely unfounded. Following this chapter, Kees Enzler meticulously analyzes the individual signs and, when possible, compares each of these with a Luwian hieroglyphic counterpart. All this results in a transcription of the text, which Lia Rietveld subsequently interprets word by word with the help of Luwian morphology and grammar. The same author systemizes her findings in a contribution on the language of the disc, which, though basically Luwian, shows typically Cretan features, but also Hittitisms and, as current in cuneiform Luwian and Hittite documents, Akkadisms. In line with the identification of the language as a form of Luwian, Fred Woudhuizen demonstrates that both the script and the language are closest to Late Bronze Age Luwian Hieroglyphic – a conclusion which lies at hand considering the correct dating of the Disc of Phaistos to the Late Bronze Age as established earlier. Finally, the last mentioned author reconstructs the historical background of our letter to Nestor as far as this can be distilled from Egyptian and Hittite sources.

According to some scholars, the Luwian reading of the Disc of Phaistos as presented here is ‘dubious’.² If it all boils down to the phantasy of a small group of people, the least that can be said is that their phantasy is highly detailed in every respect: archaeologically, epigraphically, linguistically, and historically. Of course, there are some who consider the Disc of Phaistos a forgery after all. The same scholars probably will apply the same verdict to the recently discovered Disc of Vladikavkaz (see Appendix III), which presents us with an only fragmentarily preserved, provisional draft of the text written by hand by the scribe before he set out printing the official version. Focussed on the technical aspects, Winfried Achterberg drew our attention to the fact that there is a stroke in the section of the Disc of Vladikavkaz corresponding to A 3 on the Disc of Phaistos, which is characterized on the same spot by what appeared to be an incidental scratch – clearly distinct from the ‘thorn’ D 46. In fact, however, the Disc of Vladikavkaz proves beyond doubt that the first mention of Nestor in the letter is singled out as such by the determinative of a personal name (in Luwian Hieroglyphic: Laroche 1960, sign no. 383, 1) – an identification first made by Jan Best in our Alverna Research Group meeting of November 14, 2002! Every author who will continue to qualify the Luwian reading of the Phaistos Disc as ‘dubious’ will have to come to terms with this kind of details.

² Cline 1996, 150, note 67.

1. INTRODUCTION

Winfried Achterberg

Before the Greeks settled down in Crete there was an era of high civilisation, which for lack of a proper name we call the 'Minoan' civilisation after king Minos, who would have ruled then. 'Minos' for that matter is more likely the title rather than the name of the king(s).³ In all probability this civilisation became prosperous by trade; Crete was situated on the intersection of many trade routes: possibly copper from Cyprus, amber all the way from Scandinavia, tin out of the ore mountains in Bohemia and Cornwall, and gold and ivory from Egypt.⁴ Copper and tin are the basic requirements for bronze, the metallic alloy that replaced that of copper and arsenic in the Middle East c. 2000 BC.

Arthur Evans divided the Cretan Bronze Age in three stages,⁵ and each one of them into three parts: Early Minoan (I: 2500–2100 BC, II: 2100–2000 BC, III: 2000–1950 BC), Middle Minoan (I: 1950–1800 BC, II: 1800–1600 BC, III: 1600–1550 BC) and Late Minoan (I: 1550–1450 BC, II: 1450–1300 BC, III: 1300–1100 BC). This classification was based on an analysis of pottery and not on historical data.

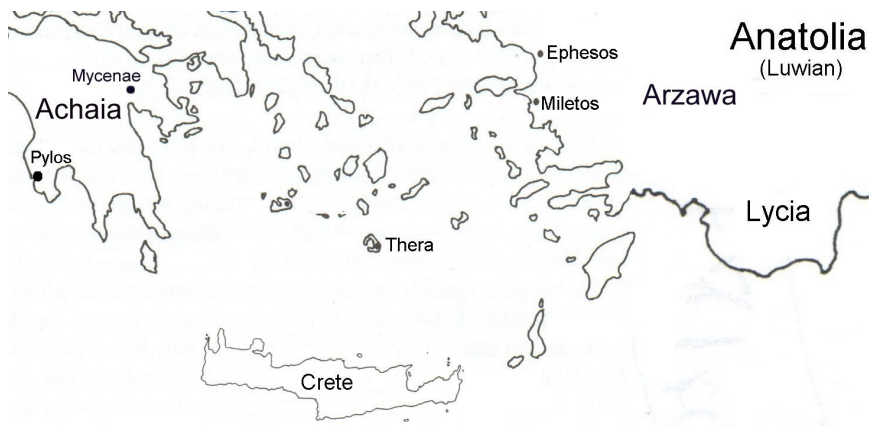


Fig. 1. Crete and its surroundings.

Nicolas Platon used in his publications another division,⁶ based on the existence of the large palaces so characteristic of this civilisation: Prepalatial

³ Mellersh 1967, 9.

⁴ Mellersh 1967, 11; Papapostolou 1981, 13.

⁵ Evans 1906.

⁶ Platon 1961, 127 ff.

(2600–1900 BC), Protopalatial (Old Palace, 1900–1720 BC), Neopalatial (New Palace, 1720–1470 BC) and Postpalatial (1470–1050 BC).

However, the most used division is that of Warren and Hankey:⁷

– EM (Early Minoan) I	3650 / 3500	– 3000 / 2900
– EM II	2900	– 2300 / 2150
– EM III	2300 / 2150	– 2160 / 2025
– MM (Middle Minoan) I A	2160 / 1979	– 20th cent.
– MM IB	19th cent.	
– MM II	19th cent.	– 1700 / 1650
– MM IIIA	1700 / 1650	– 1640 / 1630
– MM IIIB	1640 / 1630	– 1600
– MM IIIB / LM IA		– 1600
– LM (Late Minoan) IA	1600 / 1580	– ±1480
– LM IB	±1480	– 1425
– LM II	1425	– 1390
– LM IIIA1	1390	– 1370 / 1360
– LM IIIA2	1370 / 1360	– 1340 / 1330
– LM IIIB	1340 / 1330	– ±1190
– LM IIIC	±1190	– ±1070
– Subminoan	±1070	– after 1015

Around 2000 BC the first kingdoms and the first palaces came into being in Malia, Knossos and Phaistos. These palaces were the economical, political, artistical and religious centres on the island, which was playing an important role in the trade of that time: products of the Minoan civilisation could be found far outside Crete. The palaces themselves were technically very sophisticated with among others an extensive waterworks and sewage disposal system. Around 1700 BC the palaces were suddenly destroyed, probably by an earthquake, for no domination of another people followed.⁸

On the ruins of the demolished palaces new ones were built, even more impressive and luxurious than their predecessors. A fourth one was erected at Kato Zakro and the hey-day of the Minoans had apparently dawned. Everywhere on the island settlements arose, like Hagia Triada in the neighbourhood of Phaistos. Seals and tablets with Linear A inscriptions were used in most of the towns and indicate – as can be deduced from the aforementioned products – a uniform trade system.

The end comes suddenly and wholesale. All palaces and settlements are destroyed, most of them have not been re-erected, only the palace of Knossos is restored. The Achaians from Greece take over Knossos (and are probably in

⁷ Warren/Hankey 1989, 169; all dates are BC and based on Kitchen 1989. For the lowering of the date of 1370/1360 to 1350, see note 495.

⁸ Papapostolou 1981, 18.

control of the whole island) and the Minoan civilisation declines. It is not clear what caused this disaster, but the most acceptable thesis is that the eruption of the volcano of Thera (the present Santorini) was the cause. The eruption of this volcano in c. 1450 BC⁹ was so heavy, that the isle of Thera was almost complete erased.¹⁰ The *tsunami* after the eruption will have had enormous consequences for the fleet and the harbours of Crete. Thus bereaved of their protection and of their main means of income – trade – the Minoans could only recover slowly and they became a prey for the Achaians, who perhaps were less harmed or recovered quicker.¹¹

Other causes could be the change in climate wrought by the freed volcanic gas, which could have ruined the harvest for many years, and an internal struggle when the religious leaders were no longer accepted by the desperate people.¹²

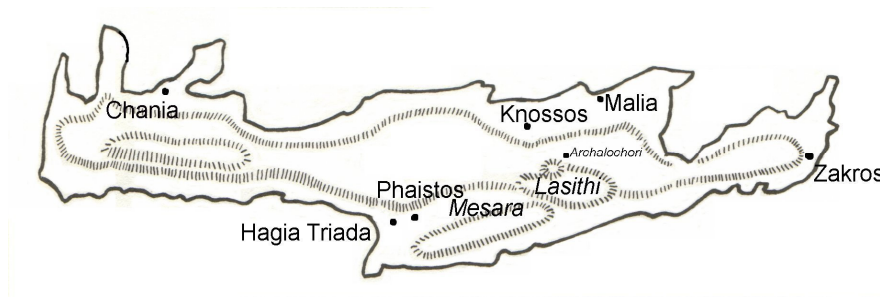


Fig. 2. Crete.

In about the same period the Hittites conquered a large part of Anatolia, consisting of the Assuwian League, probably including Arzawa (which is important in understanding the meaning of the letter to Nestor as we will see later on).

⁹ Bietak 2000, 194.

¹⁰ There are other dating criteria pointing to a much earlier date for the eruption of Thera, namely around 1650–1630 BC. For instance the long time as ‘hard’ considered dating of 1390 BC, reduced from the sediments in the ice-layers in Greenland by Hammer, Clausen and Dansgaard, but nevertheless corrected by them in 1987 to 1645 BC. Dendro-chronological data in Turkey/Anatolia should indicate the year 1628 BC (Hardy/Renfrew 1990, 14–16 and Ullstein 1999, 1–3; comprehensively Manning 1999). If so, the eruption of Thera could not have been the cause for the sudden collapse of the Minoan civilisation. The discovery of tephra in a layer which could be dated around 1450 BC by Manfred Bietak, however, is the most convincing dating criterion. See also chapter 8.

¹¹ Mellersh 1967, 131.

¹² McCoy 2001.

Though the Achaians residing in Knossos were now dominating the island, it was not the end of the Minoan civilization. There were some changes in the religion and the material culture. Simultaneously Linear B – which records an old form of Greek – was introduced in Knossos and Chania, whereas Minoan Linear A continued in the Mesara plain. Around 1350 BC the palace of Knossos and the temples and the settlement of Hagia Triada were destroyed and the latter was not restored in its former layout. Crete becomes a Mycenaean dependency and when in *c.* 1100 BC the Dorians invaded the island, the Bronze Age period came definitively to an end.



Fig. 3. The house 101 of the palace of Phaistos. To the left (a) the 7 smaller rooms and to the right (b) a side-view of the 8th room where the Disc of Phaistos was found. (Photo's: Lia Rietveld 2002).

Only at the end of the 19th century it was realised that the findings of many non-Greek seals and other artefacts could indicate more promising results from the soil of the site of Knossos. Heinrich Schliemann, who discovered Troy and also made excavations in Mycenae, did not get a permission to excavate, but later Arthur Evans did and he started digging in 1899. Shortly afterwards the French started their excavations in Malia and the Italians in Phaistos.

The Italian archaeological team was directed by Frederico Halbherr, who had already made some trial-excavations in 1894 in Phaistos. In 1900 the excavations of the palace of Phaistos continued with Luigi Pernier as supervisor. In 1908 the main part of the central palace was exposed and Pernier decided to dig on in the northeast side, where another four 'houses' were excavated, numbered 101 to 104. Of them number 101 consisted of a total number of 8 rooms, 7 small ones and one (no. 8) bigger, to the south of rooms 6 and 7. Above these rooms had been another floor, probably a storage or an archive. Next to the wall between the rooms 6–7 and 8, on July the 3rd, 1908 two clay objects were found: the fragmentary Linear A tablet PH 1 and besides it a roughly round disc with a diameter of about 16 cm and a thickness of somewhat more than 1 cm, better known as the 'Disc of Phaistos'.¹³ Nowadays this disc is exhibited in the archaeological museum in Heraklion.

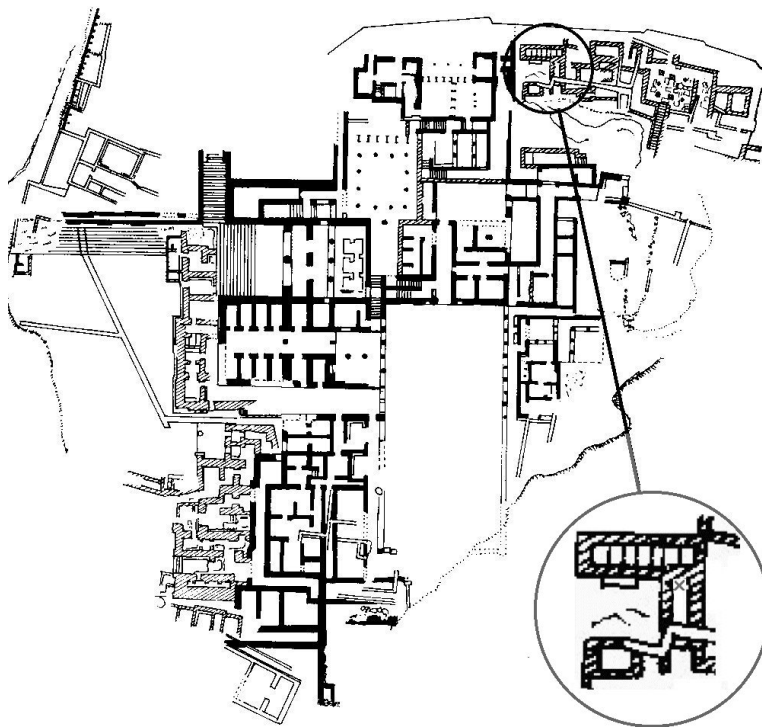


Fig. 4. Ground-plan of the palace of Phaistos. In the circle the 7 smaller and the single bigger room are enlarged. The Disc of Phaistos is found near the northern wall in the bigger room where the 'X' has been drawn (Source: Ministry of Culture, Greece, Archaeological Receipts Fund).

¹³ Godart 1995, 30.

The disc distinguishes itself in more than one aspect from the rectangular clay tablets; it is round, written in a spiral way, the signs are not drawn but stamped, the disc has been fired on purpose (and not like the tablets by accident in the fire that destroyed the palace) and, most of all, the script of the signs should be unique.¹⁴ Machteld Mellink, however, has demonstrated that sign D 24¹⁵ of the disc shows a striking similarity with the Lycian house type as depicted on a vase from the Early Bronze Age (c. 2300 BC) and as imitated by a sarcophagus in the form of a house from the Classical Period (c. 500 BC).¹⁶



Fig. 5. The Disc of Phaistos, side A, scale 1 : 1.5.

¹⁴ In 1992 the Disc of Vladikavkaz was found, but this is a copy or predecessor of the Disc of Phaistos with only a few differences. See Appendix III.

¹⁵ The numbering of the signs is after Duhoux 1977.

¹⁶ Mellink 1964a, 269-278; Mellink, 1964b: 1-7.

This connection with Lycia made Jan Best and Fred Woudhuizen also compare the other signs of the disc with Luwian Hieroglyphic – a script used in the southwest region of Anatolia. And though perhaps less striking than the cases for the signs D 24 and D 46, an oblique stroke, they found more corresponding signs and this appeared to be one of the keys to proceed with the decipherment of the text on the disc.¹⁷



Fig. 6. The Disc of Phaistos, side B, scale 1 : 1.5.

¹⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 37 and 83.

Another key was already brought up by Alice Kober (1948) while studying Linear B. It concerns the phenomenon that a number of signs occurs repeatedly in the same combination followed by alternating signs in final position. Her supposition was that the fixed combination would be the stem of a noun or a verb and that the signs in final position signalled case endings or conjugations. This discovery was one of the guiding principles which led to the decipherment of Linear B by Michael Ventris in 1952. Best applied the same principle to the Disc of Phaistos, which also contains a number of repeated stems with alternating endings.¹⁸ Sign D 46 being one of the signs featuring in these alternate endings, while at the same time it is used as a case ending in Luwian Hieroglyphic, fits quite well in this theory.

On the basis of this observation it might be deduced that the script on the Disc of Phaistos is not unique after all, but merely a variant of the Luwian hieroglyphic script.

Notable is furthermore the 8-shaped decoration (a tattoo) on the face of the man of sign D 03 and the extraordinary bulbous shape of the head of the man of sign D 02. The 8-shaped decoration also occurs on the Egyptian images of Minoans on wall-paintings¹⁹ and on a seal of the Great Queen Tanuhepa c. 1300 BC (SBo I, 24).²⁰ The shape of the head on sign D 02 recalls the Amarna-style from the period of pharaoh Akhenaten (1352-1336 BC) in Egypt.²¹

There has been a lot of discussion about the content and the meaning of the disc. There are numerous 'translations', by far the most of them based on the content of the disc as an isolated object. This explains the enormous diversity of interpretations and simultaneously proves the weakness of such an approach. For one single piece of text (provided it is a text!) in an unknown script and in an unknown language can never lead to a satisfying decipherment.

¹⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 30-48.

¹⁹ Godart 1995, 122-124.

²⁰ Güterbock, 1940, 24.

²¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 138; Jeppesen 1963, 188.

2. TECHNICAL ASPECTS*

Winfried Achterberg

The disc is not exactly round and not entirely flat. Apparently it has been manufactured by hand without the use of a mould. The diameter is roughly 16 cm and the thickness varies between 1.5 and 2 cm. Signs have been placed on both sides of the disc in a spiral shape. Even though the disc is unusual in many ways, its most spectacular feature is that – as conventional wisdom has it – the signs constitute a completely unknown form of script. Up till now this script has been found nowhere else, neither on Crete nor anywhere else,²² although we do find some of the signs used on other artefacts, such as the religious double-axe of Arkalochori and a seal found in Phaistos (HM 992, see Fig. 7), of which the meaning is not yet clear. On the axe there also are other signs, which do not occur on the disc. This indicates that we are dealing with a native form of writing and not an outside import.



(a)



(b)

Fig. 7. (a) Detail of side A of the Disc of Phaistos with sign D 21. (b) A sealprint of seal HM 992 with the same sign; the seal dates from the Old Palace period, MM II, c. 1800–1700 BC (Photo: Judith Lange).

Other scripts which have been found on tablets and seals from Crete are Cretan Hieroglyphic and Linear A and B. Linear B has been deciphered as recording an early form of Greek by the architect Michael Ventris in 1952. In which way the writing on the Disc of Phaistos fits in here (if and how) will be explained further on.

* With thanks to Claudia Seppen for the translation.

²² See also note 14.

The disc distinguishes itself from the tablets in more than one way. A remarkable fact is that the signs have not been written or drawn but have been stamped, at least 45 of the total of 47 signs. Insofar as the signs recur, they are completely identical. Using a stamp for each separate sign was highly unusual for this period (the Cretan hieroglyphic seals usually bear more than one sign). Without any doubt there would have been other texts made with this script, since one presumably does not construct a set of stamps for a one time use. It might be an indication that this text is an important official document. This is confirmed by the fact that the material of which the stamps have been constructed was gold, according to specialist engravers.²³ This would be the only material soft enough to work with in such great detail and hard enough to be used several times without any damaging or wear. Other researchers, however, mainly specify wood, ivory or stone as the material of which the stamps have been constructed.²⁴

After stamping the disc has been baked to be preserved for posterity, which can be concluded by the regular colour of the disc.²⁵ This contrasts with the average tablet, which has been baked by coincidence, because of fire, and has been preserved in this manner. These tablets show various changes in colour, varying from red to black according to the irregular reduction during the process of baking.

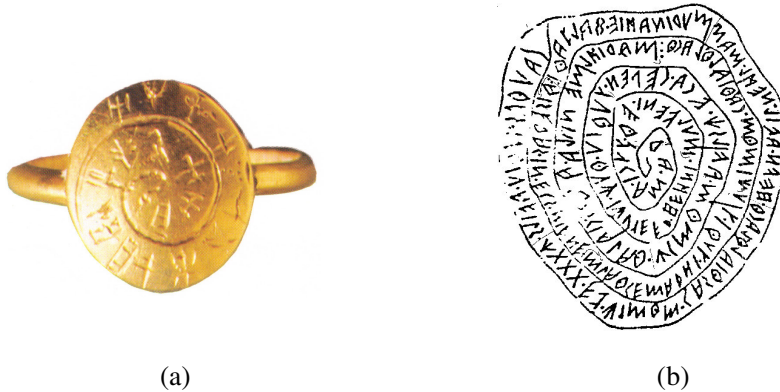


Fig. 8. (a) The golden ring of Mavro Spelio with Linear A inscription (KN Zf 13) (Photo: L. Godart). (b) A drawing of the lead Disc of Magliano (after Milani 1893).

²³ Godart 1995, 114.

²⁴ Duhoux 1977, 39.

²⁵ Duhoux 1977, 17.

Another remarkable feature of the disc is the spiral shape in which the signs have been placed. The Disc of Phaistos is not entirely unique in having this feature, because other objects are known to have a spiral-shaped text, such as the golden ring of Mavro Spelio (near Knossos) with a Linear A inscription and – from outside Crete – the lead Disc of Magliano (Etruria), which has a spiral shaped inscription as well (see Fig. 8).

There are a total of 261 signs on the disc, of which 47 are different.²⁶ They have been divided by small lines in 61 segments. On side A (the explanation of why this is side A will follow further on) there are 133 signs in 31 segments and on side B there are 128 signs in 30 segments.

We will adhere to the numeration of Yves Duhoux, who numbers the segments as A 1 - A 31 and B 1 - B 30 respectively, and the signs as D 01 - D 45. Duhoux regards the 46th sign as a separate symbol and does not recognize the 47th sign. Therefore he counts 122 signs and 9 lines (“traits obliques”) in sum on side A and 119 signs and 8 lines in sum on side B;²⁷ we will come back to this further on. Helmuth Bossert was the first to recognize that the 46th symbol was Luwian²⁸ and Jan Best discovered through his study of doublets and triplets that this symbol had to be a full-fledged sign with a phonetic value.²⁹ For this reason we add this symbol to the set of signs as D 46.



Fig. 9. Two Cycladic ‘frying pans’ from the cemetery of Hagia Photia, Siteia, c. 2500–2000 BC. The right one has a spiral-shaped decoration (Photo: Lia Rietveld).

²⁶ Visible are 259 signs, but we assume 2 more signs at two places, where the disc has a damage, sign D 46 in segment A 7 and, once again, sign D 46 in segment B 8. See chapter 4.

²⁷ Duhoux 1977, 56 ff.

²⁸ Bossert 1932, 14-15.

²⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 31.

Comparison with the Disc of Vladikavkaz allows us to assume that there is another symbol, occurring once in segment A 3, drawn through sign D 45. So far it has been considered to be a scratch from damage, but since on the Disc of Vladikavkaz a stroke is clearly visible on almost the same spot, it may well be a distinct symbol (see Fig. 44). We add it to our list as D 47. See for more details Appendix III.

The total number of 47 signs points to a syllabic script: there are too many individual signs for an alphabetic script (which usually has only 22–30 signs) and too few for a truly hieroglyphic script (which tends to use over a 100 signs). Ten signs occur only once, whereas signs D 02 and D 46 (including the two additions) occur the most with 19 times. It is probable that this particular script consisted of more signs, besides the 47 ones that occur on the disc. A statistic analysis points to at least ten more symbols.³⁰

The number of signs varies per segment between 2 to 7 with 4 as occurring most (2: 3x, 3: 17x, 4: 18x, 5: 16x, 6: 6x and 7: 3x). It is not probable that these groups are complete phrases, because the number of signs in each segment is too small. They could be words, although the number of 7 signs would be very much for one word and, on the other hand, there would be no words of one syllable, which is not very probable either. The conclusion can be drawn therefore that the lines form a separation between clusters of words.

Several corrections have been made by the manufacturer, most of them during the process of stamping. This means that a wrong sign is erased in the wet clay and that the right one has been stamped on top of it. There are several ‘erasure marks’ on the disc. At least one correction has been made afterwards (in A 4 - A 5); the clay had hardened somewhat at that point, which made erasing more difficult. A bigger problem the manufacturer encountered when the correct number of signs was higher than the previously stamped ones; at this point he had to conquer lack of space and he had to slope the signs (as in A 4) and he had to put one sign half on top of the other (as in A 5). It appears that the segment A 5 had to be expanded afterwards with two signs, which have been crammed in and which caused segments A 5 and A 4 to be stamped anew.³¹ The separation line between the segments A 4 and A 5 also has been moved, a remnant of the original line can still be seen.

The last sign of segment A 8 is illegible because of some damage. Several suggestions have been made for the sign that could have been there: D 03, D 20 or less probably D 08, D 44,³² D 07,³³ or a sign that does not occur anywhere else on the disc. Another possibility would be that the sign has been

³⁰ Mackay 1965, 15–25. The formula of Mackay states: $L^2 / (L - M) - L$ with for L the total number of symbols occurring and for M the number of different symbols. For the disc this will be $261^2 / (261 - 47) - 261 = 57,3$.

³¹ Della Seta 1908, 309–310.

³² Godart 1995, 101.

³³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 35.

erased by a later correction on the already hardened clay. This can be deduced from the fact that the damage consists of just the space of the sign and not the area surrounding it.³⁴

For a long time it has been unclear in which direction the text had to be read, from right to left and from the outside to the inside or from left to right and from the inside to the outside. Now most researchers are convinced that the text has to be read from the outside to the inside and from right to left. This is made clear by the overlap of several signs as well as the lines of the spirals.

Duhoux has investigated the signs that had been stamped on top of one another (where the bottom one had been stamped first) and the ones that had been stamped so close to one another that one deformed the other (where the deformed one had been stamped first). He ascertained 19 of these overlaps and/or deformations, of which 14 suggested a writing direction from right to left and from the outside to the inside and 5 the other way around. All these latter 5 instances, however, consisted of corrections in A 4 - A 5, of which della Seta already ascertained that these were done in the contra direction because of lack of space.³⁵ The conclusion for the writing direction is clear: from right to left and from the outside to the inside.

The spiral lines, which were hand-drawn on both sides of the disc also give a clue about the writing direction: apparently these have served as a guide for the manufacturer. From close examination of the lines and signs by Duhoux and Louis Godart it appears that where the lines touch or overlap the signs, the signs are on top of the spiral lines and must have been made at a later time. That spiral line itself – as is shown by the shape of the incision in the clay – has been drawn from the outside to the inside. On side A this has been done with two constant lines (first the outside line and after this the rest of the spiral line in one constant move towards the inside), on side B the line exists of several separately drawn parts. The clear jump from the outer layer towards the inside of the spiral line also signifies that the outer line has been drawn first.³⁶

Apparently, on side A the whole spiral line has been drawn first, after which all the signs have been stamped in an ongoing process, on side B a bit of line has been drawn and then the symbols were stamped after which another piece of line has been drawn, etc. This explains why the spiral line on side A makes a nice round shape and the symbols are somewhat crammed in the middle, while on side B the symbols are neater and the line somewhat more angled.³⁷

On side B the incisions of the starting points of the pieces of line betray the direction in which these lines have been drawn: from the outside to the inside.

³⁴ Duhoux 1977, 33.

³⁵ Della Seta 1908, 309-310; Duhoux 1977, 27-30; Godart 1995, 100.

³⁶ Duhoux 1977, 19-21.

³⁷ Godart 1995, 73-75 and 86-87.

There are two possible explanations of why the writer has chosen for these two different approaches, which in itself suggests that side A indeed has been stamped first and side B second. First, it seems logical to draw all the lines first and then stamp, which the writer did on the first side. But a spiral could create a problem in the centre because one is inclined to draw the lines closer together, which leaves too little space. When confronted with this problem on the first side, the writer used a better way on the other side.

Second, it has to be remembered that the drawing of the lines and the stamping has to be done in soft and therefore moist clay. For the first side this is not a problem, but before the other side can be worked on, the first side has to be dry enough not to be damaged when the disc is turned over to work on the other side. To still be able to stamp on the second somewhat dried side the clay has to be moistened bit by bit shortly before working on it.³⁸

The separation lines between the segments have been drawn in between stamping and not beforehand (this would mean a well-nigh impossible planning for the scribe) and not afterwards, which is shown by the way the clay has been indented on one side of the line and from the corrections which involve the separation lines.

Furthermore it is common in hieroglyphic writing that signs consisting of human or animal pictures 'look' at the start of the sentence, so counterwise of the reading direction.³⁹

Duhoux also deduced that side A has been worked on first: the signs on side A have been pressed deeper into the clay, but mostly because side A has been flattened somewhat in the middle, while side B is flatter on the whole. This can be explained by the production process: when the first side is stamped in the still moist clay, the print is deep and the disc as a whole can still be formed, which means that the underside will flatten. After a minimum of necessary hardening the other side can be stamped, but the print will be less deep and the disc will no longer deform, which means that the second side will remain flat and the first side round, and the latter will weigh down most on the thickest area – the middle. Therefore it can be concluded that side A has to be the first side which was stamped. The fact that the corrections on side B were harder to make (the erasure marks are far clearer) also shows that the clay had hardened at this point.⁴⁰

The order of writing or stamping has thus been established and, even though the reading direction could be different, it would be highly improbable that the order of stamping would have been different from the direction in which the text has to be read.

³⁸ Godart 1995, 87.

³⁹ On the Disc of Phaistos this is also the case, bar one occurrence: the bird D 31 in segment A 22. Apparently a mistake, for at the other four occurrences the bird 'flies' in the correct direction.

⁴⁰ Duhoux 1977, 41.

On both sides a small line on which 5 dots have been made signifies the start of the text.

One of the 47 signs – D 46 – plays an important role according to several researchers (Duhoux, Godart a.o.). Because this sign is the only one which was not stamped, but made by hand (most researchers being ignorant of the also hand-drawn sign D 47), *and* since every time it occurs on the disc it is the last symbol of a segment, *and* because it also is the last symbol on side B, *and* because this sign is a far more simple one than the rest, it is seen by these researchers as a punctuation mark and thus it could signify the end of a sentence. According to this theory they arrive at 17 ‘sentences’ on the disc, where the sentences vary from 1 to 12 ‘words’ or from 4 to 49 syllables.

But there is another possible explanation if we compare the disc to other – deciphered – scripts of this period. Bossert made a connection with a Luwian counterpart, in which this symbol also occurs as a sign with a phonetic value, sometimes even as the last sign of a word and attached to the penultimate sign of that particular word.⁴¹ This is also the case on the Disc of Phaistos! Stamping two signs against each other is more difficult to perform and besides this sign has such a simple form that it would not be quicker or more elegant if a separate stamp was to be made for this sign (it would only be more consistent). A stamp with a single line, which has to be attached would also be more difficult to manufacture and it would be a deviation from the other stamps.

With this explanation we arrive at a total of 47 individual signs.

There are several views on the exact date of the disc. The disc has been found in the eighth room of building 101 of the palace of Phaistos, in the immediate vicinity of the Linear A tablet PH 1. Building 101 belongs to the oldest part of the palace, but it has also been used (again) in the New Palace period. According to Luigi Pernier both objects would have been on some sort of shelf or a higher floor and they would have fallen down when the palace was destroyed.⁴² At the excavations a great amount of sherds has been found in ‘layers’, which can be assigned to different phases in culture and therefore be dated accordingly. Basing himself on these layers Duhoux dates the disc either around 1850 BC or around 1600 BC,⁴³ while others concluded that this whole period is possible. Then there are others who have a later date for the disc because it fell from the top between the sherds downwards. Godart compares the signs on the disc with similar representations on other objects and concludes from this a period of *c.* 1550 to *c.* 1200 BC.⁴⁴ Best holds that the

⁴¹ Bossert 1932, 14-15.

⁴² Pernier 1908a, 261.

⁴³ Duhoux 1977, 12.

⁴⁴ Godart 1995, 161-162.

disc and the Linear A tablet could be from the same period and that the Linear A tablet PH 1 can be more precisely dated at c. 1400–1340 BC, because of the occurrence of a name (*di-ra-di-na*) on it, which also occurs on another, dated tablet from Hagia Triada (HT 98a. 2-3: as *di-re-di-na*); given the *ductus* these variants of the name could even have been written by the same scribe.⁴⁵ The similarity between the shape of the head of symbol D 02 with the Amarna-style of the period of pharaoh Akhenaten, is a clue that the disc should not be dated before his reign (1352–1336 BC).

Unfortunately, there has been no dating based on a scientific method (radiocarbon C14 method or the like) and the clay has as yet not been tested for its origin.

⁴⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 71-72.

3. HOW TO DATE THE PHAISTOS DISC

Jan Best

In the evening of the 3rd of July 1908 a disc of terracotta with pictographic signs on both faces was found in the northern part of room 8 in building 101 next to the palace of Phaistos. A few centimetres farther to the southeast, in the same room, on practically the same level, lay a clay tablet (PH 1; see Fig. 13), carrying characters of the Cretan Linear A script (Fig. 10). Both objects were partly visible on the surface of and partly stuck in a layer of ashes comprising a few Middle Minoan IIIB sherds. This position made clear that they had fallen down, probably together, from an upper storey.⁴⁶ In other parts of room 8 sherds from all periods, starting with the Middle Minoan one and far into Hellenistic times, were found. It is not clear whether an upper storey of building 101 was rebuilt in the Late Minoan I period as was the case with the adjoining buildings 102 and 103. As no downstairs entrance was found in the remnant lower walls of building 101, in any case a staircase must have led down to its basement from the upper storey, when the complete building was in use during the Middle Minoan IIIB period, from which the sherds stem in the layer where the Phaistos Disc and Linear A tablet were found. This basement may have been closed down during the following Late Minoan period, whereas the upper storey may have been rebuilt upon its remaining walls: nobody can be sure.

To date the Phaistos Disc between *c.* 1850 and 1600 BC, as Yves Duhoux does solely on the questionable basis of external evidence consisting of a majority of Middle Minoan sherds in the basement of room 8 in building 101, is premature.⁴⁷ However, to date the Phaistos Disc after 1400 BC, but still in the 14th century BC, on the basis of a few stray Late Minoan III sherds, found in room 8, is no less premature.⁴⁸ From a purely archaeological point of view it would seem that one has to resign to the following statement: “On a donc, en bonne méthode, le droit d’imaginer que le disc peut appartenir à n’importe quelle période comprise entre le Minoen Moyen III et les époques grecques tardives”.⁴⁹

The only way out of the dilemma of how to date the Phaistos Disc is offered by the contents of the inscribed clay tablet PH 1 found nearby, that is, if one is prepared to accept the excavator’s view that the Phaistos Disc and tablet PH 1 probably fell down from an upper storey *together*. For if, in that case, we might be able to date the tablet in question, we would automatically have fixed the date of the Phaistos Disc as well.

⁴⁶ Pernier 1908a, 261.

⁴⁷ Duhoux 1977, 14.

⁴⁸ Jeppesen 1963, 182-183.

⁴⁹ Godart 1990, 206.

The Linear A tablet PH (?) 31, with the question mark assigned by Louis Godart and Jean-Pierre Olivier to the corpus of Linear A tablets found at Phaistos, is as tablet HT 170 ? – again with a question mark – assigned by Jacques Raison and Maurice Pope to the corpus of Linear A tablets found at Hagia Triada, two miles west of Phaistos (Fig. 11).⁵⁰ It contains two men's names, *ma-di* and *ku-pa-nu*, which both occur several times separately on tablets from Hagia Triada and once in combination on tablet HT 3, just as on tablet PH (?) 31.⁵¹ Although the *ductus* of the signs on the latter tablet is a little bit more loose than on the average tablet from Hagia Triada, the execution of the drawing is nearly the same. In any case, whether tablet PH (?) 31 would stem indeed from Phaistos or possibly from Hagia Triada, its overall appearance surely shows it to be contemporaneous with the corpus of Linear A tablets found at Hagia Triada.

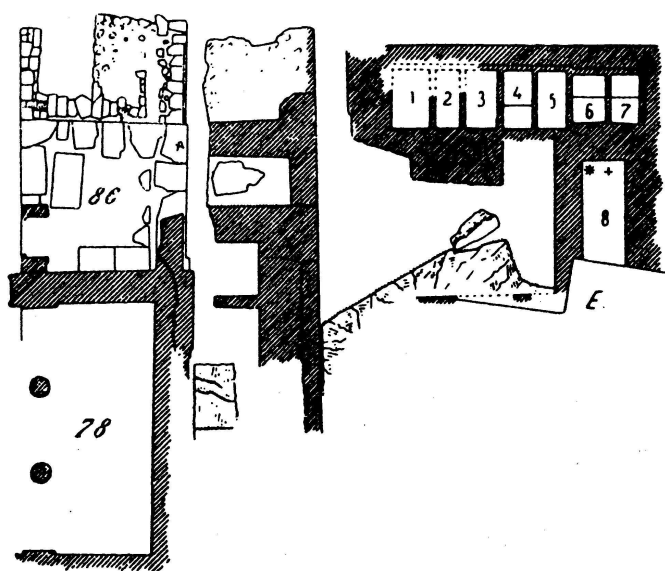


Fig. 10. Groundplan of the excavations of building 101 in Phaistos; the Disc of Phaistos is found in room 8 at the '*', the tablet PH 1 at the '+' (after Pernier 1908a).

⁵⁰ Godart/Olivier 1976, XXX, 318; Raison/Pope 1971, 231, 247, 312.

⁵¹ Cf. for *ma-di*: tablets HT 69.2, 85b.5, 97a.4, 118.1, for *ku-pa-nu*: tablets HT 1a.3, 47a.6-7, 88.3 & 4, 117a.3, 122a.6 & 7 and for *ma-di* and *ku-pa-nu* in combination: tablet HT 3.7 and 3.6, respectively. See for the values of Linear A signs Meijer 1982, 38-47; Best 2007, 53-62.

However, the same reasoning must apply to tablet PH 28 (Fig. 12), stemming without any doubt from Phaistos, on which the man's name *a-wî-su* in the last line is the same as that in the third line of tablet HT 118.⁵² Likewise the man's name *di-ra-di-na* in the first line of tablet PH 1 (Fig. 13), found next to the Phaistos Disc, occurs in the writing variant *di-re-di-na* in the second and third lines on side *a* of tablet HT 98. All tablets mentioned show the same stage and style of writing. It is not amazing that on contemporaneous tablets from Phaistos and nearby Hagia Triada the same names of individuals appear to occur in the administrations of both Phaistos and its port at present-day Hagia Triada. Only tablet PH 1, however, happens to be the one found a few centimetres from the Phaistos Disc and therefore it is of great interest to know how the corpus of Linear A tablets from Hagia Triada is dated.

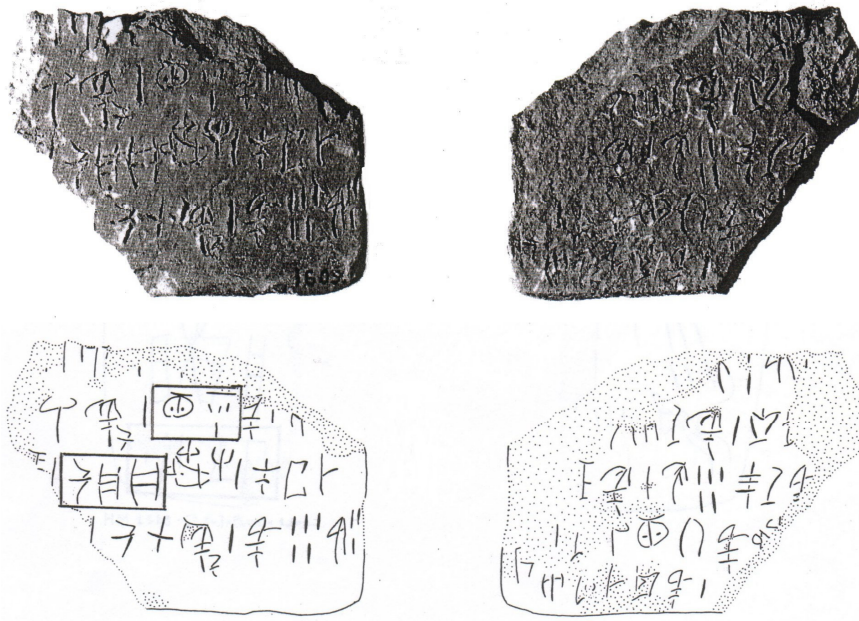


Fig. 11. Fragmentary tablet PH (?) 31 (after Godart/Olivier 1976, 318).

As so often, in this matter no consensus exists among specialists either. Most archaeologists of the British School in the 1950s dated the destruction layer in which the tablets from Hagia Triada were found to the end of the Late Minoan I period, *c.* 1450 BC, notwithstanding the fact that much earlier the British archaeologist John Pendlebury and – perhaps even more important – the

⁵² See for the correct readings of Linear A signs with long and short vowels Best 2000, 27-35.

members of the Italian School who had excavated the ancient sites of Phaistos and Hagia Triada, had noticed strong Late Minoan II influences upon the pottery from Hagia Triada and for that reason had dated the same destruction layer to the end of the Late Minoan II period, *c.* 1400 BC.⁵³

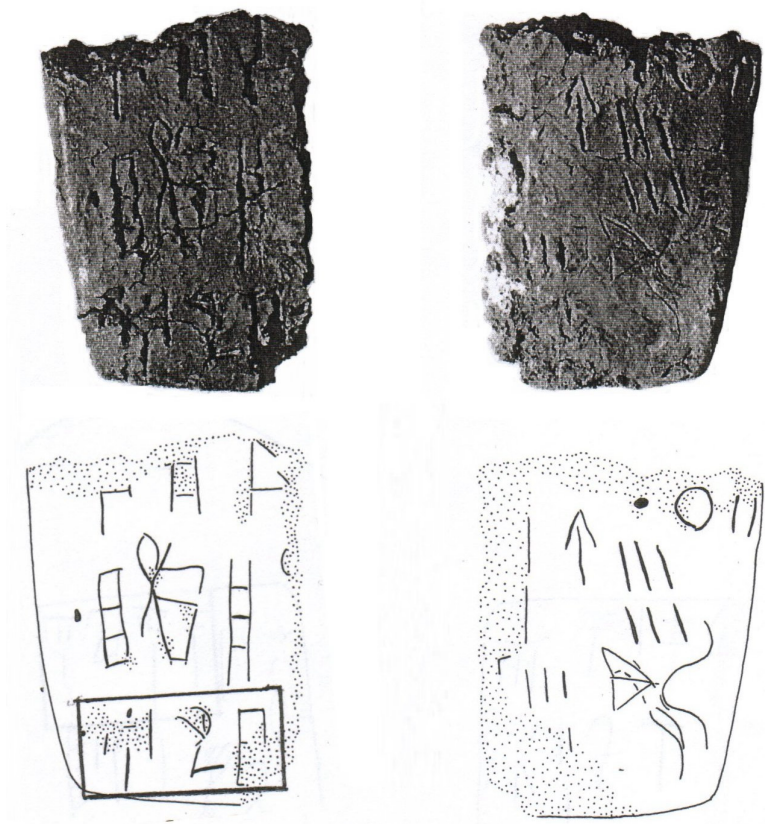


Fig. 12. Fragmentary tablet PH 28 (after Godart/Olivier 1976, 314).

In the latter case, the corpus of *c.* 150 Linear A tablets from Hagia Triada would have been contemporaneous with the *c.* 4000 Linear B tablets from Knossos, formerly also dated *c.* 1400 BC. At any rate, a corresponding chronological horizon would easily explain why deliveries from the Phaistos area as indicated in the Linear B As-series from Knossos are so often coupled with the same men's names as those written on the tablets from Hagia Triada and Phaistos. The most conspicuous names are those of *ma-di*, again, in

⁵³ Pendlebury 1939, 228; Banti 1947, 29; Pernier/Banti 1951, 487 ff.: "La ceramica festia".

Knossos on tablet KN As 603, and of *qa-qa-ru* on tablets HT 93a.4-5, 111a.2, 118.2-3, and 122b.3-4, written as *qa-qa-ro* on tablet KN As 604, because in the order of *ma-di* on tablet KN As 603 and of *qa-qa-ro* on tablet KN As 604, the same order of *ma-di* in the first line and of *qa-qa-ru* in the second and third lines of tablet HT 118 is clearly reflected.

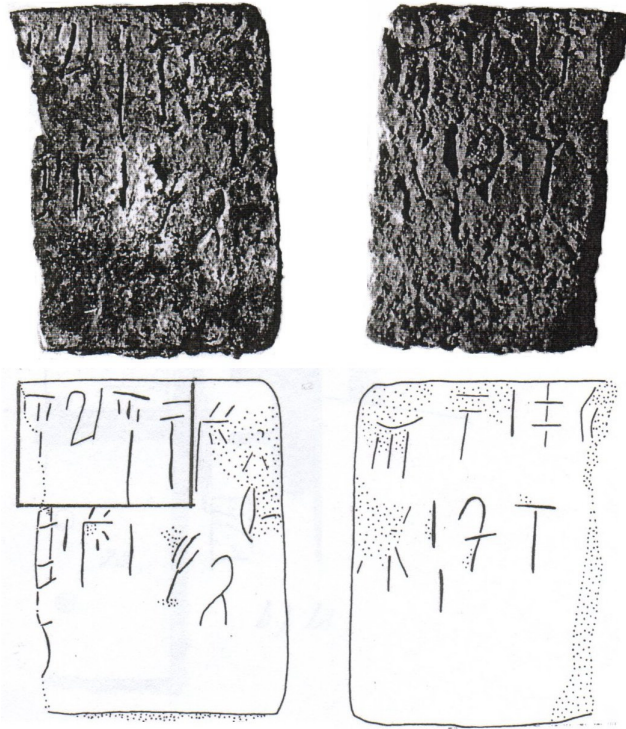


Fig. 13. Fragmentary tablet PH 1 (after Godart/Olivier 1976, 286).

Meanwhile Mervyn Popham has tried to demonstrate that the date for the destruction layer in which the Linear B tablets from Knossos were found should be set at *c.* 1375 BC (Late Minoan IIIA1/2) instead of at *c.* 1400 BC, whereas in that case the present author would show a slight preference for Godart's date 1370 BC, because in the chronology of Egypt only Mycenaeans from the Greek mainland are attested in Egyptian sources from that date onwards.⁵⁴ Consequently this low date would also apply to the Linear A tablets from Hagia Triada and Phaistos containing personal names identical

⁵⁴ Cf. Popham 1970, *passim* and Godart 1990, 113.

with those mentioned in the Linear B As-series from Knossos. However, this low date must still be lowered when Jan Driessen's reconstruction of different destruction layers with Linear B tablets at Knossos is followed. For this tentative reconstruction puts the set, of which the As-series forms part, at *c.* 1340 BC (Late Minoan IIIB1).⁵⁵ If Peter Warren and Vronwy Hankey are right in dating Amenhotep III into the period 1390–1352 BC,⁵⁶ then his successor Akhenaten would have reigned during the period 1352–1336 BC. Kristian Jeppesen and Fred Woudhuizen have, independently from each other,⁵⁷ stressed the likeness of the sign of a man's head on the Phaistos Disc to the heads rendered in the Egyptian style *en vogue* during the reign of Akhenaten.⁵⁸ Of course, a date of *c.* 1340 BC for the tablets of the As-series at Knossos, would make the higher date of *c.* 1370 BC for the tablets with corresponding names from Hagia Triada and Phaistos questionable again. Whatever the reader's preference for a date of tablet PH 1 may be – *c.* 1400, 1375, 1370, or 1340 BC –, it should in any case be dated within the period 1400–1340 BC and by no means within the period 1850–1600 BC.

Dating within the same chronological horizon Linear B tablets of the As-series from Knossos and Linear A tablets from Hagia Triada and Phaistos *bearing identical personal names in combination with each other*, means no more than that one can approximately tell when the Phaistos Disc and Linear A tablet PH 1 *must have fallen down together* – if they did at all. Without further external and internal evidence it does not mean that one can tell exactly when and on what occasion the text on the Phaistos Disc was *written*.

⁵⁵ Driessen 1997, 134, note 56; Warren/Hankey 1989, 169 (Table 3.1).

⁵⁶ Warren/Hankey 1989, 152.

⁵⁷ Oral information by Fred Woudhuizen.

⁵⁸ See note 48 *supra* Jeppesen 1963, 188; Woudhuizen in Best & Woudhuizen 1989, 137-138.

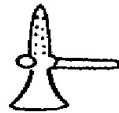
4. THE SIGNS

Kees Enzler

4.1 Introduction

The description of the signs of the disc is based upon the works of Yves Duhoux (D nos.) and Emmanuel Laroche (L nos.).⁵⁹ Concerning the numbering of the signs, the one of Duhoux is followed, taking into account that two not stamped but hand-made signs are added as the numbers D 46 and D 47. The used examples of the signs are taken from Louis Godart.⁶⁰ However, D 21 and D 24 are slightly adapted in agreement with their appearance on the disc, D 16, D 33 and D 45 are turned 90°, and D 43 is turned 180°, all for a better comparison with their Luwian hieroglyphic counterparts. Furthermore, D 46 and D 47 are added, whereas D 11 is copied from Fred Woudhuizen.⁶¹ To sign D 17 no Laroche number has been assigned. With the term ‘external evidence’ is meant that the values of the signs in question are based upon resemblance with counterparts in the Luwian hieroglyphic script (except D 09 and D 40); with ‘internal evidence’ is meant that the values of the signs in question have been determined on the basis of regularities in the text.⁶²

The various manners of printing express the following notions:

- <i>KATA</i>	= logogram (word value)	
- <i>sa</i>	= syllable (phonetic value)	
- <i>custos</i>	= Latin description for a Luwian logogram with an unknown phonetic value	
- <i>DU</i>	= determinative (concept value)	

⁵⁹ Duhoux 1977; Laroche 1960.

⁶⁰ Godart 1995, 115.

⁶¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 38, Fig. 2.

⁶² Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 54.

4.2 The Signs

D 01

Side A: 6x

Side B: 5x



Fig.: striding man

Value: *SARU* (logogram)⁶³

Remarks: - the value is based upon the relationship in form and value with a Luwian hieroglyph⁶⁴

- *SARU* denotes in Crete a vassal-king⁶⁵ of a town and/or a limited territory

Luwian

counterparts⁶⁶: L 80 and L 81⁶⁷

Remarks: - L 80 is the lower part of a human body

- L 81 is a foot

- probably both are derived from a complete figure of a striding man with staff and handkerchief (L 3a)

Value: appears in the Luwian personal name *SARU+ma*⁶⁸

Remark: - in the Hittite language *SARU* is a Semitic loanword and hence probably in the Luwian language, too

Origin: from the cuneiform writing: *LÚGAL/šarru*⁶⁹Remark: - in the Semitic language *šarru* means “king”⁷⁰

⁶³ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 65.

⁶⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

⁶⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 69; cf. Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 62.

⁶⁶ The pictures of the concerned Luwian counterparts are presented in the text. For a survey of all Luwian counterparts, see fig. 15.

⁶⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 80.

⁶⁸ Laroche 1960, 47-48.

⁶⁹ Cf. Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

⁷⁰ Von Soden 1965-1972-1981, s.v.

D 02

Side A: 14x
Side B: 5x



Fig.: head of man with feathered headdress

Remarks: - according to Herodotos (*Histories* I, 171-173 and VII, 92) a feathered headdress was worn by Lycians and Carians who once had lived in Crete, just like the Caunians
- some groups of the Sea Peoples are depicted in the same way by the Egyptian pharaoh Ramesses III (1183–1153 BC) at Medinet Habu,⁷¹ among them the Philistines who according to the Bible descended from Crete⁷² (see Fig. 17)
- the strikingly bulbous skull and the thin neck recall the Amarna-style from the time of the Egyptian pharaoh Akhenaten (1353–1337 BC);⁷³ on account of this resemblance the disc should not be dated before this period

Value: *a* (syllabic vowel)⁷⁴

Remarks: - the value is based upon external and internal evidence⁷⁵
- the sign only appears in first position⁷⁶

Luwian

counterpart: L 19⁷⁷

Value: *ā*⁷⁸

Remark: this sign appears only in first position, too⁷⁹

Other corresponding

signs: - on Middle Bronze Age cylinder seals from North Syria (2000–1700 BC), published by the Erlenmeyers⁸⁰ (see Fig. 27) and by Hogarth⁸¹
- on the double-axe of Arkalochori from the late 15th or early 14th century BC (value: *ā*)⁸² (see Fig. 28b, no. 1)



⁷¹ Pernier 1908a, 281-283; Evans 1909, 25; Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 38.

⁷² Godart 1995, 121.

⁷³ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 137-138; dates according to Freu 2007, 311.

⁷⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 55.

⁷⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 55.

⁷⁶ Duhoux 1980, 120; Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 47.

⁷⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 55.

⁷⁸ Laroche 1960, 13-14.

⁷⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 47.

⁸⁰ Erlenmeijer 1965, 1-4; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 129-130.

⁸¹ Hogarth 1920, see discussion of no. 154; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 130-131, Fig. 11b.

⁸² Duhoux 1977, 15-16; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 73-74 and 100.

D 03

Side A: 2x
 Side B: none



Fig.: head of man with tattoo on his cheek⁸³

Value: *har* (syllable)⁸⁴

Remarks: - the value is based upon the relationship in form and value with a Luwian hieroglyph⁸⁵
 - the tattoo is typically Minoan,⁸⁶ for also the Egyptians depict Cretan embassies with this tattoo in the form of an eight as happens to be the case in the tomb of Rekhmare, the Grand Vizier of pharaoh Tuthmoses III (1479–1425 BC)⁸⁷ (see Fig. 18)
 - a Luwian hieroglyphic parallel is formed by a head of a queen with this tattoo in the form of an eight⁸⁸ (see Fig. 15, L 16)
 - on the other hand this sign shows Syro-Palestinian influences, for the shaven head is, just like those of signs D 01, D 02, D 04 and D 05, characteristic for Syrians as depicted in Theban tombs⁸⁹

Luwian counterpart:

L 10⁹⁰

Value: *HARMAHI*⁹¹ 1. “man”; 2. “chief”

Remark: - the syllabic value *har* is derived from the logographic value *HARMAHI* according to the acrophonic principle⁹²



Other corresponding

signs: - on the altar-stone from Malia (value: *har*)⁹³ (see Fig. 30, no. 2)
 - on the double-axe of Arkalochori from the late 15th or early 14th century BC (value: *har*)⁹⁴ (see Fig. 28b, no. 4)

⁸³ Godart 1995, 122.

⁸⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

⁸⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

⁸⁶ Pernier 1908a, 281 and note 2.

⁸⁷ Vercoutter 1956, 201 ff.; Godart 1995, 122-124.

⁸⁸ Laroche 1960, 9, L 16.

⁸⁹ Godart 1995, 123-124; see N. de G. Davies 1935, *passim*.

⁹⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

⁹¹ Laroche 1960, 5-6.

⁹² Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

⁹³ Chapouthier 1938, 107; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 75-76.

⁹⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 73-74.

D 04

Side A: 1x
 Side B: none



Fig.: naked man with tied up arms behind his back (= prisoner)⁹⁵

Value: *hi* (syllable)⁹⁶

Remarks: - the value is based upon the relationship in form and value with a Luwian hieroglyph⁹⁷
 - the syllabic value *hi* is derived from the Luwian logographic value *HISHIA* “to tie up” according to the acrophonic principle⁹⁸
 - Asiatic prisoners are depicted likewise at the walls of the temple of Amon in Karnak by pharaoh Sethos I (1294–1279 BC)⁹⁹

Luwian counterpart: L 31¹⁰⁰



Remark: - the tied up arms possibly are derived from a completely depicted prisoner,¹⁰¹ just like L 80 and L 81 are from L 3a (see D 01)

Value: *HISHIA*¹⁰²

Other corresponding

sign: - in the Cretan hieroglyphic script (no. 006)¹⁰³ (value: *hi*) (see Fig. 31)

⁹⁵ Godart 1995, 124.

⁹⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

⁹⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

⁹⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

⁹⁹ Godart 1995, 124.

¹⁰⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

¹⁰¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

¹⁰² Laroche 1960, 22-23.

¹⁰³ Cretan hieroglyphic signs are numbered according to Olivier/Godart 1996, unless indicated otherwise.

D 05

Side A: none

Side B: 1x

Fig.: walking man

Value: *TIWA* (logogram)¹⁰⁴

Remark: - the value is based upon the relationship in form and value with a Luwian hieroglyph¹⁰⁵

Luwian

counterpart: L 90¹⁰⁶

Remark: - the foot probably is a simplification of a complete walking figure,¹⁰⁷ just like L 80 and L 81 are of L 3a (see D 01)

Values: *TIWA*, *ti*¹⁰⁸

Remark: - the syllabic value *ti* is derived from the logographic value *TIWA* according to the acrophonic principle



¹⁰⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

¹⁰⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

¹⁰⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

¹⁰⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

¹⁰⁸ Laroche 1960, 53-56.

D 06

Side A: 2x

Side B: 2x



Fig.: woman with bare breasts in praying attitude

Remarks: - a woman with bare breasts is depicted in a wall-painting in Knossos, the so-called spectatorbox of the women (see Fig. 19a)

- a little bronze statue from an unknown find-spot of a Minoan woman with bare breasts and with the left arm over the left breast like in D 06 is nowadays in the State Museum in Berlin (LM I) and an even smaller similar statue can be seen in the archaeological museum of Heraklion (MM IIIB) (see Fig. 19b)

Value: *mi* (syllable)¹⁰⁹Remark: - the value is based upon internal and external evidence¹¹⁰

Luwian

counterpart: L 15

Value: *mi*¹¹¹

Remark: - the value is determined by the fact that on a Luwian Middle Bronze Age seal from Alalakh the personal name *a-mu-sa-mi* (genitive) appears, which corresponds with the personal name *Ammusama* in the Akkadian cuneiform script; the value *mi* is represented here by the head of a woman¹¹²

¹⁰⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66.¹¹⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66.¹¹¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 134-135.¹¹² Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 134-135.

D 07

Side A: 3x
 Side B: 15x



Fig.: not identified (it is certainly not a helmet, for the cheek pieces are missing)¹¹³

Value: *sa*₂ (syllable)

Remarks: - the value *sa*₂ is based upon internal evidence, *i.e.* upon the appearance on the disc of the Luwian genitive form in *sa* (A 11, B 1, B 21, B 26)¹¹⁴
 - D 07, when used as a separate element, appears as preposition as well as postposition¹¹⁵

Luwian

counterpart: none

Other corresponding

sign: - possibly connected with the Egyptian hieroglyph which depicts a breast and is a determinative for “to suckle, to raise” (Egyptian *snk*)¹¹⁶

Origin: its function corresponds to the Akkadism *šA* used in Hittite texts¹¹⁷ with the sense of: “of (it)”

¹¹³ Woudhuizen 1992a, 29.

¹¹⁴ For an earlier suggestion *as*, cf. Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 73.

¹¹⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 65-66.

¹¹⁶ Gardiner 1957, 453, no. D 27*.

¹¹⁷ Woudhuizen 1992a, 31.

D 08

Side A: 1x
 Side B: 4x



Fig.: bandaged hand¹¹⁸

Value: *KATA* (logogram)¹¹⁹

Remarks: - the value is based upon the resemblance of the sign with a Luwian hieroglyph¹²⁰
 - boxers on a rhyton from Hagia Triada, dated c.1450 BC, wear resembling bandages¹²¹
 - children depicted on the south wall of room B 1 in sector B in Akrotiri (Thera) are boxing with these bandages, too¹²² (see Fig. 20)

Luwian counterpart:

L 57¹²³

Value: *KATA*¹²⁴

Origin: *katti-mi* is an old fossilized expression in Hittite with the sense: "under me"¹²⁵



¹¹⁸ Godart 1995, 127.

¹¹⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

¹²⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

¹²¹ Godart 1995, 126-127.

¹²² Marinatos 1973, 155.

¹²³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

¹²⁴ Laroche 1960, 36-37.

¹²⁵ Moran 1992, 165.

D 09

Side A: none

Side B: 2x

Fig.: crown or tiara¹²⁶Value: *har*₁ (syllable)¹²⁷

Remarks:

- the value is based upon external evidence because *har-ma-ha-sa* (B 27) shows a close resemblance to *harmahašši*- “of the head, of the chief” from the Luwian cuneiform script¹²⁸
- in Hittite inscriptions and on seals and rock carvings gods are depicted with this headgear, amongst others in room B of the shrine in Yazılıkaya from the reign of Tudhaliyas IV (1239–1209 BC) (see Fig. 21)
- there appears in Luwian Hieroglyphic a sign for tiara (L 17) (see Fig. 15), but this represents the value *HANTAWAT* “king”,¹²⁹

Luwian counterpart: none

**D 10**

Side A: 4x

Side B: none

Fig.: not identified

Value: *sa*₃ (syllable)¹³⁰Remark: - the value is based upon internal evidence¹³¹

Luwian counterpart: none

¹²⁶ Godart 1995, 127.¹²⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 73.¹²⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 73.¹²⁹ Woudhuizen 1992a, 17.¹³⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 73, former *sa*₂ = *sa*₃.¹³¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 73.

D 11

Side A: 1x
Side B: none

Fig.: with flower leaves embellished sun between wings¹³²
Remark: - on the disc this sign is turned 90°¹³³
Value: **sol suus** + **WASU** (winged sun + rosette)¹³⁴
Remarks: - the value is based upon the resemblance of the sign with a Luwian hieroglyph¹³⁵
- this sign is a ligature with the sense: “his majesty” (**sol suus**) + “hail” (**WASU**)¹³⁶

Luwian counterparts: L 190 (**sol suus**) and L 189 (rosette)¹³⁷



Values: **sol suus** (L 190) and **WASU, wa** (L 189)¹³⁸



Remarks: - the Hittite sovereigns place this sign above their name (in Luwian hieroglyphic script)¹³⁹ on disc-shaped seals (see Fig. 34a-d)
- this sign is the standard titular expression for Great Kings¹⁴⁰

Origin: this sign originates from the Egyptian hieroglyphic script;¹⁴¹ it is used there to crown scenes of the pharaoh, as, for example, on steles (see Fig. 34e)

¹³² Woudhuizen 1992a, 22; cf. Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 38, Fig. 2.

¹³³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

¹³⁴ Woudhuizen 1992a, 16-23.

¹³⁵ Woudhuizen 1992a, 16-17.

¹³⁶ Woudhuizen 1992a, 16-23.

¹³⁷ Woudhuizen 1992a, 16 and 22.

¹³⁸ Woudhuizen 1992a, 22-23.

¹³⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 38-39.

¹⁴⁰ Laroche 1960, discussion of L 190; cf. remarks p. 255.

¹⁴¹ Laroche 1960, discussion of L 190; cf. remarks p. 255.

D 12

Side A: 15x

Side B: 2x

Fig.: bread¹⁴²

Remarks: - a similar sign is depicted on the vase no. 14.276 found in Knossos¹⁴³

- this sign is often identified as a round shield, but round shields are only introduced in the Mediterranean from the thirteenth century BC onwards¹⁴⁴

Value: *tu* (syllable)¹⁴⁵

Remarks: - the value is based upon external and internal evidence,¹⁴⁶ but especially upon the analysis of a doublet and triplets¹⁴⁷ (see Fig. 35)

- the syllabic value *tu* is derived also from the logographic value *TURPI* of the Luwian counterpart L 181 according to the acrophonic principle¹⁴⁸

Luwian

counterpart: L 181¹⁴⁹Remark: - this is the Luwian sign for “bread”¹⁵⁰Value: *TURPI*¹⁵¹

Other corresponding

sign: - in the Cretan hieroglyphic script (nos. 074-075) (value: *tu*) (see Fig. 31)

¹⁴² Meriggi 1974, 218.

¹⁴³ Duhoux 1977, 15 and 79-80, Figs. 23-25.

¹⁴⁴ Drews 1993, 177-179.

¹⁴⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 55.

¹⁴⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 55.

¹⁴⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 31-34 and 43-48.

¹⁴⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 78.

¹⁴⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 46.

¹⁵⁰ Meriggi 1974, 218.

¹⁵¹ Laroche 1960, 95.

D 13

Side A: 3x

Side B: 3x

Fig.: not identified

Value: *mi*₁ (syllable)¹⁵²Remark: - the value is based upon external evidence¹⁵³

Luwian

counterpart: none

**D 14**

Side A: 1x

Side B: 1x

Fig.: two hills¹⁵⁴Remark: - on the disc this sign is turned 90°¹⁵⁵Value: *UTNA* (logogram)

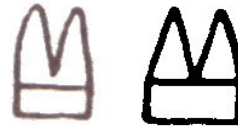
Remarks: - the value is based upon the resemblance of this sign with a Luwian hieroglyph¹⁵⁶

- *UTNA* renders the meaning “land, country, territory”

Luwian

counterparts: L 228 and L 230¹⁵⁷Values: *UTNA* (L 228) and *tu*₅ (L 230)¹⁵⁸

Remark: - *UTNA* (L 228) renders the meaning “land, country”



Other corresponding

signs: - in the Cretan hieroglyphic script (no. 034) (value: *UTNA*) (see Fig. 31)

- on a clay label (H 14) from the palace of Malia (see Fig. 26a, third sign from the left)

Origin: this is either a Sumerogram¹⁵⁹ or an Egyptian hieroglyph,¹⁶⁰ which later is taken over by the Luwians

¹⁵² Woudhuizen 1992a, 34.¹⁵³ Woudhuizen 1992a, 34.¹⁵⁴ Godart 1995, 129.¹⁵⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.¹⁵⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56; former *terra* = Luwian *UTNA*.¹⁵⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.¹⁵⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56; former *terra* = Luwian *UTNA*.¹⁵⁹ Van Binsbergen 1996-97, 146.¹⁶⁰ Best 1996-97, 110.

D 15

Side A: none
Side B: 1x

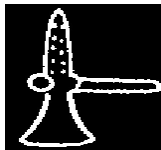


Fig.: axe¹⁶¹

Remark: - similar bronze objects are found in Phaistos¹⁶² and in Chamezi near Sitia¹⁶³

Value: **custos** (logogram)¹⁶⁴

Remarks: - the value is based upon external and internal evidence¹⁶⁵
- **custos** is a logogram with an unknown value denoting a dignitary¹⁶⁶ (not a sovereign but a lower functionary like a governor)

Luwian

counterparts: L 283 and L 284¹⁶⁷

Value: **custos**¹⁶⁸

Remark: - **custos** is a logogram with an unknown value denoting a dignitary,¹⁶⁹ see the Köylütolu text¹⁷⁰



Other corresponding

signs: - in the Cretan hieroglyphic script (no. 043) (value: **custos**) (see Fig. 31)

- on a tablet from Pylos (Ta 716.1) on which the Linear B ideogram no. 232 is attested, which depicts a similar axe;¹⁷¹ the value of this ideogram is not yet identified¹⁷² (see Fig. 22)

Origin: in meaning this sign is possibly comparable to the cuneiform *LÚ.GIŠ.TUKUL* (= royal person or high palace functionary)¹⁷³

¹⁶¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 124.

¹⁶² Pernier 1904, col. 467, Fig. 74.

¹⁶³ Godart 1995, 129.

¹⁶⁴ Woudhuizen 1994-95, 165.

¹⁶⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66; former *sceptrum* = *custos*.

¹⁶⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66; former *sceptrum* = *custos*.

¹⁶⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66.

¹⁶⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66; former *sceptrum* = *custos*.

¹⁶⁹ Masson 1980, 111-116.

¹⁷⁰ Woudhuizen 1994-95, 165.

¹⁷¹ Godart 1995, 129-130.

¹⁷² Chadwick 1987, 25, Fig. 9.

¹⁷³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 62.

D 16

Side A: none

Side B: 2x

Fig.: knife

Remark: on the disc this sign is turned 90°¹⁷⁴

Value: *LI*₁ (an abbreviation of Hittite *lingai*- “oath”¹⁷⁵ used as a determinative)

Remark: - the value is based upon the resemblance of this sign with a Luwian hieroglyph¹⁷⁶

Luwian

counterpart: L 278¹⁷⁷

Value: *li*¹⁷⁸



¹⁷⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

¹⁷⁵ Friedrich 1952, s.v.

¹⁷⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

¹⁷⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

¹⁷⁸ Laroche 1960, 146-147.

D 17

Side A: 1x
 Side B: none



Fig.: possibly signet-ring¹⁷⁹
 Remark: - on the disc this sign is turned 90°¹⁸⁰
 Value: ***imperium*** (logogram)¹⁸¹
 Remarks: - this logogram stands for domain of power
 - for parallels one can refer to the rings of Minos¹⁸² and Polykrates of Samos¹⁸³

Luwian

counterpart: BG 103¹⁸⁴

Remarks: - this is a signet-ring on a Luwian hieroglyphic stamp seal from the Old Hittite period (between 1680 and 1500 BC)
 - the central position of the ring on the seal suggests that we might be dealing with the title of an official (see Fig. 16)



Value: ***anulus***

Other corresponding

signs: - on Cretan hieroglyphic seals # 187 and # 301¹⁸⁵

¹⁷⁹ Cf. Olivier/Godart 1996, 218, # 187.

¹⁸⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

¹⁸¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56; former *TASHUWAR* = ***imperium***.

¹⁸² Pini, 1989, 1-4.

¹⁸³ Herodotos, *Histories* III, 39-43.

¹⁸⁴ A find by Fred Woudhuizen (Woudhuizen 2009, 26, see Boehmer/Güterbock 1987, no. 103).

¹⁸⁵ Olivier/Godart 1996, 218 and 280.

D 18

Side A: 6x
Side B: 6x



Fig.: not identified

Value: *sa* (syllable)¹⁸⁶

Remarks: - the value is based upon the resemblance of this sign with a Luwian hieroglyph¹⁸⁷
- this sign sometimes interchanges in the text with D 19¹⁸⁸

Luwian

counterparts: L 223¹⁸⁹ and in a Luwian text from the Iron Age on a stele base (right side) from Carchemish (c. 1200-1000 BC)



Values: *s*₆¹⁹⁰ and *sa*¹⁹¹

Other corresponding

sign: - in the Cretan hieroglyphic script (no. E 42)¹⁹² (value: *sa*) (see Fig. 31)

D 19

Side A: 3x
Side B: none



Fig.: not identified

Value: *sa*₁ (syllable)¹⁹³

Remarks: - the value is based upon internal evidence¹⁹⁴
- this sign sometimes interchanges in the text with D 18¹⁹⁵

Luwian

counterpart: none

Other corresponding

sign: - on the double-axe of Arkalochori from the late 15th or early 14th century BC (value: *sa*₁)¹⁹⁶ (see Fig. 28b, no. 3)

¹⁸⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 80.

¹⁸⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

¹⁸⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 65.

¹⁸⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56; the former comparison with L 415 should be deleted.

¹⁹⁰ Laroche 1960, 122.

¹⁹¹ A find by Fred Woudhuizen (see John Hawkins 2000, 177-178 and Plate 61).

¹⁹² For the numbers preceded by E, see Evans 1909.

¹⁹³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66.

¹⁹⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 65-66.

¹⁹⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66.

¹⁹⁶ Duhoux 1977, 15-16; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 73-74 and 100.

D 20

Side A: none

Side B: 2x

Fig.: not identified

Value: *ya*₁ (syllable)¹⁹⁷Remark: - the value is based upon internal evidence because this sign interchanges with D 40¹⁹⁸

Luwian

counterpart: none

D 21

Side A: 2x

Side B: none

Fig.: yoked pair of oxen with plough (logogram)¹⁹⁹Value: *jugum + aratrum* (yoke + plough) (logogram)²⁰⁰Remark: - *jugum + aratrum* is a logogram with an unknown value rendering the meaning: a yoked pair of oxen with a plough²⁰¹

Luwian

counterpart: none

Other corresponding

sign: - this sign appears also in seal impression HM 992 from the archive of Phaistos dating to the Old Palace period (Middle Minoan II; c. 1800–1700 BC)²⁰² (see Fig. 7b)¹⁹⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.¹⁹⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.¹⁹⁹ Woudhuizen 1992a, 39-40, Fig. 11.²⁰⁰ Woudhuizen 1992a, 36-37.²⁰¹ Hoffner 1974, 46; Woudhuizen 1992a, 39-40.²⁰² Godart 1995, 131-132.

D 22

Side A: none

Side B: 5x

Fig.: not identified

Value: *i* (syllabic vowel)²⁰³

Remarks: - the value is based upon vowel analysis²⁰⁴
 - this sign appears exclusively in first position, so it has to be a vowel, just like D 02: *a* and D 29: *u*²⁰⁵

Luwian

counterpart: none

Other corresponding

sign: - on the double-axe of Arkalochori from the late 15th or early 14th century BC in combination with an attached sign (value: *i* + *a*)²⁰⁶ (see Fig. 28a and b, nos. 6 + 7)

D 23

Side A: 5x

Side B: 6x

Fig.: not identified

Value: *ti* (syllable)²⁰⁷

Remarks: - the value is based upon internal evidence²⁰⁸ and upon a mistake of the scribe who in B 1 first filled in D 23 and changed that afterwards in D 12 (= *tu*)²⁰⁹
 - this sign interchanges in the text with D 32²¹⁰

Luwian

counterpart: none

²⁰³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 48.

²⁰⁴ Woudhuizen 1992a, 14.

²⁰⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 47-48.

²⁰⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 73-74 and 100.

²⁰⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 49.

²⁰⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 49.

²⁰⁹ Duhoux 1977, 34; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 82; Godart 1995, 104.

²¹⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 65.

D 24

Side A: 1x

Side B: 5x

Fig.: house²¹¹

Remark: - according to Mellink this sign looks much like houses and like graves in the form of a house in Lycia;²¹² this analysis is underlined by Godart²¹³

Value: *pa* (syllable)²¹⁴

Remark: - the syllabic value *pa* is derived from *PARNA* “house” according to the acrophonic principle²¹⁵

Luwian

counterpart: L 167 (parallel proposed by present authors)

Value: unknown

Other corresponding

signs: - on the altar-stone from Malia (value: *pa*)²¹⁶ (see Fig. 30, no. 9)
 - in the Cypro-Minoan script²¹⁷



²¹¹ Mellink 1964a, 1-7.

²¹² Mellink 1964a, 1-7; Mellink 1964b, 269-278; Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 37.

²¹³ Godart 1995, 133.

²¹⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

²¹⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

²¹⁶ Chapouthier 1938, 108; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 75-76.

²¹⁷ Cf. Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 122, Fig. 14, line 2, 7th sign from the left.

D 25

Side A: 2x

Side B: 5x

Fig.: ship²¹⁸Remark: - on the disc this sign is turned 90°, except in B 29²¹⁹Value: *na*₁ (syllable)²²⁰

Remark: - the value is based upon the hypothesis that *na*₁ is derived from the Indo-European root **nah₂w-* “ship” according to the acrophonic principle (cf. Carian: *nausso*; Greek: *naus*; Latin: *navis*)²²¹

Luwian

counterpart: L 35²²²

Remark: - the ship-sign recalls the earliest forms of L 35 (= *na*) on Luwian hieroglyphic seals from Boğazköy-Hattusa and Ras Shamra-Ugarit²²³

Value: *na*²²⁴

Other corresponding

signs: - on a Middle Bronze Age cylinder seal from Kültepe-Kanesh from c. 2000–1780 BC²²⁵ (see Fig. 29, lowest sign on the right)

- in the Cretan hieroglyphic script (no. 040) (value: *na*) (see Fig. 31)

- this type of ship, without a mast, appears once on clay tablet HT 11b with a Linear A inscription from Hagia Triada²²⁶ (see Fig. 23a, first sign on the second line)

- the closest parallel is a ship engraved on a golden ring from Mochlos (East Crete) dated c. 1450 BC (New Palace period)²²⁷ (see Fig. 23b)

²¹⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 37; Godart 1995, 134.

²¹⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 37 and 73.

²²⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 73; former *na* = *na*₁.

²²¹ Frisk 1970, s.v. *naus*; Brixhe 1982: 217, note 4; Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 73; Gamkrelidze/Ivanov 1995, II-125.

²²² Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 84, note 25.

²²³ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 84, note 25.

²²⁴ Laroche 1960, 25.

²²⁵ Garelli/Collon 1975, Pl. 48, no. 2.

²²⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 13.

²²⁷ Godart 1995, 134-135.

D 26

Side A: 5x

Side B: 1x

Fig.: horn

Value: *su* (syllable)²²⁸Remark: - the value is based upon the resemblance of this sign with a Luwian hieroglyph²²⁹

Luwian

counterpart: L 108²³⁰Values: *SURNA*, *sú*²³¹Remark: - the syllabic value *sú* is derived from the logographic value *SURNA* “horn” according to the acrophonic principle²³²**D 27**

Side A: 10x

Side B: 5x

Fig.: animal skin, probably ox-hide

Remarks: - on the disc in two instances this sign is turned 180° (A 29)
- this sign strongly reminds us of the Linear B ideogram no. 154, found only in Pylos²³³ (see Fig. 33)Value: *ku* (syllable)²³⁴Remark: - the syllabic value *ku* is derived from the logographic value ^{KUŠ}*kurša*, the Hittite word for “skin”, according to the acrophonic principle²³⁵

Luwian

counterpart: none

²²⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.²²⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.²³⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.²³¹ Laroche 1960, 69-70.²³² Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 81.²³³ Godart 1995, 135.²³⁴ Woudhuizen 1992a, 38.²³⁵ Woudhuizen 1992a, 38.

D 28

Side A: 2x
Side B: none



Fig.: lower leg with hoof

Remarks: - on the disc this sign is turned 180° or 90° as compared to its Luwian hieroglyphic counterpart²³⁶
- 5 seals in the form of a bull's leg with hoof are found in Malia and Lenta,²³⁷ but a seal in exactly the same form as this sign is found in Apodoulou in a level from about 1700 BC (Old Palace period)²³⁸ (see Fig. 24)

Value: *LI* (an abbreviation of Hittite *lingai*- "oath"²³⁹ used as a determinative)

Remark: - the value is based upon the resemblance of this sign with a Luwian hieroglyph²⁴⁰

Luwian counterpart: L 125²⁴¹

Value: *li*²⁴²

Other corresponding

sign: - in the Cretan hieroglyphic script (no. E 77) (value: *li*) (see Fig. 31)



²³⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

²³⁷ Yule 1981, see "hoves"; Godart 1995, 136.

²³⁸ Godart 1995, 136.

²³⁹ Friedrich 1952, s.v.

²⁴⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

²⁴¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

²⁴² Laroche 1960, 75-76.

D 29

Side A: 3x
Side B: 8x



Fig.: lion's head²⁴³

Value: *u* (syllabic vowel)²⁴⁴

Remarks:

- the value is based upon external and internal evidence²⁴⁵
- the syllabic value *u* is derived from the logographic value *WALWA*, the Luwian word for "lion", according to the acrophonic principle; this happens analogously to Luwian *WAWA* "ox", which acrophonically also leads to the value *u*²⁴⁶ (note in this connection that *u* and *wa* are interchangeable)
- this sign only appears in first position²⁴⁷
- when *u* appears as a separate element, it is used, like *a* in Luwian Hieroglyphic, as a sentence introductory particle²⁴⁸ with the function of a semicolon or a colon, followed by a statement or enumeration

Luwian

counterpart: L 97²⁴⁹

Values: *WALWA* "lion",²⁵⁰ *u*



Other corresponding

signs:

- on a Middle Bronze Age cylinder seal from Kültepe-Kanesh from c. 2000–1780 BC²⁵¹ (see Fig. 29, second sign from below on the right)
- on a Middle Bronze Age cylinder seal from North Syria (c. 2000–1700 BC) published by the Erlenmeyers (see Fig. 27, top row, second figure from the right)

²⁴³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 47.

²⁴⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 47-48.

²⁴⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 55.

²⁴⁶ Melchert 1993, 254, s.v.

²⁴⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 47.

²⁴⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 61.

²⁴⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 47-48.

²⁵⁰ Melchert 1993, 254, s.v.

²⁵¹ Garelli/Collon 1975, Pl. 48, no.2; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 133.

D 30

Side A: none
Side B: 1x



Fig.: ram's head
Remark: - on the disc this sign is turned 90°²⁵²
Value: *ma* (syllable)²⁵³
Remark: - the value is based upon the resemblance of this sign with a Luwian hieroglyph²⁵⁴

Luwian counterpart: L 110²⁵⁵
Value: *ma*²⁵⁶

**D 31**

Side A: 5x
Side B: none



Fig.: flying bird, possibly eagle with snake in his talons²⁵⁷
Remark: - on the disc this sign is turned twice 90° (A 9 and A 25) and once 180° (A 22)

Value: *ra* (syllable)²⁵⁸
Remark: - the value is based upon external and internal evidence²⁵⁹

Luwian counterparts: L 131 - L 134²⁶⁰
Values: *ARA*, *ar(a)*, *ra*²⁶¹



²⁵² Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

²⁵³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

²⁵⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

²⁵⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

²⁵⁶ Laroche 1960, 70-71.

²⁵⁷ Godart 1995, 136.

²⁵⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 67.

²⁵⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66-67.

²⁶⁰ Cf. also Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 67.

²⁶¹ Laroche 1960, 79-80; L 131 is used for the value *ARA* in the Emirgazi text; for the value *ra*, see Fig. 27, second column from the right, third sign from the top and cf. Woudhuizen, chapter 7, Table 1.

D 32

Side A: 2x

Side B: 1x

Fig.: bird, possibly dove²⁶²

Remark: - on the disc this sign is turned 90°

Value: ti_2 (syllable)²⁶³

Remarks: - the value is based upon external and internal evidence²⁶⁴
 - the syllabic value ti_2 is probably derived from *TINTAPU*, the Luwian word for a bird,²⁶⁵ according to the acrophonic principle
 - this sign interchanges in the text with D 23²⁶⁶

Luwian

counterpart: L 128²⁶⁷Values: i_6 , ta ? [= ti]²⁶⁸

Other corresponding

sign: - on a Middle Bronze Age cylinder seal from Kültepe-Kanesh from c. 2000–1780 BC²⁶⁹ (see Fig. 29, two identical top signs on the right)

²⁶² Godart 1995, 137.²⁶³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 49.²⁶⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66.²⁶⁵ Woudhuizen 1990-91, 148.²⁶⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66.²⁶⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66.²⁶⁸ Laroche 1960, 76-78.²⁶⁹ Garelli/Collon 1975, Pl. 48, no.2; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 133.

D 33

Side A: 2x

Side B: 4x

Fig.: fish, possibly tunny²⁷⁰

Remark: - on the disc this sign is turned 90°

Value: *wa* (syllable)²⁷¹

Remarks: - the value is based upon internal evidence²⁷²
 - when *wa* appears as a separate element (B 5), it has, like in Luwian, the function of a sentence introductory particle indicating direct speech²⁷³

Luwian

counterpart: L 138²⁷⁴

Value: unknown

Other corresponding

sign: - in the Cretan hieroglyphic script (no. E 59) (value: *wa*) (see Fig. 31)

**D 34**

Side A: 1x

Side B: 2x

Fig.: winged insect

Value: *ri* (syllable)²⁷⁵

Remark: - the value is based upon internal evidence and upon the fact that this sign is used to express the dative (viz. *uri*) of Luwian *ura*- "great"²⁷⁶

Luwian

counterpart: none

²⁷⁰ Godart 1995, 137.

²⁷¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

²⁷² Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

²⁷³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 61.

²⁷⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 59.

²⁷⁵ Woudhuizen 1992a, 38-39.

²⁷⁶ Woudhuizen 1992a, 38-39.

D 35

Side A: 5x

Side B: 6x



Fig.: plant, possibly ivy

Value: *ta* (syllable)²⁷⁷

Remark: - the value is based upon external and internal evidence, but especially on the analysis of a doublet and triplets²⁷⁸ (see Fig. 35)

Luwian
counterpart: none

D 36

Side A: none

Side B: 4x

Fig.: vine-tendrill²⁷⁹Value: *wi* (syllable)²⁸⁰

Remark: - the value is based upon the resemblance of this sign with a Luwian hieroglyph²⁸¹

Luwian
counterpart: L 160²⁸²

Values: *WIANA*, *wi*²⁸³

Remark: - the syllabic value *wi* is derived from the logographic value *WIANA* “vine” according to the acrophonic principle²⁸⁴



²⁷⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 81.

²⁷⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 43-49 and 65.

²⁷⁹ See also Godart 1995, 137.

²⁸⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

²⁸¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

²⁸² Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

²⁸³ Laroche 1960, 85-86.

²⁸⁴ Laroche 1960, 85-86.

D 37

Side A: 2x

Side B: 2x

Fig.: possibly papyrus²⁸⁵

Remark: - this possible papyrus sign closely resembles depictions of papyrus plants on wall-paintings of Akrotiri in Santorini/Thera²⁸⁶

Values: *DU* (determinative indicating a numeral), *du* (syllable)²⁸⁷

Remarks: - the value is based upon internal evidence²⁸⁸
 - on side A, D 37 is twice used as a determinative (*DU*), on side B it is twice used as a syllable (*du*), namely in a divine name (*Haddu*, B 3)²⁸⁹ and in a personal name (*Idumana*, B 9)²⁹⁰

Luwian

counterpart: none



²⁸⁵ Godart 1995, 138.

²⁸⁶ Godart 1995, 138.

²⁸⁷ Woudhuizen 1992a, 39.

²⁸⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 65-66; former *tu₁* = *du*.

²⁸⁹ Woudhuizen 1992a, 24.

²⁹⁰ Woudhuizen 1992a, 39.

D 38

Side A: 3x
Side B: 1x

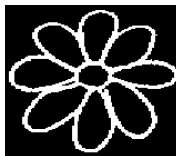


Fig.: rosette with eight petals²⁹¹

Remarks: - a rosette appears often in Minoan-Mycenaean art, such as the one painted on the body of a bull on sarcophagus 1710 in the cemetery at Armenoi (c. 1280 BC) (see Fig. 25)
- especially the rosette on a vase from Malia recalls D 38²⁹²
- also resembling this rosette with eight petals are the large flowers, decorating the rosette krater from Phaistos²⁹³
- prototypes of this floral motif were metallic, such as, for example, a golden flower with six petals found in the Chrysolakkos cemetery at Malia²⁹⁴ and a golden flower with eight petals found in a grave at Mochlos²⁹⁵ (both forming the head of a pin)

Value: *wa*₁ (syllable)²⁹⁶

Remarks: - the value is based upon external and internal evidence²⁹⁷
- the syllabic value *wa* is derived from the logographic value *WASU* “good, health” of the Luwian counterpart L 189 according to the acrophonic principle²⁹⁸

Luwian

counterpart: L 189²⁹⁹

Value: *WASU* “good”³⁰⁰



²⁹¹ Woudhuizen 1992a, 22; Godart 1995, 138.

²⁹² Evans 1909, 279; Godart 1995, 138.

²⁹³ Marinatos 1973, Pl. XII; Godart 1995, 138.

²⁹⁴ Poursat 1980, 130-131, Fig. 184; Godart 1995, 138.

²⁹⁵ Higgins 1973, 36.

²⁹⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 67.

²⁹⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66-67.

²⁹⁸ Woudhuizen 1992a, 22.

²⁹⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 67.

³⁰⁰ Laroche 1960, 99.

D 39

Side A: 1x

Side B: 3x

Fig.: symbol of lightning³⁰¹Remark: - in East Luwya the symbol of lightning stands for the storm-god³⁰²Values: *TARHU(NT)* (logogram), *ha* (syllable)³⁰³

Remarks: - the value is based upon the resemblance of this sign with a Luwian hieroglyph³⁰⁴

- *TARHU(NT)* is the East-Luwian indication of the storm-god during the late Bronze Age; in West Luwya the root of this name appears at that time as *TARKU*, written with the goat's head sign L 101 – an archaism recalling the situation on Middle Bronze Age seals from Cappadocia and North Syria³⁰⁵ (see Fig. 15)

Luwian

counterparts: L 196 and L 199³⁰⁶

Remark: - when the deity holds the symbol of lightning in his hand, there is a little handle underneath³⁰⁷

Values: *TARHU(NT)*, *ha*³⁰⁸³⁰¹ Woudhuizen 1992a, 6.³⁰² Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 37.³⁰³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.³⁰⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.³⁰⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 112-113.³⁰⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.³⁰⁷ See Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 38, Fig. 2.³⁰⁸ Laroche 1960, 104-109.

D 40

Side A: 3x

Side B: 3x

Fig.: not identified

Value: *ya* (syllable)³⁰⁹

Remark: - the value is based upon external evidence provided by Linear A *Payata* as attested for the text of the ring of Mavro Spelio³¹⁰ (see Fig. 8)

Luwian

counterpart: none

**D 41**

Side A: 2x

Side B: none

Fig.: possibly bone

Value: *ti*₃ (syllable)³¹¹

Remark: - the value is based upon external and internal evidence³¹²

Luwian

counterpart: none

**D 42**

Side A: none

Side B: 1x

Fig.: not identified

Value: *ma*₁ (syllable)³¹³

Remark: - the value is based only upon the unique appearance of this sign in the personal name *Idumana* (Idomeneus)³¹⁴ (see further chapter 6)

Luwian

counterpart: none



³⁰⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

³¹⁰ Oral information by Jan Best; cf. Godart/Olivier 1982, 152-153 (KN Zf 13).

³¹¹ Woudhuizen 1992a, 35 and 38; see also 36, A 10-11.

³¹² Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66.

³¹³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 76; former *ma*₂ = *ma*₁.

³¹⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 76.

D 43

Side A: none
Side B: 1x

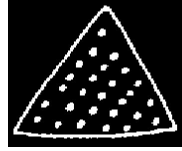


Fig.: not identified

Remark: - on the disc this sign is turned 180°³¹⁵

Value: *as* (syllable)³¹⁶

Remarks: - the value is based upon the resemblance of this sign with a Luwian hieroglyph³¹⁷
- the syllabic value *as* is derived from the logographic value *ASU* of the Luwian counterpart L 370 according to the acrophonic principle;³¹⁸ note that Luwian *ASU* is a loan from Hittite *aššu*

Luwian

counterpart: L 370³¹⁹

Values: *ASU*, (*a*)*su*³²⁰

Remarks: - the syllabic value (*a*)*su* is derived from the logographic value *ASU* according to the acrophonic principle³²¹
- the sequence VC is exceptional in Luwian Hieroglyphic and on the disc, but is explicable here as derivation of Hittite *aššu* according to the acrophonic principle



³¹⁵ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

³¹⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

³¹⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

³¹⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

³¹⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

³²⁰ Laroche 1960, 196-197.

³²¹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.

D 44

Side A: 1x
 Side B: none

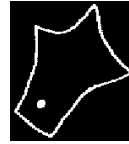


Fig.: not identified

Value: *ti*₄ (syllable)³²²

Remarks: - the value is based upon internal and external evidence³²³
 - this sign is used only once on the disc (A 7) in order to express the nominative of the personal pronoun of the 2nd person singular “you”³²⁴

Luwian counterparts: L 318 and L 319 and there is a parallel in a Luwian hieroglyphic text from Aleppo (M III A)³²⁵



Values: *TESUP, tes, té, tí*

³²² Woudhuizen 1992a, 35 and 38; see also 36, A 6-7.

³²³ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 66-67 and 1989, 90.

³²⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 67.

³²⁵ A find by Fred Woudhuizen (Woudhuizen 2009, 25, cf. Bossert 1954, 229, Fig 1).

D 45

Side A: 2x

Side B: 4x

Fig.: water³²⁶Remark: on the disc this sign is turned 90°³²⁷Value: *na* (syllable)³²⁸Remark: - the value is based upon the resemblance of this sign with a Luwian hieroglyph³²⁹

Luwian

counterparts: L 212 and L 214³³⁰Value: *ná*³³¹

Other corresponding

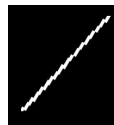
- signs:
- this sign, which reminds us of flowing water, corresponds conceptually to the Egyptian sign for flowing water (N 35) with initial value *n*³³² (see Fig. 32)
 - on a Middle Bronze Age cylinder seal from North Syria (c. 2000–1700 BC), published by Hogarth³³³
 - in the Cretan hieroglyphic script (no. 069) (value: *ná*) (see Fig. 31)

³²⁶ Godart 1995, 139.³²⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.³²⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.³²⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 56.³³⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 81; L 212 should be added to this reference.³³¹ Laroche 1960, 117.³³² Gardiner 1957, see N 35; Godart 1995, 139.³³³ Hogarth 1920, 65, see discussion of no.154; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 130-131, Fig. 11b.

D 46

Side A: 10x

Side B: 9x

Fig.: ‘thorn’³³⁴Remark: - this sign is not stamped, but incised by the scribe³³⁵Value: +*ti* (syllable)³³⁶

Remarks: - the value is based upon external and internal evidence, but especially upon the analysis of triplets³³⁷ (see Fig. 35)

- this sign always appears in last position of a word and is always attached to the preceding sign³³⁸

Luwian

counterpart: L 383, 2³³⁹

Remark: - this sign also is always attached to the preceding sign in the Luwian hieroglyphic script,³⁴⁰ but does not always occur in last position: it also can appear in middle position

Values: +*r(a/i)* (after supposed rhotacism from +*ta/ti*)³⁴¹

Other corresponding

sign: - on the double-axe of Arkalochori from the late 15th or early 14th century BC (values: +*ta/ti*)³⁴² (see Fig. 28b, no. 2)

Origin: the sign is typical for the Luwian hieroglyphic script³⁴³³³⁴ Woudhuizen 1992a, 23.³³⁵ Duhoux 1977, 43.³³⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 48.³³⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 43 and 48.³³⁸ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 46.³³⁹ Bossert 1932: 14-15; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 76-78.³⁴⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 46.³⁴¹ Laroche 1960, 204-206.³⁴² Duhoux 1977, 15-16; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 73-74 and 100.³⁴³ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 76.

D 47

Side A: 1x
 Side B: none



Fig.: oblique stripe (partly through sign D 45)

Remarks: - like D 46 this sign is not stamped, but incised by the scribe
 - that D 47 is a sign, is based upon the appearance of a resembling sign on the Disc of Vladikavkaz (see Appendix III), underneath sign D 29 and to the right of sign D 45, in the segment that corresponds with segment A 3 of the Disc of Phaistos

Value: ^l (determinative of a personal name)

Remark: - the value is based upon the relationship in form and value with a Luwian hieroglyph

Luwian

counterpart: L 383, 1

Value: ^l (determinative of a personal name)³⁴⁴



Other corresponding

signs: - the vertical nail in the Akkadian cuneiform script
 - the vertical nail in the Hittite cuneiform script

³⁴⁴ Laroche 1960, 204.

Conclusions

1. In total there are 261 signs on the disc (A: 133; B: 128).
2. 1 sign (the last one of A 8) obviously has been wiped out.
3. There are 47 different signs, of which 25 appear on both sides, 12 only on side A and 10 only on side B (see also paragraph 4.3).
4. 10 signs only appear 1x (see also paragraph 4.3).
5. Of the 47 signs 31 are related to Luwian hieroglyphic counterparts, for which category applies that similarity in form concurs with similarity in value – provided some small adaptations to the phonological rules of the respective languages (see table 1 on page 109).
6. The values of the remaining 16 signs are found by analysis of doublets, triplets and vowels, by interchange with other signs, by comparison with related languages or by starting from logic in the text.
7. Every sign has only one value, except D39.
8. Several signs can have the same value (see also paragraph 4.3).
9. With respect to the values of the signs, three basic categories can be distinguished: syllables, logograms and determinatives (a few have both a syllabic and a logographic value).
10. With respect to the syllables the pattern CV appears most, only rarely CVC and once VC.
11. With respect to the consonants sibilants and dentals appear the most.
12. With respect to the vowels *a* appears the most, followed by *u* and *i*.

4.3 The Distribution of the Signs over Side A and Side B

D 01	<i>SARU</i>	A: 1-11-15-21-26-30 B: 7-8-12-15-17
D 02	<i>a</i>	A: 1-5-8-10-12-14-16-17-19-20-22-23-26-29 B: 1-3-11-17-28
D 03	<i>har</i>	A: 28-31 B: none
D 04	<i>hi</i>	A: 5 B: none
D 05	<i>TIWA</i>	A: none B: 3
D 06	<i>mi</i>	A: 8-24 B: 16-28
D 07	<i>sa₂</i>	A: 3-6-11 B: 1-2-8-10-18-20-21-23-24(2x)-25-26-27-28-30
D 08	<i>KATA</i>	A: 7 B: 18-19-21-26
D 09	<i>har₁</i>	A: none B: 17-27
D 10	<i>sa₃</i>	A: 14-20-28-31 B: none
D 11	<i>sol suus</i> + <i>WASU</i>	A: 13 B: none
D 12	<i>tu</i>	A: 1-2-5-6-8-10-12-16-17-19-22-23-25-26-29 B: 1-5
D 13	<i>mi₁</i>	A: 1-26-30 B: 7-8-19
D 14	<i>UTNA</i>	A: 23 B: 14
D 15	<i>custos</i>	A: none B: 8
D 16	<i>LI₁</i>	A: none B: 6-14
D 17	<i>imperium</i>	A: 24 B: none
D 18	<i>sa</i>	A: 1-8-14-20-23-24 B: 6-8-14-23-25-27
D 19	<i>sa₁</i>	A: 10-24-27 B: none
D 20	<i>ya₁</i>	A: none B: 5-13

D 21	<i>jugum + aratrum</i>	A: 17-29 B: none
D 22	<i>i</i>	A: none B: 1-4-9-21-26
D 23	<i>ti₁</i>	A: 12-14-18-20-27 B: 3-6-22-25-28-29
D 24	<i>pa</i>	A: 2 B: 5-10-13(2x)-25
D 25	<i>na₁</i>	A: 14-20 B: 4-9-12-22-29
D 26	<i>su</i>	A: 9-16-19-22-25 B: 11
D 27	<i>ku</i>	A: 6-7-14-17(2x)-20-23(2x)-29(2x) B: 2-4-12-17-22
D 28	<i>LI</i>	A: 15-21 B: none
D 29	<i>u</i>	A: 3-4(2x) B: 13-15-18-19-20-21-26-29
D 30	<i>ma</i>	A: none B: 27
D 31	<i>ra</i>	A: 9-16-19-22-25 B: none
D 32	<i>ti₂</i>	A: 12-23 B: 16
D 33	<i>wa</i>	A: 5-18 B: 5-7-15-16
D 34	<i>ri</i>	A: 4 B: 22-29
D 35	<i>ta</i>	A: 9-10-17-27-29 B: 2-10-13-16-23-28
D 36	<i>wi</i>	A: none B: 11-18-21-26
D 37	<i>DU, du</i>	A: 17-29 B: 3-9
D 38	<i>wa₁</i>	A: 12-28-31 B: 12
D 39	<i>TARHU(NT), ha</i>	A: 13 B: 7-16-27
D 40	<i>ya</i>	A: 2-5-11 B: 1-10-11
D 41	<i>ti₃</i>	A: 10-11 B: none
D 42	<i>ma₁</i>	A: none B: 9

D 43	<i>as</i>	A: none
		B: 6
D 44	<i>ti</i> ₄	A: 7
		B: none
D 45	<i>na</i>	A: 3-6
		B: 2-20-24-30
D 46	<i>+ti</i>	A: 1-3-[7]-12-15-16-19-21-22-27
		B: 3-6-[8]-18-20-21-24-26-30
D 47	¹	A: 3
		B: none
Only on side A:		D 03-04-10-11-17-19-21-28-31-41-44-47
Only on side B:		D 05-09-15-16-20-22-30-36-42-43
Only appearing 1x:		D 04-05-11-15-17-30-42-43-44-47

Identical sound values

<i>har</i>	D 03	D 09			
<i>li</i>	D 16	D 28			
<i>ma</i>	D 30	D 42			
<i>mi</i>	D 06	D 13			
<i>na</i>	D 25	D 45			
<i>sa</i>	D 07	D 10	D 18	D 19	
<i>ti</i>	D 23	D 32	D 41	D 44	D 46
<i>wa</i>	D 33	D 38			
<i>ya</i>	D 20	D 40			

	a	i	u
			
y			
h			
k			
l			
m			
n			
p			
r			
s			
t/d			
w			

Fig. 14. Grid of the syllabic signs (CV) on the Disc of Phaistos. The same high frequency for the signs with sV and tV is attested in the signary of Luwian Hieroglyphic.

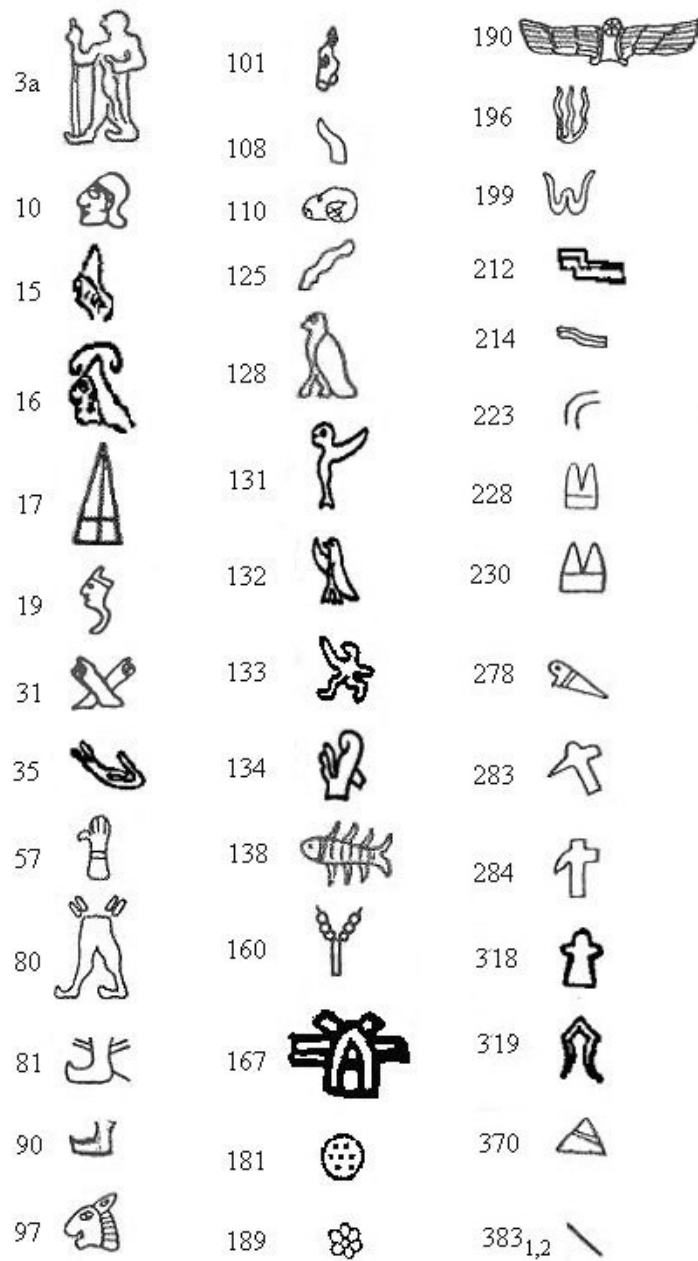
Fig. 15. Corresponding Luwian hieroglyphs (Laroche 1960, *passim*).



Fig. 16. Luwian stamp seal with a signet ring in the centre (Boehmer/Güterbock 1987, no. 103).

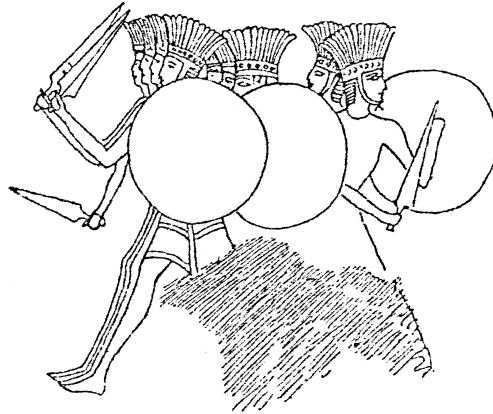


Fig. 17. Sea Peoples depicted in the temple of Ramesses III at Medinet Habu (Godart 1995, 121).



Fig. 18. Cretan with a tattoo in the form of an eight depicted in the tomb of Rekhmare (Godart 1995, 123).



a.



b.

Fig. 19. (a) Woman with bare breasts on a wall-painting from Knossos (detail of a reconstruction) (Bossert 1937, 127, Fig. 233).
(b) Bronze statuette of a Minoan woman with bare breasts and left arm bent over the left breast (Buchholz/Karageorghis 1973, Fig. 1224c).

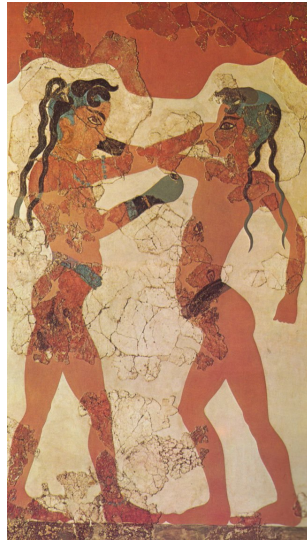


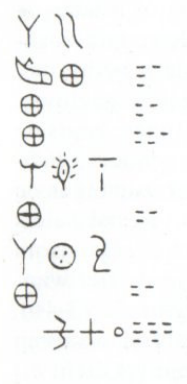
Fig. 20. Mural painting from Thera; the figure on the left wears boxing gloves (Petrakos 1981, b 158).



Fig. 21. Procession of Hittite gods with tiaras on their heads at Yazılıkaya (Godart 1995, 127).



Fig. 22. Linear B ideogram no. 232 on tablet Ta 716.1 from Pylos (Godart 1995, 129).



a.



b.

Fig. 23. (a) Clay tablet HT 11b with Linear A inscription from Hagia Triada (Brice 1961, see HT 11b) .
(b) Golden ring from Mochlos with the representation of a Cretan ship (c. 1450 BC) (Godart 1995, 134).



Fig. 24. Seal in the form of a bull's leg from Apodoulou dated c. 1700 BC (Old Palace period) (Godart 1995, 136).



Fig. 25. Bull with rosettes painted on its body, on sarcophagus 1710 from Armenoi (c. 1280 BC) (Godart 1995, 138).

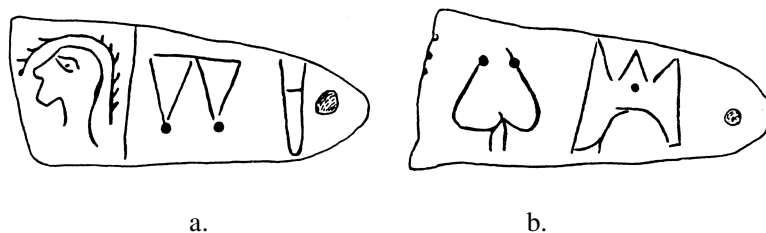


Fig. 26. Front (a) and back (b) of clay tablet H 14 from Malia with hieroglyphic inscription (Chapouthier 1930, 22, H 14).

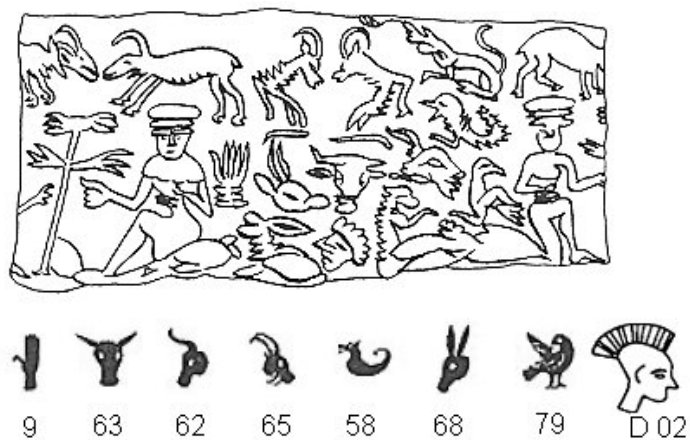


Fig. 27. North-Syrian seal from c. 2000–1700 BC published by the Erlenmeyers with corresponding Cretan signs, according to the numbering of Evans 1909 (Erlenmeyer 1965, 1–4; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 129, Fig. 11a).

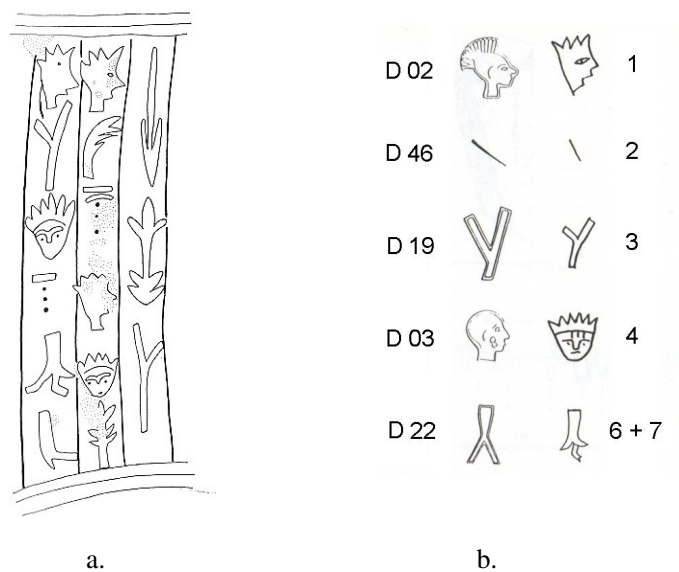


Fig. 28. (a) Inscription on the double-axe of Arkalochori (Bouphidis 1958, 62 ff.).
 (b) The corresponding signs of the Disc of Phaistos (left) and the double-axe of Arkalochori (right) (Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 74, Fig. 1b).



Fig. 29. Middle Bronze Age cylinder seal from the Assyrian trading colony of Kültepe-Kanesh in Cappadocia (c. 2000–1780 BC) (Garelli/Collon 1975, Pl. 48, no. 2).

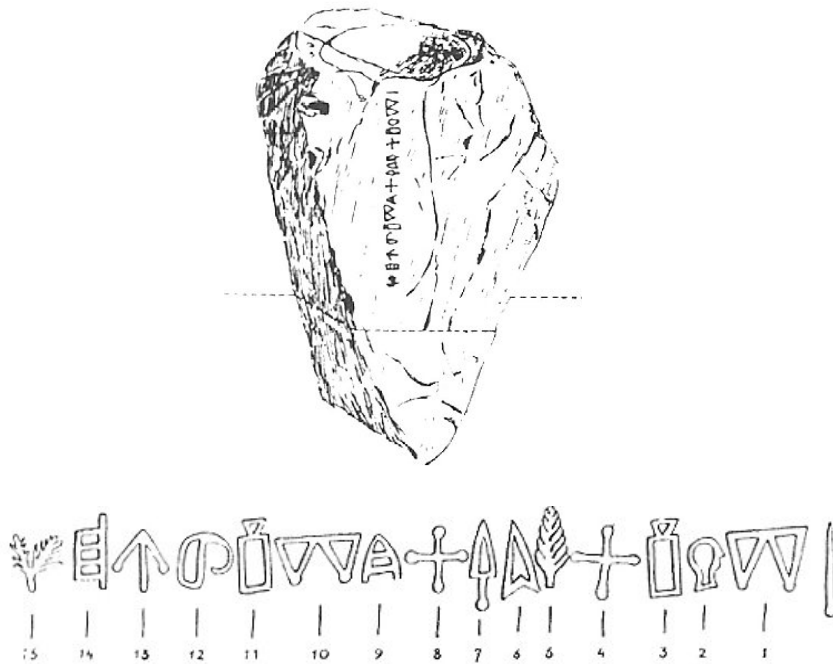


Fig. 30. The altar-stone from Malia with its inscription (Chapouthier 1938, 105).



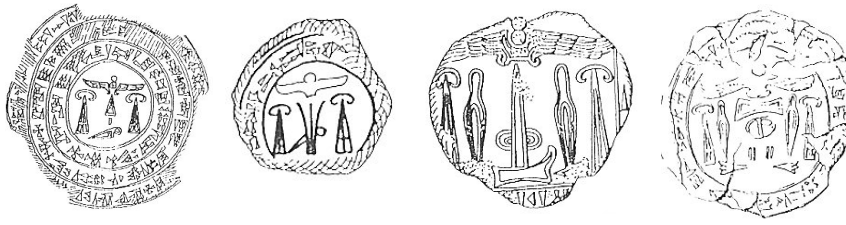
Fig. 31. Cretan hieroglyphic signs ([a] Evans 1909, 198, 204-205 and 210; [b] Olivier/Godart 1996, 17). (See for the values Appendix II).



Fig. 32. Egyptian hieroglyph for water, with, among others, the value *n* (Gardiner 1957, see N 35).



Fig. 33. Linear B sign 154 (Pylos) (Bennett Jr/Olivier 1973, Part I, 216).



a. Mursilis II. b. Hattusilis III. c. Tudhaliyas IV. d. Suppiluliumas II.



e. Stele of Tuthmoses III.

Fig. 34. (a-d) Disc seals from the Hittite Empire Period (c. 1344–1180 BC) (Beran 1967, no. 167 [d], no. 180 [a], no. 186 [b], no. 190 [c]; the sequence of the seals is adapted according to Laroche 1969-70, 94-98).
(e) An Egyptian stele of Tuthmoses III (1479–1425 BC) from the 18th dynasty (Lacau 1909: no. 34.010 Karnak, Pl. VII).

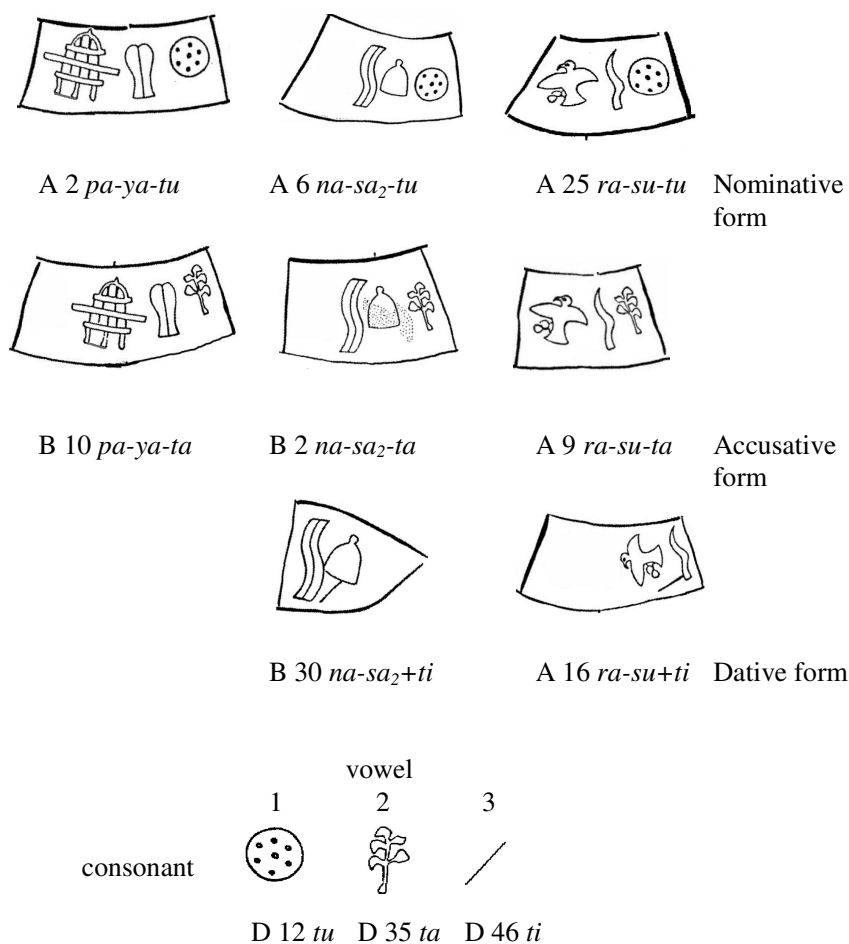
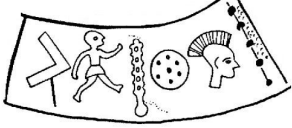
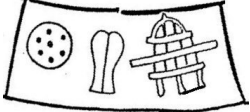
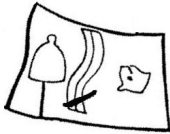
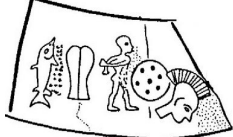
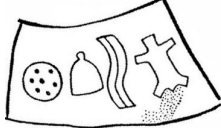
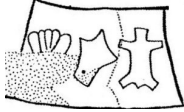


Fig. 35. Alternating final signs in recurrent combinations (1 doublet and 2 triplets) with the inflexion of the noun and underneath the symmetrical ordering in a grid (Woudhuizen 1992a, 13, Figs. 2a-b and 3). (Note that for a better understanding the segments above are represented mirrored here and that only the signs belonging to the doublet and the triplets are shown and the others omitted).

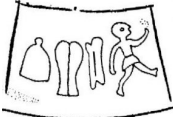
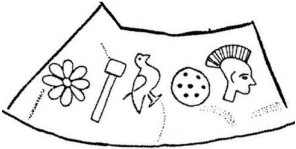
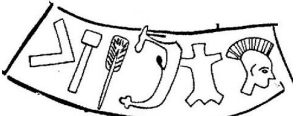
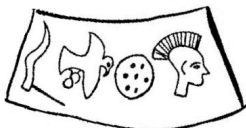
4.4 Transliteration of the Text Based upon the Values of the Signs

Side A (the signs are to be read from right to left)³⁴⁵

A 1		02-12 13-01 18+46 <i>a-tu mi₁-SARU sa+ti</i>
A 2		24-40-12 <i>pa-ya-tu</i>
A 3		29 47 45-07+46 <i>u / na-sa₂+ti</i>
A 4		29 29-34 <i>u u-ri</i>
A 5		02-12 04-40-33 <i>a-tu hi-ya-wa</i>
A 6		27 45-07-12 <i>ku na-sa₂-tu</i>
A 7		27 44 08 [+46] <i>ku ti₄ KATA[+ti]</i> ³⁴⁶

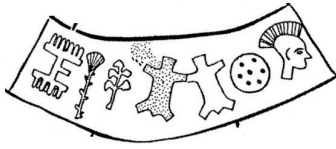
³⁴⁵ The source of the depicted segments with the signs is Godart 1995, 62 and 76. Only with respect to sign D 24 the middle and the right post of its lower side are connected, so that at the left a house entrance appears. This is more in agreement with the situation on the disc and concerns the segments A 2, B 5, B 10, B 13 (2x) and B 25 (see also Duhoux 1977, 59).

³⁴⁶ In the damaged part of A 7, sign D 46 must be reconstructed following sign D 08; on the one hand because it makes the text/translation logical, on the other hand because *KATA* on side B of the disc is also followed by the personal pronouns *ti* or *mi* (B 18, B 19), which latter combinations also appear in Luwian Hieroglyphic and Hittite Cuneiform (cf. Woudhuizen 1992a, 34).

A 8		02-12 06-18 {..} ³⁴⁷ <i>a-tu mi-sa</i>
A 9		31-26-35 <i>ra-su-ta</i>
A 10		02-12 41-19 35 <i>a-tu ti₃-sa₁ ta</i>
A 11		01 41-40-07 <i>SARU ti₃-ya-sa₂</i>
A 12		02-12-32 23-38+46 <i>a-tu-ti₂ ti₁-wa₁+ⁿti</i>
A 13		39 11 <i>TARHU(NT) sol suus+WASU</i>
A 14		02 27-25-10 23-18 <i>a ku-na₁-sa₃ ti₁-sa</i>
A 15		28 01+46 <i>^{LI} SARU+ti</i>
A 16		02-12 31-26+46 <i>a-tu ra-su+ti</i>

³⁴⁷ The last sign of A 8 obviously has been wiped out.

A 17



02-12 27-27-35
a-tu ku-ku-ta

37 21
^{DU} **jugum+aratrum**

A 18



33-23
wa-ti₁

A 19



02-12 31-26+46
a-tu ra-su+ti

A 20



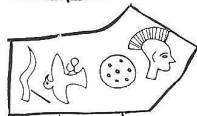
02 27-25-10 23-18
a ku-na₁-sa₃ ti₁-sa

A 21



28 01+46
^{LI} SARU+ti

A 22



02-12 31-26+46
a-tu ra-su+ti

A 23



02-12 27 14 32-18 27
a-tu ku UTNA ti₂-sa ku

A 24



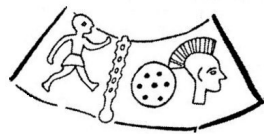
06-18 17-19
mi-sa **imperium**-sa₁

A 25



31-26-12
ra-su-tu

A 26



02-12 13-01
a-tu mi₁-SARU

A 27



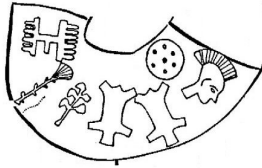
23-19 35+46
ti₁-sa₁ ta+ti

A 28



10-03-38
sa₃-har-wa₁

A 29



02-12 27-27-35
a-tu ku-ku-ta

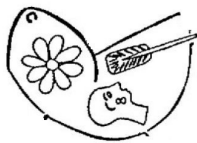
37 21
^{DU} jugum+aratum

A 30



13-01
mi₁-SARU

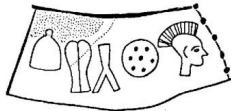
A 31



10-03-38
sa₃-har-wa₁

Side B

B 1



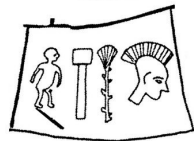
02-12 22-40-07
a-tu i-ya-sa₂

B 2

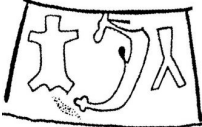
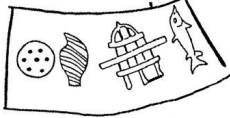
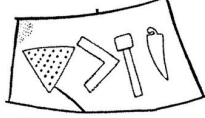
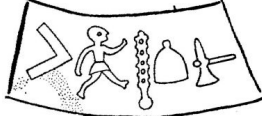
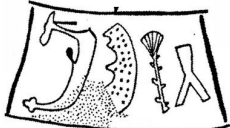
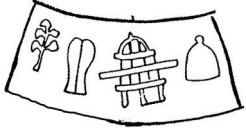
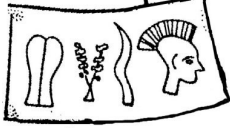
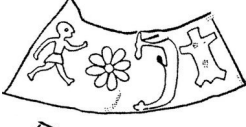
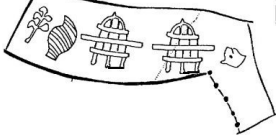


27 45-07-35
ku na-sa₂-ta

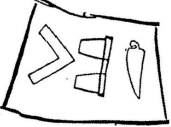
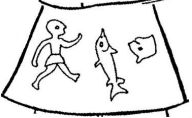
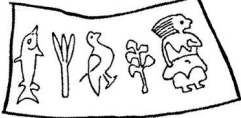
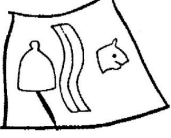
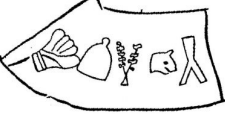
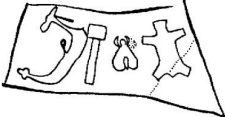
B 3



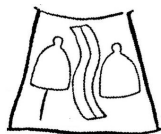
02-37-23 05+46
a-du-ti₁ TIWA+ti

B 4		22-25-27 <i>i-na₁-ku</i>
B 5		33 24-20-12 <i>wa pa-ya₁-tu</i>
B 6		16 23-18 43+46 <i>ti₁-sa as+ti</i>
B 7		13-01-39-33 <i>mi₁-SARU-ha-wa</i>
B 8		15 07 13-01 18[+46] ³⁴⁸ <i>custos sa₂ mi₁-SARU sa[+ti]</i>
B 9		22-37-42-25 <i>i-du-ma₁-na₁</i>
B 10		07 24-40-35 <i>sa₂ pa-ya-ta</i>
B 11		02-26-36-40 <i>a-su-wi-ya</i>
B 12		27-25-38 01 <i>ku-na₁-wa₁ SARU</i>
B 13		29-24 24-20-35 <i>u-pa pa-ya₁-ta</i>

³⁴⁸ At the end of B 8 sign D 46 must have stood at the damaged spot, considering A 1: 13-01-18-46. The damage is exactly on the spot where in A 1, D 46 is attached to D 18.

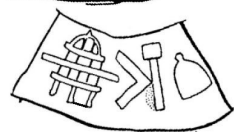
B 14		16 14-18 <i>LI</i> UTNA-sa
B 15		29-33 01 u-wa SARU
B 16		06 35-32-39-33 mi ta-ti ₂ -ha-wa
B 17		02-09-27 01 a-har ₁ -ku SARU
B 18		29-36-07 08+46 u-wi-sa ₂ KATA+ti
B 19		29 08-13 u KATA-mi ₁
B 20		29 45-07+46 u na-sa ₂ +ti
B 21		22 29-36-07 08+46 i u-wi-sa ₂ KATA+ti
B 22		27 34-23-25 ku ri-ti ₁ -na ₁
B 23		07 18-35 sa ₂ sa-ta

B 24



07 45-07+46
sa₂ na-sa₂+ti

B 25



07 23-18 24
sa₂ ti₁-sa pa

B 26



22 29-36-07 08+46
i u-wi-sa₂ KATA+ti

B 27



09-30-39-18 07
har₁-ma-ha-sa sa₂

B 28



02-06 35-23 07
a-mi ta-ti₁ sa₂

B 29



29 34-23-25
u ri-ti₁-na₁

B 30



45-07+46
na-sa₂+ti

5. THE TEXT

Lia Rietveld

Side A

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. <i>a-tu mi₁-SARU sa+ti</i> | “In the Mesara is |
| 2. <i>pa-ya-tu</i> | Phaistos.” |
| <i>a-tu</i> | : preposition + dative/ø, “in” |
| <i>mi₁-SARU</i> | : geographical name, undeclined, ³⁴⁹
“Mesara” (plain in South Crete) |
| <i>sa+ti</i> | : 3rd person singular, present tense, “is”, of
the verb stem (<i>a</i>) <i>sa-</i> “to be” |
| <i>pa-ya-tu</i> | : place-name, undeclined, ³⁵⁰ “Phaistos”
(South Crete) |
| 3. <i>u' na-sa₂+ti</i> | “: To Nestor: |
| 4. <i>u u-ri</i> | great (man) |
| 5. <i>a-tu hi-ya-wa</i> | in Achaia.” |
| <i>u</i> | : introductory particle |
| <i>' na-sa₂+ti</i> | : personal name, dative, “Nestor” |
| <i>u</i> | : introductory particle |
| <i>u-ri</i> | : adjective, dative singular, “great (man)” |
| <i>a-tu</i> | : preposition + dative/ø, “in” |
| <i>hi-ya-wa</i> ³⁵¹ | : geographical name, undeclined, “Achaia” |

³⁴⁹ There is often no ending after a logogram (also in Luwian Hieroglyphic from the Late Bronze Age; see John Hawkins 1995, *passim*).

³⁵⁰ The forms with stem-final *-u/-a* are undeclined, in the sense that the endings of the nominative and accusative forms may be suppressed in the spelling as is common in LBA Luwian Hieroglyphic and in Linear B. This concerns names that in Linear B have a stem-final *-o* (e.g. *Paito*). In Cretan Hieroglyphic [o] is not written, but is represented by [a] or [u]. Also Luwian does not have [o]. See for instance A 9/A 25 *Rasuta/Rasutu* and A 6/B 2 *Nasatu/Nasata*: forms with stem-final *-u* and *-a* with the same function in the sentence. See also paragraph 6.3 on the forms with stem-final *-u/-a*.

³⁵¹ The vowel [a] is left out at the beginning of the word. This is called ‘aphaeresis’ and this occurs often in Luwian; *Attarima* is rendered as *Titarma* (see chapter 7, remark 3). In the hieroglyphic text of the bilingual from Çineköy the geographical name *Hiāwa* appears. This can be equated to *Ahhiyawa* in Hittite texts (Tekoğlu/Lemaire 2000, 982-984). Another occurrence of the geographical name Hiyawa is found in two Akkadian excerpts, written about 1200 BC, in which the Hittite king Suppiluliumas II and a Hittite court official Pentišarruma instruct Ammurapi, king of Ugarit to ship PAD.MEŠ (metal ingots[?]) to Hiyawamen (LÚ.MEŠ *Hi-ya-ú-wi-i*) in Lukka (Yakubovich 2008, 189, his source: Singer 2006, 250), see paragraph 6.4.

6. *ku na-sa₂-tu* “What Nestor (has),
 7. *ku ti₄ KATA[+ti]* what you (have) under [you],”
- ku* : relative pronoun, accusative singular
 neuter, “what”
na-sa₂-tu : personal name, undeclined,³⁵² “Nestor”
ku : relative pronoun, accusative singular
 neuter, “what”
ti₄ : personal pronoun, 2nd person singular,
 nominative,³⁵³ “you”
*KATA[+ti]*³⁵⁴ : preposition + dative, “under”; *-ti*: enclitic
 personal pronoun, 2nd person singular,
 dative, “you”
8. *a-tu mi-sa {..}* “in my (territory),
 9. *ra-su-ta* Lasithi,”
- a-tu* : preposition + dative/ø, “in”
mi-sa : possessive pronoun, 1st person singular,
 genitive, “my”
{..} : this sign has been wiped out
ra-su-ta : geographical name, undeclined,³⁵⁵
 “Lasithi” (region in Central Crete)
10. *a-tu ti₃-sa₁ ta* “in yours and
 11. *SARU ti₃-ya-sa₂* (that) of your king.”
- a-tu* : preposition + dative/ø, “in”
ti₃-sa₁ : personal pronoun, 2nd person singular,
 genitive, nominal use, “(that of) you”
ta : conjunction, “and”
SARU : noun, undeclined, “king”

³⁵² See note 350.

³⁵³ This pronoun can also be read as enclitic *-ti*, a possessive dative, “what is for you”, which means the same as “what you have”. This dative also occurs in Hittite (Friedrich 1960, 121).

³⁵⁴ Rost (1956, 337) calls *-mi* in *katti-mi* (in Amarna-letter EA 31 in Hittite, from the king of Egypt to the king of Arzawa) a normal form of the possessive pronoun in Hittite. But there may be a relation to “the Arzawan dialect” (Sturtevant 1951, §173). Arzawa was a Luwian region, where the sender of the text of the Disc of Phaistos possibly came from (see chapter 8 and Appendix I.5). In the Yalburt and Südburg texts (in Luwian Hieroglyphic) Woudhuizen (1994-95) also discovered the use of *KATA+mi* (Yalburt: phrase 14 and Südburg: phrase 3). See also note 413.

³⁵⁵ See note 350.

- ti*₃-*ya-sa*₂ : *ti*- possessive pronoun, 2nd person singular, “your”, -y- glide,³⁵⁶ -*asa* adjectival genitive suffix; with *SARU* nominal use of the adjective, “(that) of your king”
12. *a-tu-ti*₂ *ti*₁-*wa*₁+ⁿ*ti* “In you Tarhunt and His Majesty bring
13. *TARHU(NT)* ***sol suus*** +*WASU* hail.”
- a-tu* : preposition + dative/ø, “in”
- ti*₂ : enclitic personal pronoun, 2nd person singular, dative, “you”
- ti*₁-*wa*₁+ⁿ*ti* : 3rd person plural, present tense, “bring”, of the verb stem *tiwa*- “to bring”
- TARHU(NT)* : lightning (East-Luwian),³⁵⁷ symbol of the storm-god
- sol suus*** +*WASU* : ligature of two nouns, undeclined: “His Majesty” (the Great King of Arzawa),³⁵⁸ + “hail”
14. *a ku-na*₁-*sa*₃ *ti*₁-*sa* “: Knossos (is) yours,
15. ^L*SARU*+*ti* (it is) part of the kingship of the oath
16. *a-tu ra-su*+*ti* in Lasithi,”
- a* : introductory particle
- ku-na*₁-*sa*₃ : place-name, undeclined, “Knossos” (Central/North Crete)
- ti*₁-*sa* : personal pronoun, 2nd person singular, genitive, “you”
- ^L*SARU*+*ti* : noun, Akkadian partitive genitive singular, “kingship of the oath”; ^L: abbreviation of the Hittite concept *lingai*- “oath”,³⁵⁹ used as determinative
- a-tu* : preposition + dative/ø, “in”
- ra-su*+*ti* : geographical name, dative, “Lasithi” (region in Central Crete)

³⁵⁶ If the vowel [i] is followed by the vowel [a], then in Luwian Cuneiform a glide -y- comes in between (Laroche 1959, 133). Here the stem-final -i is followed by -asa.

³⁵⁷ In West-Luwian a goat’s head is the symbol for this god (Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 112-113).

³⁵⁸ The sender of this letter; indication of his realm in B 11: *Asuwiya*, see chapter 8 and Appendix I.5 on this name.

³⁵⁹ ^L: examples for words accompanied by a syllabic sign (which is an abbreviation of a word) used for specification are present in Linear A (in ligature ideogram + syllabic sign: GRA+ku, GRA+qe and GRA+da; Meijer 1982, 83) and B (ideogram + syllabic sign: OIL+WE and OIL+A; Palmer 1963, 9 and 11).

17. *a-tu ku-ku-ta* “in whatever (territory) where a yoke of two
^{DU} *jugum + aratrum* oxen ploughs
 18. *wa-ti₁* for the town
 19. *a-tu ra-su+ti* in Lasithi.”
- a-tu* : preposition + dative/ø, “in”
ku-ku-ta : indefinite pronoun, undeclined, neuter
 “whatever”
^{DU} *jugum* : the combination “yoke of two oxen +
+ aratrum plough” (noun) possibly means
 “ploughland”; ^{DU}: numeral, “two”, used as
 determinative³⁶⁰
wa-ti₁ : noun, dative singular, “town” (Knossos)
a-tu : preposition + dative/ø, “in”
ra-su+ti : geographical name, dative, “Lasithi”
 (region in Central Crete)
20. *a ku-na₁-sa₃ ti₁-sa* “: Knossos (is) yours,
 21. ^{LI} *SARU+ti* (it is) part of the kingship of the oath
 22. *a-tu ra-su+ti* in Lasithi,”
- A 20 + 21 + 22 = A 14 + 15 + 16
23. *a-tu ku UTNA ti₂-sa ku* “in what territory of yours, what
 24. *mi-sa imperium-sa* (is) part of my dominion,
 25. *ra-su-tu* (namely:) Lasithi.”
- a-tu* : preposition + dative/ø, “in”
ku : relative pronoun, undeclined, neuter,
 “what”, used attributively (with *UTNA*)
UTNA : noun, undeclined, “territory”
ti₂-sa : personal pronoun, 2nd person singular,
 genitive, “you”
ku : relative pronoun, nominative singular
 neuter, refers to *ku UTNA* “what territory,
 what”
mi-sa : possessive pronoun, 1st person singular,
 genitive, “my”
imperium-sa : noun, partitive genitive singular, “part of
 the dominion”
ra-su-tu : geographical name, undeclined,³⁶¹
 “Lasithi” (region in Central Crete)

³⁶⁰ See note 359.³⁶¹ See note 350.

26. *a-tu mi₁-SARU* “In the Mesara
 27. *ti₁-sa₁ ta+ti* (is) yours and for you:
 28. *sa₃-har-wa₁* Scheria,”
- a-tu* : preposition + dative/ø, “in”
mi₁-SARU : geographical name, undeclined: “Mesara”
 (plain in South Crete)
ti₁-sa₁ : personal pronoun, 2nd person singular,
 genitive, “you”
ta : conjunction, “and”
+ti : enclitic personal pronoun, 2nd person
 singular, dative, “you”
sa₃-har-wa₁ : place-name, undeclined, “Scheria” (South
 Crete)
29. *a-tu ku-ku-ta* “in whatever (territory) where a yoke of two
^{DU}jugum +arattrum oxen ploughs,”
- Cf. A 17.
30. *mi₁-SARU* “(in) the Mesara,
 31. *sa₃-har-wa₁* (for) Scheria.”
- mi₁-SARU* : geographical name, undeclined: “Mesara”
 (plain in South Crete)
sa₃-har-wa₁ : place-name, undeclined, “Scheria” (South
 Crete)
- Same construction (after A 29 = A 17) as in
 A 18 + 19, but now region first and town
 last. Because of lack of space *atu* is not
 repeated.³⁶²

Side B

1. *a-tu i-ya-sa₂* “In (the territory) of this,
 2. *ku na-sa₂-ta* what Nestor (has).”
- a-tu* : preposition + dative/ø, “in”
i-ya-sa₂ : *i-* demonstrative pronoun, singular, “this”,
 -y- glide,³⁶³ -asa, adjectival genitive suffix,

³⁶² See Appendix I.4.

³⁶³ See note 356.

		nominal use of the adjective; refers to the last mentioned region on side A: the Mesara, about which side B continues
	<i>ku</i>	: relative pronoun, accusative singular neuter, “what”
	<i>na-sa₂-ta</i>	: personal name, undeclined, ³⁶⁴ “Nestor”
3.	<i>a-du-ti₁ TIWA+ti</i>	“Haddu brings you
4.	<i>i-na₁-ku</i>	life.”
	<i>a-du</i>	: Phoenician storm-god, nominative, “Haddu”
	<i>-ti₁</i>	: enclitic personal pronoun, 2nd person singular, dative, “you”
	<i>TIWA+ti</i>	: 3rd person singular, present tense, “brings”, of the verb stem <i>tiwa-</i> “to bring”
	<i>i-na₁-ku</i>	: noun, undeclined, “life”
5.	<i>wa pa-ya₁-tu</i>	“Phaistos
6.	<i>^{LI}ti₁-sa as+ti</i>	is of your (territory by) oath,
7.	<i>mi₁-SARU-ha-wa</i>	and the Mesara.”
	<i>wa</i>	: introductory particle of direct speech ³⁶⁵
	<i>pa-ya₁-tu</i>	: place-name, undeclined, “Phaistos” (South Crete)
	<i>^{LI}ti₁-sa</i>	: personal pronoun, 2nd person singular, genitive, nominal use; ^{LI} : abbreviation of the Hittite concept <i>lingai-</i> “oath” ³⁶⁶ , used as determinative: “yours by oath”
	<i>as+ti</i> ³⁶⁷	: 3rd person singular, present tense, “is”, of the verb stem (<i>a</i>) <i>sa-</i> “to be”
	<i>mi₁-SARU</i>	: geographical name, undeclined, “Mesara” (plain in South Crete)
	<i>-ha-wa</i>	: enclitic conjunction, “and”

³⁶⁴ See note 350.

³⁶⁵ Possibly the announcement of a direct quotation from the original letter of the Great King.

³⁶⁶ See note 359.

³⁶⁷ The sign of a triangle in Luwian Hieroglyphic (LH) is similar to the sign on the disc (see paragraph 4.2, D 43). The sign does not render Luwian *WASU*, as one might have expected, but Hittite *aššu*; both words mean “good”. However, this is the only syllabogram of the type Vowel - Consonant (VC). John Hawkins (1986, 374) saw that Linear B and LH are typologically similar in consisting, besides the vowel signs, of syllabograms of the type CV (+ CV occasionally) only (this in contrast to the cuneiform syllabary). So the Disc of Phaistos (PD) is typologically similar to Linear B and LH.

8. *custos sa₂ mi₁-SARU sa[+ti]* “Governor of the Mesara [is]
 9. *i-du-ma₁-na₁* Idomeneus.”
- custos* : noun, undeclined, “governor”³⁶⁸
sa₂ : Akkadian preposition (+ genitive/ø),
 “of”³⁶⁹
mi₁-SARU : geographical name, undeclined, “Mesara”
 (plain in South Crete)
sa[+ti] : 3rd person singular, present tense, “is”, of
 the verb stem (*a*)*sa-* “to be”
i-du-ma₁-na₁ : personal name, undeclined, “Idomeneus”
10. *sa₂ pa-ya-ta* “Of the Assuwian Phaistos
 11. *a-su-wi-ya* Kuneus (is) king.”
 12. *ku-na₁-wa₁ SARU*
- sa₂* : Akkadian preposition + genitive/ø, “of”³⁷⁰
pa-ya-ta : place-name, undeclined, “Phaistos” (South
 Crete)
a-su-wi-ya : adjective of the geographical name
 “Assuwa” (Southwest Anatolia), -*ya*
 adjectival suffix, undeclined
ku-na₁-wa₁ : personal name, undeclined, “Kuneus”
SARU : noun, undeclined, “king”
13. *u-pa pa-ya₁-ta* “Of the oath (bound) territory behind
 14. ^{LI₁} *UTNA-sa* Phaistos
 15. *u-wa SARU* Uwas (is) king,”
- u-pa* : preposition + ø, “behind, after”
pa-ya₁-ta : place-name, undeclined, “Phaistos” (South
 Crete)
^{LI₁} *UTNA-sa* : noun, genitive singular; ^{LI₁}: abbreviation of
 the Hittite concept *lingai-* “oath”, used as
 determinative; “oath (bound) territory”
u-wa : personal name, undeclined, “Uwas”
SARU : noun, undeclined, “king”

³⁶⁸ A higher rank than a *SARU* (in B 12, 15 and 17).

³⁶⁹ No ending to the word ruled by *sa*. An equivalent of *sa* also appears often in Hittite texts. It is an Akkadian loanword. It is used here in the same manner as in Hittite: the word ruled by it receives a genitive ending or, like here, no ending (Friedrich 1946, 341). In transcriptions of Hittite the Akkadian counterpart of our *sa* is written in capital italics, although not here, because then *sa₂* (the syllable) would appear next to ŠA (the Akkadian word).

³⁷⁰ No ending to the word ruled by *sa* (see note 369). See also note 350 for stem-final -*u/-a*.

<i>ri-ti₁-na₁</i>	: place-name, undeclined, “Rhytion” (South Crete)
<i>sa₂</i>	: Akkadian preposition + genitive/ø, “of”, nominal use, “of it” (of the territory)
<i>sa-ta</i>	: 3rd person singular, past tense, “was”, of the verb stem (<i>a</i>) <i>sa</i> - “to be”
<i>sa₂</i>	: Akkadian preposition + genitive/ø, “of”, nominal use, “of it” (of the territory)
<i>na-sa₂+ti</i>	: personal name, dative, “Nestor”
<i>sa₂</i>	: Akkadian preposition + genitive/ø, “of”, nominal use, “of it” (of the territory)
<i>ti₁-sa</i>	: personal pronoun, 2nd person singular, genitive, “you”
<i>pa</i>	: demonstrative pronoun, nominative neuter, “that there” ³⁷²
26. <i>i u-wi-sa₂ KATA+ti</i>	“This of you under you (was)
27. <i>har₁-ma-ha-sa sa₂</i>	of it of the man,
28. <i>a-mi ta-ti₁ sa₂</i>	of it for my father.” ³⁷³
26	: See B 21.
<i>har₁-ma-ha-sa₂</i>	: adjective of <i>harmahi</i> - “man, governor”, - <i>asa</i> adjectival genitive suffix, “of ...” ³⁷⁴
<i>sa₂</i>	: Akkadian preposition + genitive/ø, “of”, here postposition, nominal use, “of it”
<i>a-mi</i>	: = <i>mi</i> , possessive pronoun, 1st person singular, dative, “mine”
<i>ta-ti₁</i>	: noun, dative singular, “father”
<i>sa₂</i>	: Akkadian preposition + genitive/ø, “of”, here postposition, nominal use, “of it”
29. <i>u ri-ti₁-na₁</i>	“: Rhytion
30. <i>na-sa₂+ti</i>	(is) for Nestor.”
<i>u</i>	: introductory particle
<i>ri-ti₁-na₁</i>	: place-name, undeclined, “Rhytion” (South Crete)
<i>na-sa₂+ti</i>	: personal name, dative, “Nestor”

³⁷² For stress *pa* is placed at the end (*pa* refers to Ritina).

³⁷³ B 24. *sa nasati* B 27. *harmahasa sa*
B 25. *sa tisa pa* B 28. *ami tati sa*

This is a chiasma: for a change *sa* is first placed in front and later at the end.

³⁷⁴ *harmahasa*: “of the man”, *ami tati*: “for my father”. The man: Acharkis, refers to B 16 and B 17 (Acharkis was king for my father).

Side A

1. *a-tu mi₁-SARU sa+ti* 2. *pa-ya-tu* “In the Mesara is Phaistos.”
 3. *u’na-sa₂+ti* “: To Nestor
 4. *u u-ri* 5. *a-tu hi-ya-wa* : great (man) in Achaia,”
 6. *ku na-sa₂-tu* “What Nestor (has),
 7. *ku ti₄ KATA[+ti]* what you (have) under [you],”
 8. *a-tu mi-sa {..}* 9. *ra-su-ta* “in my (territory), Lasithi,”
 10. *a-tu ti₃-sa₁ ta* 11. *SARU ti₃-ya-sa₂* “in yours and (that) of your king.”
 12. *a-tu-ti₂ ti₁-wa₁+ⁿti* “In you Tarhunt and His Majesty
 13. *TARHU(NT) sol suus +WASU* bring hail.”
 14. *a ku-na₁-sa₃ ti₁-sa* “: Knossos (is) yours,
 15. ^L*SARU+ti* (it is) part of the kingship of the oath
 16. *a-tu ra-su+ti* in Lasithi,”
 17. *a-tu ku-ku-ta^{DU}jugum+aratum* “in whatever (territory) where a yoke
 of two oxen ploughs
 18. *wa-ti₁* 19. *a-tu ra-su+ti* for the town in Lasithi.”
 20. *a ku-na₁-sa₃ ti₁-sa* “: Knossos (is) yours,
 21. ^L*SARU+ti* (it is) part of the kingship of the oath
 22. *a-tu ra-su+ti* in Lasithi,”
 23. *a-tu ku UTNA ti₂-sa ku* “in what territory of yours, what
 24. *mi-sa imperium-sa* (is) part of my dominion,
 25. *ra-su-tu* (namely:) Lasithi.”
 26. *a-tu mi₁-SARU* 27. *ti₁-sa₁ ta+ti* “In the Mesara (is) yours and for you:
 28. *sa₃-har-wa₁* Scheria,”
 29. *a-tu ku-ku-ta^{DU}jugum+aratum* “in whatever (territory) where a yoke
 of two oxen ploughs,”
 30. *mi₁- SARU* 31. *sa₃-har-wa₁* “(in) the Mesara, (for) Scheria.”

Side B

1. *a-tu i-ya-sa₂* “In (the territory) of this,
 2. *ku na-sa₂-ta* what Nestor (has).”
 3. *a-du-ti₁ TIWA+ti* 4. *i-na₁-ku* “Haddu brings you life.”
 5. *wa pa-ya₁-tu* 6. ^L*ti₁-sa as+ti* “Phaistos is of your (territory by)
 oath,
 7. *mi₁-SARU-ha-wa* and the Mesara.”
 8. *custos sa₂ mi₁-SARU sa[+ti]* “Governor of the Mesara [is]
 9. *i-du-ma₁-na₁* Idomeneus.”
 10. *sa₂ pa-ya-ta* 11. *a-su-wi-ya* “Of the Assuwian Phaistos
 12. *ku-na₁-wa₁ SARU* Kuneus (is) king.”
 13. *u-pa pa-ya₁-ta* 14. ^L*UTNA-sa* “Of the oath (bound) territory behind
 Phaistos
 15. *u-wa SARU* Uwas (is) king,”

-
- | | |
|--|--|
| 16. <i>mi ta-ti₂-ha-wa</i> | “and for my father |
| 17. <i>a-har₁-ku SARU</i> | Acharkis (was) king.” |
| 18. <i>u-wi-sa₂ KATA+ti</i> | “Yours under you, : under me, |
| 19. <i>u KATA-mi₁</i> | : for Nestor, |
| 20. <i>u na-sa₂+ti</i> | this (is) yours under you.” |
| 21. <i>i u-wi-sa₂ KATA+ti</i> | “What Rhytion was of it, |
| 22. <i>ku ri-ti₁-na₁</i> | of it for Nestor, <i>that</i> (is) yours of it.” |
| 23. <i>sa₂ sa-ta</i> | “This of you under you (was) |
| 24. <i>sa₂ na-sa₂+ti</i> | of it of the man, |
| 25. <i>sa₂ ti₁-sa pa</i> | of it for my father.” |
| 26. <i>i u-wi-sa₂ KATA+ti</i> | “: Rhytion (is) for Nestor.” |
| 27. <i>har₁-ma-ha-sa sa₂</i> | |
| 28. <i>a-mi ta-ti₁ sa₂</i> | |
| 29. <i>u ri-ti₁-na₁</i> | |
| 30. <i>na-sa₂+ti</i> | |

6. THE LANGUAGE

Lia Rietveld

Not only the script of the Disc of Phaistos shows similarities with Luwian Hieroglyphic, but also the language which lies behind it. There are similarities in grammar (see paragraph 6.2) and in words (see paragraph 6.1): these are Luwian, too. Not writing case endings after a logogram (e.g. *SARU*), or after geographical and personal names in nominative or accusative, is a common feature of Luwian in the Late Bronze Age.³⁷⁵

The contents of the disc nicely coincides with the place where it was found: the text opens with “In the Mesara is Phaistos”. These and other geographical names belong to Crete (the names Mesara and Lasithi still exist and Knossos and Phaistos are nowadays much visited ruins). Exceptions are Achaia in the Greek Peloponnesos and Assuwa, which refers to Asia Minor.



Fig. 36. “In the Mesara is Phaistos”. The ruins of the Palace of Phaistos and in the background the Mesara plain. (Photo: Lia Rietveld 2002).

Two of the personal names on the disc can be found in Homer’s epics: Nestor in connection with Pylos in the Peloponnesos and Idomeneus in connection

³⁷⁵ John Hawkins 1995, 31. Suppiluliumas in the text is Suppiluliumas II who governs from 1205 to 1180? BC.

with Knossos in Crete.³⁷⁶ However, for the other personal names we cannot refer to Homer. These are mostly Anatolian names.³⁷⁷ Tarhunt is a Luwian god's name.³⁷⁸ The text on the disc also shows evidence of Semitic influence (the god's name Haddu).³⁷⁹ According to Homer there were a number of languages spoken in Crete.³⁸⁰ The different language influences that are present on the disc support Homer's information.

6.1 Words

6.1.1 Names

Geographical names		Personal names (including gods)	
<i>Misaru</i>	Mesara	<i>Nasatu</i>	Nestor
<i>Payatu</i>	Phaistos	<i>Idumana</i>	Idomeneus
<i>Rasutu</i>	Lasithi	<i>Kunawa</i>	Kuneus
<i>Kunasa</i>	Knossos	<i>Uwa</i>	Uwas
<i>Saharwa</i>	Scheria	<i>Aharku</i>	Acharkis
<i>Ritina</i>	Rhytion		
<i>Hiyawa</i>	Achaia	<i>Tarhunt</i>	Tarhunt
<i>Asuwiya</i> (adj.)	Assuwa	<i>Adu</i>	Haddu

The geographical and personal names on the disc are paralleled in Linear B, in Hittite/Luwian, and Egyptian Hieroglyphic (see further paragraph 6.3). The other words on the disc have mostly equivalents in Luwian Hieroglyphic (LH) and to a lesser extent in Hittite. Sometimes a word comes from Akkadian, Linear B or Egyptian Hieroglyphic.

6.1.2 Nouns

<i>custos</i>	: “governor”; Hittite: ^{LÚ} GIŠ-PA, “scepterman”; ^{LÚ} .GIŠ.TUKUL ³⁸¹
<i>imperium-sa</i>	: “dominion”

³⁷⁶ Nestor, e.g. Homer, *Odyssey* 3, 79; Idomeneus, e.g. Homer, *Odyssey* 19, 181.

³⁷⁷ Zgusta 1964, 243: *Kunaa* (Lycian) and Laroche 1966, 98 (no. 625: *Ku-na-a*), 200 (no. 1461: *U-wa-a*), 24 (no. 14: *A-ka-ar-ki-is*).

³⁷⁸ Laroche 1966, 289: *Tarhunt*.

³⁷⁹ Meijer 1982, 82; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 8.

³⁸⁰ Homer, *Odyssey* 19, 175-177; he distinguishes a mixture of languages, spoken by Achaians, Eteocretans, Kydones, three sorts of Dorians and Pelasgians.

³⁸¹ Götze 1968, 31 and 33; Masson 1980, 111-116.

<i>inaku</i>	: “life”; Egyptian: ‘ <i>nh, ankh</i> ’ ³⁸²
<i>jugum + aratrum</i>	: “ploughland” ³⁸³
^{L1} <i>SARU+ti</i>	: “kingship of the oath”, ^{L1} (Hittite: <i>lingai-</i> “oath”) ³⁸⁴ + <i>SARU-tu</i> , “kingship”; Akkadian: <i>šarrutu/LUGAL-utu</i> ³⁸⁵
^{L1} <i>UTNA-sa</i>	: “territory of the oath”, ^{L1} (Hittite: <i>lingai-</i> “oath”) + <i>UTNA</i> (see below)
<i>SARU</i>	: “king”; Akkadian: <i>šarru/LUGAL</i> ³⁸⁶
<i>sol suus + WASU</i>	: “His Majesty” + “hail”; Akkadian: ^d <i>UTU</i> ^š <i>i</i> + <i>šul-mu</i> ³⁸⁷
<i>tati</i>	: “father”; LH: <i>tati</i> - ³⁸⁸
<i>UTNA</i>	: “territory”, LH: with phonetic complement <i>-na</i> ³⁸⁹
<i>wati</i>	: “town”; Linear B: <i>watu</i> ³⁹⁰

6.1.3 Adjectives

<i>asuwiya</i>	: adjective of the geographical name “Assuwa”; Hittite: ^{KUR} <i>a-aš-šu-wa</i> ³⁹¹
<i>harmahasa</i>	: adjectival genitive of LH: <i>harmahi-</i> “man, head” ³⁹²
<i>uri</i>	: “great”, LH: <i>ura/i-</i> ³⁹³

6.1.4 Pronouns

Personal pronoun

<i>-mi</i>	: 1st person singular; enclitical: <i>KATA-mi</i> ³⁹⁴
<i>-ti, ti, tisa, ^{L1} tisa</i>	: 2nd person singular; enclitical: <i>KATA+ti</i> ; ³⁹⁵ LH: <i>tí-</i> ³⁹⁶
<i>uwisa</i>	: 2nd person plural; LH: <i>u-W-s</i> ³⁹⁷

³⁸² W.V. Davies 1987, 20; Laroche 1960, sign 369, here written in full.

³⁸³ Woudhuizen 1992a, 39-40.

³⁸⁴ Tischler 1982, 47.

³⁸⁵ Friedrich 1946, 173.

³⁸⁶ Friedrich 1946, 172 (341a) and 173 (345a).

³⁸⁷ Woudhuizen 1992a, 17-22.

³⁸⁸ John Hawkins 1995, 125.

³⁸⁹ Laroche 1960, 125, no. 228, *PAYS-na*.

³⁹⁰ Palmer 1963, 261.

³⁹¹ Del Monte/Tischler 1978, 52-53.

³⁹² Laroche 1960, 6, no. 10; Meriggi 1962, 52 *ha-r-[ma-]ha-sa*, adjectival genitive.

³⁹³ Laroche 1960, 191, no. 363d, here written in full.

³⁹⁴ See note 413.

³⁹⁵ See note 413.

³⁹⁶ Meriggi 1966, 50.

Possessive pronoun

- (a)mi, misa : 1st person singular; LH: (á)mi-,³⁹⁸ a-mi-s³⁹⁹
 tiyasa : 2nd person singular; adjectival genitive of the
 personal pronoun ti-, LH: tí-, the suffix -asa makes
 it possessive⁴⁰⁰

Demonstrative pronoun

- i, iyasa : “this”; LH: i-,⁴⁰¹ i(a)sa⁴⁰²
 pa : “that”; LH: (a)pa-⁴⁰³

Relative pronoun

- ku : “what”; LH: QU-⁴⁰⁴

Indefinite pronoun

- kukuta : “whatever”; LH: QU-QU-, QU-a-ta QU-a-ta;⁴⁰⁵
 Hittite: *kuiskuis* “whoever” and *kuitta* “all,
 every”⁴⁰⁶

6.1.5 Numeral

- du : “two”; LH: tuwa-⁴⁰⁷

³⁹⁷ Meriggi 1962, 142. See note 399 for the consonant [s].

³⁹⁸ Meriggi 1962, 18.

³⁹⁹ Meriggi 1962, 18. The word *a-mi-s* = *a-mi-sa*: John Hawkins (1986, 369) suggests that in the LH script consonants without vowels were rendered by the a-series, “so *s* would be written with *sa*, *n* with *na*, etc.”.

⁴⁰⁰ With a glide between the pronoun and the suffix. For the glide between [i] and [a] in CL see Laroche 1959, 133 (for example *a-ti-ya-as*). See also the adjectival genitive of the demonstrative pronoun *i-*.

⁴⁰¹ Laroche 1960, 199, nr. 376, 2; John Hawkins 1995, 126, gives *za-*. This form differs because of the difference between the old and the new reading of the sign in question. The old reading is *i-*. See Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 89-97 for the arguments in favour of the old reading.

⁴⁰² With adjectival genitive suffix; Meriggi 1966, 53-54.

⁴⁰³ John Hawkins 1995, 123.

⁴⁰⁴ Meriggi 1962, 158-160. John Hawkins 1995, 123; new reading *kwi-*.

⁴⁰⁵ Meriggi 1962, 161-162.

⁴⁰⁶ Tischler 1982, 40.

⁴⁰⁷ Laroche 1960, 206, no. 384.

6.1.6 Verbs

<i>tiwati</i>	: 3rd person singular, present tense, “brings”; LH: <i>ti-wa-ti</i> ⁴⁰⁸
<i>tiwaⁿti</i>	: 3rd person plural, present tense, “bring”; LH: <i>ti-wa-ti</i> ⁴⁰⁹
<i>sati, asti</i>	: 3rd person singular, present tense, “is”; LH: <i>a-s-ti</i> -from (<i>a</i>) <i>sa</i> - ⁴¹⁰
<i>sata</i>	: 3rd person singular, past tense, “was”; LH: <i>a-sa-ta</i> from (<i>a</i>) <i>sa</i> - ⁴¹¹

6.1.7 Prepositions

<i>atu</i>	: + dative/ø, “in”; LH: <i>a-ta</i> ⁴¹²
<i>KATA</i>	: + dative, “under”; LH: <i>KATA</i> and Hittite: <i>katta</i> , both with enclitical personal/possessive pronoun in the dative ⁴¹³
<i>sa</i>	: + genitive/ø, “of”; in Hittite ⁴¹⁴ and also in Luwian Cuneiform ⁴¹⁵ the corresponding ŠA is an Akkadian loanword
<i>upa</i>	: + ø, “after, behind”; LH: <i>apan</i> ⁴¹⁶

6.1.8 Particles

<i>ta</i>	: conjunction “and”; Hittite: <i>ta</i> ⁴¹⁷
<i>-hawa</i>	: conjunction “and”, enclitical; LH: <i>-ha-wa</i> ⁴¹⁸
<i>u, a</i>	: introductory particle/conjunction; LH: <i>a</i> - ⁴¹⁹
<i>wa</i>	: introductory particle of direct speech; LH: <i>wa</i> ⁴²⁰

⁴⁰⁸ Meriggi 1962, 130-131.

⁴⁰⁹ See note 408. The [n] before the consonant is not written in LH, therefore 3rd person singular and plural are written the same (Werner 1991, 34).

⁴¹⁰ Meriggi 1962, 34; John Hawkins 1995, 123 and 125: *-ti* present tense. See note 399 for [s]: *a-s-ti* = *a-sa-ti*.

⁴¹¹ John Hawkins 1995, 123.

⁴¹² Meriggi 1962, 40: postposition + dative.

⁴¹³ Meriggi 1962, 72; Rost 1956, 334-335 and 350: *katti-mi*, in the Amarna letter EA 31 in Hittite, from the king of Egypt to the king of Arzawa. It is used in a greeting formula: *katti-mi ...-mi ...-mi* “with me all is well, my ..., my ... (with you..., your ..., your)”. In the Luwian hieroglyphic text Südburg: phrase 3, *KATA+mi*, “with me” is attested, in the form of a ligature of *56 *KATA* with the lozenge shaped variant of *391 *mi*, *419 (Woudhuizen 2004, 87).

⁴¹⁴ Friedrich, 1946, 172.

⁴¹⁵ Otten 1953, 59 and 115.

⁴¹⁶ John Hawkins 1995, 123. In CL preposition + dative (Laroche 1959, 29). In LH postposition + dative (John Hawkins 2000, 53, Kt. 40).

⁴¹⁷ Tischler 1982, 80.

⁴¹⁸ John Hawkins 1995, 123, new reading *-ha-wa/i*.

⁴¹⁹ John Hawkins 1995, 122.

⁴²⁰ John Hawkins 1995, 126, new reading *wa/i*.

6.2 Morphology

6.2.1 Nouns/adjectives

singular

nom.	∅	<i>Rasutu, Rasuta</i>
acc.	∅	<i>inaku</i>
dat.	-i	<i>Rasuti, wati, tati</i>
gen.	-sa	imperium -sa
gen. (adj.)	-asa	<i>harmahasa</i>

6.2.2 Suffixes

The suffix *-utu* is a Hittitism. It is an Akkadian abstractum that is also used in Hittite (*SARU-tu*).

The suffix *-ya* is an adjectival suffix (*Asuwiya*).

The suffix *-asa* is an adjectival genitive suffix, meaning “of”.⁴²¹ It makes the word adjectival: *harmahasa, iyasa, tiyasa*. The last two words need a glide: *ti-y-asa, i-y-asa*.⁴²² This suffix is used as a genitive, just like in LH *-asa*.

The genitive is not only rendered by this suffix, but also a genitive ending appears in the text: **imperium**-sa. In CL only the adjectival genitive suffix is used to render a genitive.⁴²³

6.2.3 Pronouns

Personal pronoun

singular	1	2	plural	2
dat.	-mi	(-)ti		
gen.		tisa		uwisa

Possessive pronoun

singular	1	2
dat.	(a)mi	
gen.	misa	
gen. (adj.)		tiyasa

⁴²¹ See note 438.

⁴²² See note 400 about the glide.

⁴²³ Laroche 1959, 136.

Demonstrative pronoun

singular

nom. *i* *pa*gen. *iyasa*

Relative pronoun

nom./acc. n. *ku*

Indefinite pronoun

undeclined *kukuta*

6.2.4 Verbs

singular	3	plural	3
present tense	<i>-ti</i> (<i>tiwati, sati, asti</i>)		<i>-ⁿti</i> (<i>tiwaⁿti</i>)
past tense	<i>-ta</i> (<i>sata</i>)		

The words on the Phaistos Disc mostly have parallels in LH, but also the grammatical features show that the language on the Disc of Phaistos is Luwian. This can be concluded from the parallels in paragraph 6.1. In paragraph 6.2, the grammatical features of the text of the Phaistos Disc, like the suffixes, the case-endings, and the verbal endings, are put together. However, the case-endings of the names and nouns do require further explanation in the next paragraph.

6.3 *The u/a-Vowel Shift in Stem-final Position of the Geographical and Personal Names*

That the undeclined form of a geographical or personal name on the disc sometimes ends in [u], sometimes in [a], independent of the function in the sentence, may perhaps be explained by their equivalents in Linear B, as demonstrated in this scheme (in which equivalents found in other languages also are included).

PD	Linear B	Hittite	Luwian	Egyptian Hieroglyphic	Akkadian/NW Semitic/Linear A
<i>Misaru</i>	<i>Misarajo</i> ⁴²⁴				
<i>Payatu</i>	<i>Paito</i> ⁴²⁵			<i>Biyašataya</i>	<i>Payata</i>
<i>Rasutu</i>	<i>Rasuto</i> ⁴²⁶				
<i>Kunasa</i>	<i>Konoso</i> ⁴²⁷			<i>Kunuša</i>	
<i>Saharwa</i>	<i>Sakarijo</i> ⁴²⁸				
<i>Ritina</i>					
<i>Hiyawa</i>	<i>Akawija</i> ⁴²⁹	<i>Ahhiyawa</i>	<i>Hiyawa</i>		<i>Hiyaúwii</i>
<i>Asuwiya</i>	<i>Asiwija</i> ⁴³⁰	<i>Assuwa</i>		<i>ʿIsy</i>	<i>Asijaka</i>
<i>Nasatu</i>	<i>Netijano</i> ⁴³¹				
<i>Idumana</i>	<i>Idomenijo</i> ⁴³²				
<i>Kunawa</i>	<i>Kuneu</i> ⁴³³	<i>Kuna</i>			
<i>Uwa</i>	<i>Uwasijo</i> ⁴³⁴	<i>Uwa</i>			
<i>Aharku</i>		<i>Akarkis</i>			
<i>Tarhunt</i>		<i>Tarhunt</i>			
<i>Adu</i>					<i>Adu</i>

What is striking in this scheme is the fact that several cases of stem-final [u] and [a] are paralleled in Linear B by the ending [o].

The case-endings on the disc and those in LH show resemblances and differences:

	PD	LH ⁴³⁵	Akk./NW Sem. ⁴³⁶	Lin. A ⁴³⁷
nom.	∅	-s(a)	-u	-u
acc.	∅	-n(a)	-a	-a
dat.	-i	-i	∅	
gen.	-sa	-s(a)	-i	-i
gen. (adj.)	-asa	-asa ⁴³⁸		

⁴²⁴ Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 219 (*paito misarajo*).

⁴²⁵ See note 424.

⁴²⁶ Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 163.

⁴²⁷ Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 317.

⁴²⁸ Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 581.

⁴²⁹ Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 209.

⁴³⁰ Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 534-535.

⁴³¹ Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 563.

⁴³² Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 547; dative.

⁴³³ Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 557.

⁴³⁴ Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 589; patronymic adjective.

⁴³⁵ Werner 1991, 27-29.

⁴³⁶ Friedrich 1960, 171.

⁴³⁷ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 9-10 (-u, -a); 12 (-i): instead of "My King", *sa-ri* = "of the king" (oral information by Jan Best).

⁴³⁸ Werner 1991, 27-29. Adjectival genitive ending -a/isi (new reading); Meriggi 1962: -asa.

The endings *-u* and *-a* appear both in undeclined forms, for example:

ku Nasatu (A 6) “What Nestor (has)” *ku Nasata* (B 2) “What Nestor (has)”
atu misa {...} *Rasuta* (A 8, A 9) *misa imperium-sa Rasutu* (A 24, A 25)
 “in my territory, Lasithi” “of my dominion, Lasithi”

Once the ending is written with [u], once with [a], because here it concerns a Greek (Linear B) name in [o], which is rendered in Luwian either with [u] or [a]. This phenomenon also appears in Hittite, which is closely related to Luwian.

In the Madduwattas text (14th century BC) the name *Alaksandus* appears. This name is an isolated name in Hittite/Luwian, it does not have any meaning in these languages and therefore seems to be a foreign name,⁴³⁹ viz. “Alexandros”: the [o] is rendered in Hittite with [u].



Fig. 37. “In my territory Lasithi”. The Lasithi upland plain (Photo: Lia Rietveld 2002).

⁴³⁹ Laroche 1966, 26, no. 21; Güterbock 1997, 223: *Alaksandu* is probably nothing more than a bad transcription of the Greek *Alexandros* and has got nothing to do with [Indo-European] languages of Asia Minor.

Many names on the disc appear in Linear B but not in LH. It concerns here names with stem-final [o], rendered on PD by [u] or [a]. The Linear B ending *-a* is rendered in the same way on PD.

The nominative and the accusative endings *-s* and *-n* are suppressed in the spelling, just like in Linear B and LH from the same period.

The dative⁴⁴⁰ and genitive endings of PD and LH are the same.

What PD has in common with Linear A and Akkadian, is the *u*-ending. Where PD has [u] or [a] in the nominative or accusative, Linear A has [u]. The genitive, however, is different, except the Akkadian partitive genitive in A 15, ^USARU+ti. Some Akkadian influence on cases is therefore present.

However, on the whole the cases on the PD are paralleled by those of Luwian: in the dative and genitive, *and* in the nominative and accusative. The *u/a-vowel shift* can be explained by the fact that it concerns foreign names, whereas not rendering the nominative and accusative case-ending is a feature which the Luwian dialect on the PD shares with Luwian Hieroglyphic of the Late Bronze Age.

6.4 *Nestor and (Ah)hiyawa*

6.4.1 The Disc vs Homer

In the first line of the *Letter to Nestor* on the Disc of Phaistos, after the mentioning of the dispatch address, Phaistos in the Mesara, it is clear that Nestor's home is not Phaistos, but Hiyawa.

Atu Misaru sati Payatu

U Nasati, u uri atu Hiyawa

Nestor (the) Great, rules in Hiyawa. This information is not completely in line with Homer's *Iliad*, where Nestor is king of Pylos in Messenia on the Peloponnese. In Homer's work a name for the Greeks is Achaia, after their homeland Achaia, and in the *Letter to Nestor* we are dealing with the Luwian variant of this name, Hiyawa.

But in Homers *Iliad* Nestor is not the leading king, Agamemnon is, together with his brother Menelaos. Therefore in the *Letter to Nestor* we are dealing with the time before the events in the *Iliad*, as is congruent with the dating of the *Letter to Nestor* (see chapter 3). The story of Nestor's younger days in the *Iliad*, the *Nestoris*, has many archaic Greek words and is of an earlier date.⁴⁴¹

⁴⁴⁰ Examples of datives in Luwian Hieroglyphic can be found in John Hawkins 2000, 125 (Carchemish A6: phrase 25), 131 (Carchemish A15b: phrase 24), 523 (Bulgarmaden: phrase 10), 579 (Boğça: phrase 2 and 4), 581 (Karaburun: phrase 8 and 19).

⁴⁴¹ Jan Best 1994, 20. The Linear B texts from Pylos date from 1200 BC, except a small amount of older tablets from the older palace that dates from 1400-1300 BC (Best 1994,

In the Linear B texts of Pylos no king's name is given, nor a geographic name Hiyawa. But Hittite sources abundantly provide us with the name Ahhiyawa in connection with Mycenaean Greeks.

6.4.2 Ahhiyawa and Nestor

There are several Hittite texts with reference to Ahhiyawa, mostly without a name for the Ahhiyawan rulers, simply because the name was not written, but also because the lines in which the name could have been, were lacking. These references point to about 200 years of contact between Greeks and Hittites, from c. 1400-1220 BC.⁴⁴² The contact was often hostile, but in a number of letters it was friendly and diplomatic. In the early years of contact there was no Achaean state, only powerful palatial centres that were expanding.

Later on these centres became independent kingdoms, but with a common culture, with a king of Ahhiyawa as ruler of the most important kingdom, and with a military capacity to be reckoned with by the Hittite king.⁴⁴³

In the *Indictment of Madduwattas* (c. 1400 BC) the Hittite king, Arnuwandas I, co-regent of Tudhaliyas II from 1400 to 1390 BC,⁴⁴⁴ mentions Attarisiyas who has attacked Madduwattas (a vassal of the Hittite king) with 100 chariots, from his base in western Anatolia. Attarisiyas later reconciled with the vassal and they made raids on Alasiya (Cyprus).⁴⁴⁵ This "man" of Ahhiyawa (not a king) was here on his own account, with his own fleet and chariots. Because of conflicts between competing Mycenaean kings who were expanding their territory, as is clear from the building of bigger palaces and fortresses in the Mycenaean mainland, some aristocrats with their followers had to seek their fortune elsewhere, on the islands and the coast of the opposite shore of the Aegean.⁴⁴⁶ Attarisiyas could have been such an aristocrat. This "man" of Ahhiyawa must have been Atreus who in Homer's *Iliad* was king of Mycenae,⁴⁴⁷ father of the kings Agamemnon and Menelaos, and thus, like Nestor, of an earlier generation.

24-25).

⁴⁴² Kelder 2004-05, 151.

⁴⁴³ Kelder states that, because of the military capacity, Ahhiyawa must have been larger than any of the known Mycenaean states. A conglomerate of some - or all - of the known palatial states. (Kelder 2004-05, 151). According to Trevor Bryce the various kingdoms could form temporary alliances for military purposes or for other major enterprises (Bryce 2003, 201).

⁴⁴⁴ KUB XIV 1. Tudhaliyas II (1425-1390), Arnuwandas I (1390-1370) (Freu 2007, 311); Bryce 1998, xiii: Tudhaliyas I/II and Arnuwandas I 1400-1360.

⁴⁴⁵ Shane Hawkins 2010, 217.

⁴⁴⁶ Niemeier, 2002, 295. Bryce suggests that Attarisiyas may have been an agent of the new expanding Mycenaean palace centres that needed access to resources, including human labour (Bryce 2006, 102).

⁴⁴⁷ After some struggle; according to Hesiodos, he was earlier, by marriage, king of Argos and expelled his brother Thyestes. According to Niemeier Attarisiyas is a Luwian adaptation of the Greek name Atreus (Niemeier 2002, 296).

Another letter in which an Ahhiyawan name occurs, is the *Tawagalawas Letter* sent by Hattusilis III (1250 BC).⁴⁴⁸ In this letter a Mycenaean ruler is called “king”. It also mentions a brother of a king of Ahhiyawa by name, Tawagalawas, (**Etewoklewes*, Eteokles).⁴⁴⁹ He has diplomatic contact with the Hittite king, has been at his court and went for a chariot ride with a relative of the king.

The question now is, how does the *Letter of Nestor* fit in these contacts? In what stage of Mycenaean power does Nestor operate? In chapter 3 the dating of the *Letter to Nestor* is given: between 1370-1340 BC, which date can be sharpened to 1352-1336 by other evidence: the style of sign D02 on the disc.⁴⁵⁰ This means that the *Letter to Nestor* can be placed later than the *Indictment of Madduwattas*, dating from c. 1400 BC, in which Attarisiyas is mentioned, but before the *Tawagalawas Letter* from c. 1250 BC. In between these letters the power of the Achaeans has enormously increased. From “man” to “king”, from “hostile raids” to “chariot rides”. Some fifty years after Attarisiyas, and long before Tawagalawas, Nestor, “Great” in Hiyawa,⁴⁵¹ was probably in contact with a king of Arzawa, in the Luwian language, and not with a Hittite king, due to a diminishing of Hittite power in favour of the Arzawan king.⁴⁵² Nestor has gained parts of Crete which the king of Arzawa had to give up⁴⁵³ and installed his vice-roy, Idomeneus, here. As Homer refers to Nestor as ruler of Pylos, he might have reigned from this place, but there is no archaeological evidence for Pylos being the centre of Mycenaean power, Mycenae was that centre. In the Hittite letters no place-names in Ahhiyawa

⁴⁴⁸ KUB XIV 3. In this letter Millawanda (Miletos), on the Anatolian coast, is under control of Ahhiyawa. The Hittite king and the king of Ahhiyawa are in conflict because of Wilusa. Recently Gurney has dated this letter earlier during the reign of Muwatallis II (1295-1271) (Gurney 2002, 133-141); Bryce sticks to Hattusilis III (Bryce 2003, 212).

⁴⁴⁹ A find by Emil Forrer (Shane Hawkins 2010, 217). In the Linear B tablets of Pylos a name of an important dignitary/military man is e-te-wo-ke-re-we-i-jo (Palmer 1963, 77 and 143-144).

⁴⁵⁰ See chapter 2, p. 24.

⁴⁵¹ In Luwian *ura* means “great”. Possibly this is a short term for the title “Great King”, although one would expect then the title “King” here as well. The greeting formulas make clear that Nestor is very important to the Luwian king (Haddu brings you life).

⁴⁵² Probably Tarhundaradus (Amarna letters EA 31 and 32). Arzawa was a kingdom west from Hatti. Formerly it was defeated by the Hittites, now it attacked Hittite territory (KBo VI 28). In the *Letter to Nestor* the king who sends the letter is presented as Great King, according to the use of sign D11, a sun between wings, the standard expression for Hittite Great Kings.

⁴⁵³ The Arzawan king refers to Assuwan Phaistos, to emphasize his former rights. Similar use of reference to Assuwa, to which Arzawa formerly belonged, is made in KUB XXVI 91 (Bo 1485, Sommer 1932, 268-271), a fragmentary letter from a king of Ahhiyawa to a Hittite king. Reference is made to the older times of a great-grandfather (in the *Letter to Nestor* to the father). According to Shane Hawkins, this text refers to an early dynastic marriage contracted between Ahhiyawa and Assuwa. The tablet-text appears to be a Hittite translation of a Mycenaean communiqué (Shane Hawkins 2010, 218).

are given, because of lack of knowledge on the side of the Hittites. Contacts between Hittites and Ahhiyawans mostly took place in the Hittite (vassal) territories.

6.4.3 Hiyawa and Nestor

Besides the Hittite sources for Achaia, another Luwian and two Akkadian sources refer to Achaia. These sources are, however, from a later time than the *Letter to Nestor*. The *Bilingue of Çinekoy* dates from the Early Iron Age. This bilingue, in Luwian and Phoenician, is about king Warikas, descendent of Mukasas, a Hiyawayan king, who is proud of himself to make Hiyawa grow and make the plain of Hiyawa prosperous. This Hiyawa is located on Anatolian soil, and the name refers to earlier times in which the Achaiaans were powerful here. The Luwian name Hiyawa in this bilingue, with aphaeresis (= loss of front vowel) of the initial *a*,⁴⁵⁴ was thought to have been the earliest known case of this feature, but recently new material has shown otherwise. An earlier occurrence of this name with aphaeresis can be found in two Akkadian excerpts of c. 1200 BC, found in Ugarit, in which men of *Hiyaiúwi* appear. Apparently the Luwian name was adapted in these Akkadian letters. In these excerpts the Hittite king Suppiluliumas II and a Hittite court official Penti-Šarruma instruct Ammurapi, king of Ugarit to ship PAD.MEŠ (metal ingots) to Hiyawa-men (LÚ.MEŠ *Hi-ya-ú-wi-i*) in Lukka.⁴⁵⁵ These Hiyawa-men (= Achaiaans) seem to be tradesmen by now, waiting in some port of Lukka for their cargo of metal ingots. Ilya Yakubovich sees in the occurrence of *Hiyaiúwi* evidence for an early Greek presence in Lycia.⁴⁵⁶

However, an even earlier date for the appearance of the name Hiyawa with aphaeresis is provided by the first lines of the *Letter to Nestor*, as cited above. The Luwian hieroglyphic sign L31 *HISHIA*, two bound arms, is similar to sign D 04 of the Disc of Phaistos: a man with his hands bound, with the value *hi* from Luwian *hishiya* (to tie up), according to the acrophonic principle. The occurrence of this typically Luwian hieroglyphic sign on the Disc of Phaistos, a sign exclusively restricted to the Luwian hieroglyphic script and the script on this Disc of Phaistos, proves that *Hiyawa* is Luwian for Hittite *Ahhiyawa*, both referring to Achaiaans who make their appearance in the Luwian and Hittite world.

⁴⁵⁴ Tekoğlu/Lemaire 2000, 982-983.

⁴⁵⁵ Singer 2006, 251 and 257.

⁴⁵⁶ Yakubovich 2008, 189. For a discussion on this topic see Rietveld/Woudhuizen 2010, 227-236.

The Luwian geographical name Hiyawa in the *Letter to Nestor* and the Hittite attestation of Ahhiya, the older form of Ahhiyawa⁴⁵⁷ in the *Indictment of Madduwattas*, are the earliest references in written history to the existence of the Achaian Greeks. In this connection Nestor has gained more power fifty years after Attarisiyas, for he has parts of Crete as his domain and has diplomatic contact with the Great King of Arzawa. This makes him important enough to bear the title: “Great” in Achaia.

⁴⁵⁷ Bryce 1998, 61.

7. THE DISC OF PHAISTOS AND LUWIAN HIEROGLYPHIC LATE BRONZE AGE TEXTS

Fred Woudhuizen

The Disc of Phaistos (PD), which is made of clay, is imprinted on both sides with hieroglyphic signs. From a comparative point of view, there are only two scripts current in the region of the eastern Mediterranean which may serve as a basis for comparison, namely Egyptian Hieroglyphic on the one hand, and Luwian Hieroglyphic (LH) on the other. If such a comparison is put into practice for experimental purposes, it soon turns out that similarities with Egyptian Hieroglyphic are unproductive, whereas those with Luwian Hieroglyphic are prolific. This result invites us to take a closer look: is a connection with Luwian Hieroglyphic *a priori* possible?

In a review article of *Ancient Scripts from Crete and Cyprus*, the late John Chadwick declared himself against a relationship of the signs on the Phaistos Disc with Luwian hieroglyphic counterparts because: (1) it is based on a random comparison between scripts, and (2) it is chronologically impossible since the disc considerably antedates the earliest manifestations of the Luwian hieroglyphic script.⁴⁵⁸ However, both these arguments are incorrect. As we have seen, from a comparative point of view there are only two scripts which may serve as a basis for comparison, one of which leads to encouraging results – which is not the same as a random comparison between scripts. Secondly, the Disc of Phaistos probably dates to a considerably later period than to which it is usually assigned (namely Late Minoan IIIA1/2, c. 1350 BC,⁴⁵⁹ instead of Middle Minoan II to IIIB, c. 1850–1600 BC)⁴⁶⁰ and Luwian Hieroglyphic, as I have shown elsewhere,⁴⁶¹ is already attested for the Middle Bronze Age (c. 2000–1700 BC) – in short: there is no chronological obstacle to a comparison between the two scripts.

If, then, by means of a working hypothesis, we start to compare the signary of the Disc of Phaistos to that of Luwian Hieroglyphic, we will soon experience that not all the signs from the disc have a convincing parallel in the latter script. Of the total number of 47 individual signs (45 printed, 2 – the so-called ‘thorn’ and the determinative of a personal name⁴⁶² – incised with a stylus), 31 in sum may plausibly be related to a Luwian hieroglyphic counterpart, which, though substantial, still means that the remaining 16 signs go

⁴⁵⁸ Chadwick 1989, 181.

⁴⁵⁹ For the lowering of the date of LM IIIA1/2 from c. 1370 BC to c. 1350 BC, see note 495; see also chapter 3.

⁴⁶⁰ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 71-72; 137-138; *contra* Duhoux 1977, 6-14; cf. Duhoux 2000, 597.

⁴⁶¹ Woudhuizen 1990-91, 139-149; Woudhuizen 2004, 112-120.

⁴⁶² The additional stroke at the lower side of D 45 in A 3 is paralleled by a ‘thorn’ in the same position on the Disc of Vladikavkaz. For the identification of this sign as the determinative of a personal name see the Preface on page 10.

unparalleled (cf. Table 1). This brings us to a prime difficulty of the comparative method: notwithstanding the obvious overall relationship with Luwian Hieroglyphic, the signary of the disc is of a decidedly local Cretan nature. The latter conclusion is not only borne out by the number of unparalleled signs, it also emanates from the fact that of the signs which do have a convincing counterpart in Luwian Hieroglyphic the *ductus* still exhibits local Cretan features – a nice example is the tattoo in the form of a figure-of-eight rendered on the face of D 03, which is a typical feature for Cretans depicted in Egyptian funeral paintings, but which is missing in the related LH male sign L 10.⁴⁶³ Hence, it comes as no surprise that signs from the disc are paralleled in other inscribed objects from Crete, as, for instance, the double-axe of Arkalochori and the altar-stone from Malia.⁴⁶⁴ In their turn, these latter texts show signs well-known from the repertory of Cretan Hieroglyphic, so that in the end it is incredible that the Disc of Phaistos, like the double-axe of Arkalochori, is not included in the recently edited corpus of Cretan hieroglyphic inscriptions, whereas the altar-stone from Malia is (as # 328).⁴⁶⁵ Whatever the reason for this may be, it is clear that the comparative method, although being an indispensable aid in establishing a basic relationship with Luwian Hieroglyphic, will not help us to unravel the text of the disc in every detail: much remains to be extracted by internal analysis.

This is not the place to discuss the internal evidence which leads to the assignment of values to the remaining set of 16 signs – it is a topic which has been treated extensively elsewhere.⁴⁶⁶ What primarily concerns us here is the relationship of the script on the disc, and the language it contains, with Luwian hieroglyphic documents dating from the Late Bronze Age (LBA) period. For if we are right in our assumption that the Disc of Phaistos bears testimony to an insular offshoot of Luwian Hieroglyphic, the script and the language may be logically expected to show the closest affinity to Luwian hieroglyphic inscriptions on rock and stone monuments from the same chronological horizon as from which the disc stems, *in casu* the Late Bronze Age.

As far as the writing is concerned, the aforesaid 31 signs of the disc which correspond to a Luwian hieroglyphic counterpart have been set out in a diagram, which shows their occurrence in the mother script differentiated according to time (see Table 1). It thus appears that of these 31 signs 29 are attested for the Early Iron Age (EIA), 25 are attested for the Late Bronze Age (in one instance, L 283-284 *custos*, exclusively so),⁴⁶⁷ whereas 12 already

⁴⁶³ Godart 1995, 123 (see Fig. 18 above); for the numbering of LH signs, see Laroche 1960. Cf. chapter 4, discussion of D 03.

⁴⁶⁴ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 73-76; see chapter 4 and Appendix II.

⁴⁶⁵ Olivier/Godart 1996.

⁴⁶⁶ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 30-84; Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 65-97; Woudhuizen 1992a, 11-47.

⁴⁶⁷ Attestation for LBA in effect means from the reign of Tudhaliyas I (1465–1440 BC) to that

	PD	LH	value	EIA	LBA	MBA
1.	01	80	<i>SARU</i>	x	x	
2.	02	19	<i>á</i>	x	x	x
3.	03	10	<i>HARMAHI, [har]</i>	x	x	
4.	04	31	<i>HISHIA, [hi]</i>	x		
5.	05	90	<i>TIWA, ti</i>	x	x	
6.	06	15	<i>mi</i>	x	x	x
7.	08	56-57	<i>KATA, kà</i>	x	x	x
8.	11	190	<i>sol suus</i>	x	x	x
9.	12	181	<i>TURPI, [tu]</i>	x		
10.	14	228, 230	<i>UTNA, tu₅</i>	x	x	
11.	15	283-284	<i>custos</i>		x	
12.	16	278	<i>li</i>	x	x	
13.	17	BG103	<i>anulus</i>		x	
14.	18	223	<i>s₆</i>	x		
15.	24	167	<i>[PARNA, pa]</i>	x		
16.	25	35	<i>na</i>	x	x	x
17.	26	108	<i>SURNA, sú</i>	x		
18.	28	125	<i>lí</i>	x	x	
19.	29	97	<i>WALWA, [u]</i>	x	x	x
20.	30	110	<i>ma</i>	x	x	
21.	31	131-133	<i>ARA, a(ra), ra</i>	x	x	x
22.	32	128	<i>TINTAPU, ti₅ > zi₄</i>	x	x	x
23.	33	138	<i>wa₈</i>	x		x
24.	36	160	<i>WIANA, wi</i>	x	x	
25.	38	189	<i>WASU, [wa₁]</i>	x	x	
26.	39	199	<i>TARHU(NT), ha</i>	x	x	x
27.	43	370	<i>ASU, as, su</i>	x	x	x
28.	44	318-319	<i>TESUP, tes, té, tí</i>	x	x	
29.	45	212, 214	<i>HAPA, ná</i>	x	x	x
30.	46	383, 2	<i>[+ti], +r(a/i)</i>	x	x	
31.	47	383, 1	(determinative of a personal name)	x	x	

Table 1. Corresponding signs of the Disc of Phaistos with Luwian hieroglyphic counterparts differentiated according to the time of their occurrence (values in square brackets reconstructed for the disc only); cf. Fig. 15.

of Suppiluliumas II (1205–1190 BC), except for L 189 *WASU* which already occurs on seals from the Old Hittite period (1650–1500 BC). For a discussion of the LBA texts mentioned here, see Woudhuizen 1994-95 and Woudhuizen 2004.

occur in the Middle Bronze Age (MBA) (in one instance, L138 *wa₈*, continuity from MBA to EIA seems to be inferred).⁴⁶⁸ If we realize that the absence of an attestation for the Late Bronze Age period, as is the case with 6 signs, considering the limited number of Luwian hieroglyphic texts from the latter period, may be due to mere chance (as seems to be inferable in the case of the “fish” sign L 138), this pattern strongly supports a connection of the script of the disc with the Late Bronze Age Luwian hieroglyphic syllabary. It is interesting to note in this connection that in one instance, D 02 (= the counterpart of L 19 *á*), the execution of the sign shows a closer correspondence to the Middle Bronze Age representations than to the Late Bronze Age ones, which leave out the back of the head and only render the face in profile. In this respect, the Cretan offshoot of Luwian Hieroglyphic is apparently archaic in nature (although it must be admitted that the *ductus* is ‘modern’ in the sense that, for the extraordinarily bulbous skull, it joins in with the short-lived Akhenaten style).⁴⁶⁹

Turning next to the language of the disc, we may note the following correspondences with Luwian hieroglyphic Late Bronze Age texts:

1. The phenomenon of aphaeresis (= loss of front vowel), which characterizes the geographic name *hiyawa* “Achaia”, is paralleled for a place name in the Köylütolu text (phrases 2, 7), where *titarma*^{UMINA} corresponds with Hittite cuneiform *Attarima*. Thanks to a recently discovered bilingual inscription from Çineköy (30 km south of Adana), set up in memory of Urikki, king of Que in the late 8th century BC, the ‘aphaeresized’ form *hiāwa-* is now recorded as the regular Luwian hieroglyphic counterpart of Hittite cuneiform *Ahhiyawa-* “Achaia”.⁴⁷⁰
2. The expression *KATA-mi* “under me”, which also occurs in a variant characterized by the enclitic pronoun of the 2nd person singular, *KATA+ti* “under you”, is paralleled in writing variant *KATA+mi* for the Yalburt text (phrases 14, 29) and the one from the Südburg in Boğazköy-Hattusa (phrase 3).
3. The use of a derivative of the reduplicated (= indefinite) form of the relative *kukuta* “wherever” in an expression which specifies the extension

⁴⁶⁸ Of the 12 signs with an occurrence already in MBA, 8 have been mentioned in Woudhuizen 1990-91. Of the remaining 4, L 190 *sol suus* and L 199 *TARHU(NT)* are attested for seal impressions from Karahöyük near Konya, see Alp 1968, 116, no. 5 and 214, nos. 191-192, respectively, whereas L 214 *HAPA, ná* and L 138 *wa₈* turn up on a seal from the First Syrian Group, see Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 128-137.

⁴⁶⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 137-138.

⁴⁷⁰ Tekoğlu/Lemaire 2000, 981-984 (my thanks are due to Maya Vassileva and Jan de Boer for drawing my attention to this inscription).

of the territory belonging to a certain town strikingly recalls the sequences, likewise characterized by reduplicated (= indefinite) forms of the relative, *HWAā HWAā tītarma*^{UMINA} “whatever (belongs to) the town of Attarima” from the Köylütölu text (phrase 7) and *HWA HWA lúwata*^{UTNA} “whatever (belongs to) the land of Luwanda” from the Yalburt text (phrase 9).

4. The sparse use of introductory particles, otherwise the hallmark of a new phrase, reminds us of the situation in the Südburg text from Boğazköy-Hattusa, where this phenomenon is explained by the editor of the text in terms of a deliberately archaizing style.⁴⁷¹
5. The nominative (masculine/feminine) singular ending *-sa* and the accusative (masculine/feminine) singular ending *-na* in the realm of the noun and in the realm of the personal names are not indicated in the language of the disc; this correlates exactly with the situation in Luwian hieroglyphic Late Bronze Age texts⁴⁷² – note in this connection especially the combination *misa tātī* “my father (nominative)” as attested for the Nişantaş text from Boğazköy-Hattusa (phrase 2). In texts from the Early Iron Age, on the other hand, these endings are as a rule indicated: compare the writing of the man’s name *hártápusa* “Hartapus (nominative)” in the Kızıldağ and Karadağ group of inscriptions.⁴⁷³
6. The mention of the combination *mi tati*₂ or, in writing variant, *ami tati*₁ “for my father” in a historical context may well be compared to the mention of *āmīi* ^m*TÁ(TI)* *HUHAi* “my fathers (and) grandfathers” in the Yalburt text (phrase 42), also in a historical context. It should be noted, however, that reference to the father (and grandfather) of the editor of the text is not confined to Late Bronze Age inscriptions, but also occurs in Early Iron Age ones; compare, for example, *āmīi tātīa hūhai* *-ha* “my

⁴⁷¹ John Hawkins 1995, 21.

⁴⁷² What might not be indicated too in the language of the disc, is a separate ending for the genitive plural, as is also the case with the situation in Luwian hieroglyphic Late Bronze Age texts. Thus it is possible, depending on the context, to interpret a genitive singular as a genitive plural. In the case of the genitive singular *-sa* in *SARU tiyasa* (A 11) or the adjectival suffix *-(a)sa-* in *iyasa* (B 1) it is possible to read these forms as plural forms, leading to the interpretation “of your kings” and “of these”. This phenomenon characterizes not only Luwian hieroglyphic texts of the Late Bronze Age but also of the beginning of the Early Iron Age, where the expected ending, in the light of the parallels from Lycian and Lydian, would be *-ai* (Meriggi 1980, 275, § 5; 287, § 40 [Lycian *-āi* as in *ladāi* “of the wives”]; Woudhuizen 1984-85, 97 [Lydian *-ai*₁ as in *Ibšimi*₁*ai*₁ *Kulumi*₁*a(i)*₁ *-k* “of the Ephesians and the Koloans”]). Instead of this ending, however, we are confronted with forms like *MASANASA* or *MASANANASA* “of the gods” in Südburg: phrase 3, and Kızıldağ 4: phrase 2, respectively, and *UTNAsa* “of the lands” in Yalburt: phrase 2 and Kızıldağ 4: phrase 2, or *HÁ(TI)*^{utna}*sa* “of the Hatti lands” in Südburg: phrases 1, 5, and 6.

⁴⁷³ For the EIA texts from Kızıldağ and Karadağ, see Woudhuizen 1992-93, 204-213 and Woudhuizen 2004, Appendix V.

fathers and grandfathers” in Boğça: phrase 6,⁴⁷⁴ and *miaia tati* *HUHAhatii* -*ha*, *idem*, in Carchemish A11b: phrase 8.⁴⁷⁵

7. In the text of the disc the addressed person, Nestor in Achaia, is specified by the titular expression *uri*, dative singular in -*i* of *ura*- “great (man)”, which by itself is rather vague: usually *ura*- occurs in ligature with an honorific title like for instance *hantawat*- “king” or *domina*- “queen” to indicate the magistracy “Great King” or “Great Queen”. A similar vagueness characterizes the passage *na₄ -wa -ta HWAtiha URA+UPA₂* “I did not found for anybody else a (position as) great (man) there” from the Südburg text from Boğazköy-Hattusa (phrase 12), which bears reference to the vassal state of Tarhuntassa – one of the foremost provinces of the Hittite Empire.
8. The form *harmahasa* “of the man” is characterized by the adjectival suffix -*sa*-, which is typical of the Luwian language and also occurs in the form *apasa*- “his, her”, attested for the Köylütölu text (phrase 3) – an adjectival derivative from the demonstrative pronoun *apa*- “(s)he, that”.
9. Some observations of a more general nature may be grouped together here. These concern: identical repetitions, the omission of the verb, and the use of graphic variation. Thus the sequence *ta₇wana KATA aka* “I subdued the enemy” is repeated as many as 6 times in full in the text of the Südburg in Boğazköy-Hattusa, whereas that of ^{MASANA}*TARHU(NT) dominus-na PARANA HWAtat* “Tarhunt, the Lord, ran before me” occurs at least 4 times in the Yalburt text. Moreover, the verb is clearly omitted in Yalburt: phrase 25, and Südburg: phrase 13. Finally, for graphic variation we may point to the writings *MASANA-na*- and *MASANA-na*- “god”, *TAT(NT)*- and *tati*- “father”, and, last but not least, *A*-, *at*-, *ai*-, *ai*-, *ai*-, and *ai*- “to make, do” (various LBA texts).
10. The use of the genitive particle *sa₂* “of” falls outside the scope of Luwian Hieroglyphic in general. It rather points to Hittite Cuneiform, which is characterized by the Akkadian genitive particle *ša* of the same meaning.⁴⁷⁶ However, it is interesting to note in this connection that the latter particle is also attested for Luwian cuneiform texts.⁴⁷⁷ As I have suggested elsewhere, it seems likely that the section of the text on the disc, which follows the particle *wa*- of direct speech and singles itself out by the frequent use of the particle *sa₂* (= B 5 - B 30), actually constitutes a citation from a cuneiform Luwian letter!⁴⁷⁸

⁴⁷⁴ John Hawkins 2000, 479.

⁴⁷⁵ John Hawkins 2000, 103.

⁴⁷⁶ Friedrich 1960, 172-173.

⁴⁷⁷ Otten 1953, 59 (XXXV 54 Vs II, l. 40); 115 (75/k Vs?, l. 3).

⁴⁷⁸ Woudhuizen 1992a, 31.

11. A peculiarity of the language on the disc is (with the one time exception of the determinative of the personal name Nestor) the absence of determinatives which define the word as belonging to the general category of, for example, “man”, “town”, or “god”. Although in Cuneiform Luwian these determinatives normally do occur, there is one reasonably understandable phrase which definitely lacks them, *in casu: ahha -ta -ta alati awienta wilusati* “when they came to steep Wilusa” (KBo IV 11, 46), where the town name *Wilusa-* (= Ilion) goes unspecified by the determinative URU.⁴⁷⁹
12. Another feature, which at first sight cannot be explained in terms of Luwian hieroglyphic Late Bronze Age texts, is the expression *inaku*, which presents a phonetic rendering of Egyptian *ankh* “life”. However, as I have shown elsewhere,⁴⁸⁰ Luwian Hieroglyphic, when *in statu nascendi* during the Middle Bronze Age, developed under strong influences from Egyptian Hieroglyphic, deriving e.g. the signs winged sun-disc (L 190) and *ankh* (L 369). Accordingly, if we are to expect any Egyptian influence in a document related to Luwian Hieroglyphic from the Late Bronze Age, it is these two signs. The only strange thing, which cannot be accounted for, is that, in contrast to the winged sun-disc, which straightforwardly appears as D 11, the *ankh*-sign (otherwise known as the Cretan knot) is not used but the word it expresses is written out phonetically.

From the foregoing exposé it may safely be concluded that the Disc of Phaistos in script and language is most closely related to Luwian Hieroglyphic of the Late Bronze Age period. However, as we have explicitly indicated here with respect to the script and argued elsewhere with respect to the language,⁴⁸¹ both the script and the language of the disc are of decidedly local Cretan nature. The most reasonable explanation for the document, which, in contrast to the average Linear A and B tablet, has been purposely baked (and of which even a fragmentarily preserved provisional draft has been found! – see Appendix III on the Disc of Vladikavkaz), is that we are dealing with an incoming letter from international correspondence (most likely in Luwian Cuneiform) which has been transcribed in the local Cretan script and dialect. For a parallel situation we may point to the procedure recorded for the palace of Ras Shamra-Ugarit, where incoming Akkadian cuneiform letters were transcribed in the local alphabet and the local dialect.⁴⁸² The letter, which is addressed to the Achaian king Nestor, who had his residence in Pylos according to Homer, gives a detailed account of the division of power in the island of Crete at the time of the Late Minoan IIIA1/2 transitional period (c.

⁴⁷⁹ Watkins 1986, 58; cf. Laroche 1959, 164; Starke 1985, 341.

⁴⁸⁰ Woudhuizen 2004, Appendix I.

⁴⁸¹ Woudhuizen 1992a, 29.

⁴⁸² Lehmann 1970, 52, note 53.

1350 BC).⁴⁸³ It specifies exactly which king is ruling over which territory. The sender of the letter, who is addressed only by his title winged sun-disc (= “His Majesty”), is most likely to be identified as Great King Tarhundaradus of Arzawa, the successor state of the short-lived Assuwian League, to which reference is made by the expression *payata asuwiya* “the Assuwian Phaistos” in B 10-12. This king is known from the El-Amarna archive to have corresponded in Hittite Cuneiform with the Egyptian pharaoh Amenhotep III (1391–1353 BC), the father of Akhenaten (1353–1337 BC). But his residence, the country of Arzawa, with its capital *Apaša* “Ephesos”, is situated in Luwian speaking territory as the Luwian hieroglyphic monument at Karabel near Smyrna may prove,⁴⁸⁴ if not the Luwian nature of the later Lydian.⁴⁸⁵ In short, when corresponding in his native language, he will probably have written in Luwian. However this may be, the Disc of Phaistos presents us with a letter comparable to the ones discovered in the great palaces of the Near East, like Boğazköy-Hattusa, Ras Shamra-Ugarit, or El-Amarna, and in doing so it is the first of its kind so far west. It gives us information which we are lacking in the average Linear A and B tablet, which, in contrast to the disc, was not purposely preserved. We thus get a unique glimpse of the division of power in the Aegean region at the time of the El-Amarna archive which is of interest to historians of both the Anatolian and Greek civilizations.

⁴⁸³ For this date, see note 495.

⁴⁸⁴ John Hawkins 1998, *passim*.

⁴⁸⁵ Woudhuizen 1984-85, *passim*.

8. TOWARDS A HISTORICAL FRAME FOR THE PHAISTOS DISC

Fred Woudhuizen

The sensational discovery of tephra from the Santorini eruption in a layer dating to the reign of Tuthmoses III (1479–1425 BC) at Tell el-Dab‘a/Avaris by Manfred Bietak, has provided Aegean archaeology with one of the most important chronological divides.⁴⁸⁶ As a result of this discovery, we can now be sure that the unprecedented catastrophe of the Santorini eruption made an abrupt end to the period of about one century of Minoan thalassocracy, covering the archaeological phases of Late Minoan (LM) IA and IB (c. 1550–1450 BC). One of the first countries to profit from the downfall of the Minoan thalassocracy was Arzawa in western Anatolia. This kingdom organized a league of nations comprising all states of western Anatolia from Lukka (= Lycia) in the south through Karkisa (= Karia) in the middle to Wilusiya (= Homeric Ilion) in the north, which entered the historical records under the name of Assuwa (= Greek Asia), after the *Asios leimōn* “Asian field” near Ephesos,⁴⁸⁷ the capital of Arzawa.⁴⁸⁸ As recorded for a Hittite text of later date, the realm of Assuwa also included islands in the Aegean.⁴⁸⁹ Among these islands may have been Crete itself, as, in the form Asiya, Assuwa first turns up in Egyptian records from the time of Tuthmoses III in direct association with Keftiu, the Egyptian indication of Crete. In the annals of Tuthmoses III Asiya is mentioned for the years 34 and 38–39, which means 1445 BC and 1441–1440 BC in absolute chronology.⁴⁹⁰ This Assuwian League was subsequently defeated, first when under king Piyamakuruntas and later again when under his son Kukkulis, by a Hittite king Tudhaliyas who thanks to Jacques Freu (2007) can now be positively identified as Tudhaliyas II (1425–1390 BC). Note, however, that these events must have taken place early in the latter’s reign, because near the end of it he fought together with his son Arnuwandas I (1390–1370 BC) battles with Kupantakuruntas of Arzawa, a successor of Piyamakuruntas and Kukkulis of the Assuwian League.⁴⁹¹ As a consequence, the successive defeats of Assuwa are more likely to be dated sometime during the last quarter of the 15th century BC.⁴⁹²

⁴⁸⁶ Bietak 2000, 194; the chronology followed here is that of Kitchen 1989. See also note 10.

⁴⁸⁷ Homer, *Iliad* II, 461, *asiōi en leimōni*.

⁴⁸⁸ KUB XXIII 11; for a handsome survey of Middle Hittite texts, see Carruba 1977; for the location of Arzawa, see John Hawkins 1998.

⁴⁸⁹ KUB XXVI 91; cf. Smit 1986–87, 57; the identification of *guršawara* as “islands” rests with Starke 1981.

⁴⁹⁰ Helck 1971, 283.

⁴⁹¹ KUB XXIII 21, Heinhold-Krahmer 1977, 259; for the chronology of the Hittite kings, see Gurney 1990, 181, now to be adapted according to Freu 2007: 311.

⁴⁹² Cf. Cline 1996, 141, who redates Tudhaliyas II to ca 1450–1420 BC, whereas Starke 1997, 455 even ascribes the successive defeats of Assuwa to one of the latter’s predecessors, Tudhaliyas I (1465–1440 BC). Note that the mention of Assuwa in a fragmentary text of

The elimination of the Assuwan League by the Hittites created a power vacuum in western Anatolia and, once more, in the Aegean region. Again, we can see some parties taking advantage of the situation. In the first place there appears a certain Madduwattas on the stage, who carved out a realm for himself in Southwest Anatolia, starting from the mountain region of Zippasla and the river land of Siyanta (= Xanthos river in Lycia),⁴⁹³ which he received as fiefs by two successive Hittite kings. Secondly, we are confronted with the man of Ahhiya, Attarisiyas, who repeatedly attacked Madduwattas and together with the latter held a raid on the island of Alasiya (= Cyprus), using as many as 100 chariots,⁴⁹⁴ shipped overseas. Now, Attarisiyas of Ahhiya is plausibly identified as Atreus of Achaia, and therefore embodies the rise to power in the Aegean region of Mycenae in the Argolid. This rise to power of the Mycenaean Greeks in general can be archaeologically traced by the introduction of the mainland type of warrior graves and so-called Ephraean goblets in Crete during the LM II-III A1 period (= Minoan-Mycenaean transitional period, c. 1450–1350 BC).⁴⁹⁵ Furthermore, it is reflected in the wall-paintings of the tombs of Egyptian high officials from the reign of Tuthmoses III and his successor Amenhotep II (1427–1400 BC), where the Minoan kilts with codpieces of Cretan emissaries are replaced by Mycenaean ones without codpieces (Rekhmare) and such emissaries are subsequently depicted as Mycenaeans with beard altogether (Menkheperreseneb).⁴⁹⁶ But the raids by Attarisiyas in specific, firmly date to the latter part of the reign of the Hittite king Tudhaliyas II and the beginning of the reign of Arnuwandas I in the first half of the 14th century BC, as his one time foe and next time conspirator Madduwattas fought against and made an alliance with Kupantakuruntas of Arzawa – at that time the opponent of the aforementioned Hittite kings according to the annals of Arnuwandas I.⁴⁹⁷

The next episode which can be distinguished in what we have baptized the Minoan-Mycenaean transitional period (c. 1450–1350 BC), is characterized by the renewed prominence of Arzawa under its king Tarhundaradus. This king corresponded with the Egyptian pharaoh Amenhotep III (1391–1353 BC) about the marriage of his daughter to the latter. In this correspondence, recovered at Tell El-Amarna, it is stipulated that the land of Hatti is

Arnuwandas I (KUB XXIII 14) is likely to be considered a historical reflection.

⁴⁹³ Mellink 1995, 5-6.

⁴⁹⁴ Götze 1968, *passim*; cf. Heinhold-Krahmer 1977, 260-261.

⁴⁹⁵ For the correlation of archaeological phases and absolute chronology, see Warren/Hankey 1989 and page 12; note however that the lowering of the dates of Amenhotep III and Akhenaten has its repercussions for the date of the transition from LM III A1 to LM III A2, which should likewise be lowered from c. 1370 BC to c. 1350 BC.

⁴⁹⁶ Woudhuizen 1992a, 66-77; according to Wachsmann 1987, 43, what appear to be codpieces, in reality are broad belts depicted en face. I do not accept Wachsmann's (1987, 33-37) reversed dating of the tombs of Rekhmare and Menkheperreseneb.

⁴⁹⁷ KUB XXIII 21.

“zersplittert”.⁴⁹⁸ The latter situation is plausibly connected with the historical preamble to a decree of Hattusilis III (1264–1239 BC), according to which before the reign of Suppiluliumas I (1350–1322 BC) the realm of Arzawa reached to Uda and Tuwanuwa, which means to the territory south of the Halys river deep into the ancestral Hatti lands.⁴⁹⁹ Furthermore, the Egyptian pharaoh requests Tarhundaradus to send Kaskans, a people situated to the north of the Hittite capital Boğazköy-Hattusa, but at the time even occupying Nenassa south of the Halys bow. The marriage of Amenhotep III with a daughter of Tarhundaradus was part of a grander political scheme, namely to curb Hittite power both in the East and the West. Another part of this scheme was formed by the political support rendered to the Mycenaean Greeks. As argued by Eric Cline, this support is emanating from the discovery of scarabs and faience plaques of Amenhotep III and his wife Tiye in the Aegean region, a concentration of which was found in the capital Mycenae itself. Moreover, there is a remarkable correspondence between the findspots of these Egyptian imports and the places mentioned in the list of Aegean place-names on a statue base found at Kom el-Hetan (Thebes), which, though starting and ending in Crete, likewise attributes a central position to the Greek mainland, if not actually to Mycenae itself. Interestingly, the distribution of the Egyptian imports, plausibly suggested to reflect political support, includes western Asia Minor, as a scarab of Amenhotep III has been discovered at Panaztepe in the Hermos valley, which conceivably belonged to the realm of Tarhundaradus.⁵⁰⁰ The rationale behind lending political support to both Tarhundaradus and the Mycenaean Greeks in a containment policy of the Hittites may perhaps be provided by the information from the Disc of Phaistos. Here Great King Tarhundaradus is staged as the overlord of the Mycenaeans in Crete⁵⁰¹ under leadership of king Nestor from Pylos in mainland Greece⁵⁰² – the latter no doubt also a vassal of the king of Mycenae. Hence, the political destinies of Great King Tarhundaradus of Arzawa and the Mycenaean Greeks are intricately linked up with each other. An interesting detail in this connection is that, with the mention of “Assuwian Phaistos”, Tarhundaradus refers back to the Assuwian League of his predecessor of about a generation ago in order to legitimize his claim on Crete.

The Minoan-Mycenaean transitional period as discussed here in its three

⁴⁹⁸ EA 31-32, see Mercer 1939.

⁴⁹⁹ KBo VI 28; cf. Bryce 1989, 308, note 46.

⁵⁰⁰ Cline 1987, *passim*; Cline 2001, *passim*.

⁵⁰¹ It is interesting to note in this connection that a representative of the *Keftiu* (= Cretans) is depicted in the tomb of an Egyptian high official from the reign of Amenhotep III with *Anatolian* type of shoes with upturned toes, see Wachsmann 1987, 40, Pl. L, A.

⁵⁰² On the relation of Pylos with Crete, see Hiller 1996, 81-82 with reference to tablet fragments in Knossian scribal tradition from the old palace at Pylos and the mention in the Pylos tablets of the Cretan towns *aminiso* “Amnisos” (PY An 943) and *kotuwe* “Gortys (dative)” (PY An 233, etc.).

distinct phases, ends with the conquest of Crete and the islands in the Aegean by the Greeks from Mycenae (as opposed to the former presence of Greeks from Pylos), as reflected in the archaeological record by megaron-houses at Phaistos and Gournia in Crete and Phylakopi in Melos and the introduction of the Mycenaean *koine* in pottery from Late Helladic (LH) IIIA2 (start *c.* 1350 BC) onwards. No doubt, in the background of this political shift lurks the downfall of the kingdom of Arzawa, which after Tarhundaradus loses much terrain to the Hittites under the excellent leadership of Suppiluliumas I.

EGYPT	HATTI	ARZAWA	AEGEAN
Tuthmoses III 1479–1425 BC	Tudhaliyas I 1465–1440 BC		LM II/LH IIB (post Santorini eruption, <i>c.</i> 1450 BC)
	Tudhaliyas II 1425–1390 BC	Piyamakuruntas (Assuwian League)	
Amenhotep III 1391–1353 BC	Arnuwandas I 1390–1370 BC	Kupantakuruntas (Madduwattas)	LM/LH IIIA1 (Attarisiyas)
	Tudhaliyas III 1370–1350 BC	Tarhundaradus	(Assuwian Phaistos, Nestor)
Akhenaten 1353–1337 BC	Suppiluliumas I 1350–1322 BC	Uhhazitis	LM/LH IIIA2-B

Table 2: Synchronisms between Egypt, Hatti, Arzawa, and the Aegean.

Notes to Table 2:

(1) There is a correlation between Tuthmoses III and LM IB pottery, but the transition to LM II occurred during the reign of this pharaoh, as suggested by the replacement of Minoan kilts with codpieces (or broad belts depicted en face) by Mycenaean ones without codpieces in the wall-paintings of the tomb of Rekhmare.

(2) The distinction between Tudhaliyas I and Tudhaliyas II is now proven by Freu,⁵⁰³ whose correction of the dates for the Hittite Great Kings in question, as compared to Gurney,⁵⁰⁴ is adhered to.

(3) The synchronism between Tudhaliyas III and Tarhundaradus is now reinforced by texts from Sapinuwa/Ortaköy.⁵⁰⁵

⁵⁰³ Freu 2007, 311.

⁵⁰⁴ Gurney 1990, 181.

⁵⁰⁵ Yakubovich 2010, 88–89. Note that his Tudhaliyas II actually is Tudhaliyas III.

(4) The synchronism between Suppiluliumas I and Uhhazitis is based on KUB XIV 16 rev. III 26-27, according to which the latter received the town of Puranda from the former.

Additional note: ⁵⁰⁶

There is a substantial number of cylinder seals found in Thebes, of which one, according to Porada, is singled out from the rest for its definite Anatolian origin.⁵⁰⁷ Like two other Cyprian seals this one originally had been gold covered – presumably they had been encased in a gold container in order to be actually worn – and, like another Cyprian seal, it is inscribed with Luwian hieroglyphic signs. The seal is decorated with a scene of four deities, which could be identified as the tutelary deity Kuruntas, the sun-god Tiwatas, the storm-god Tarhunt and the goddess Kubaba or Ishtar.



Fig. 38. An imprint of the Luwian hieroglyphic cylinder seal from Thebes (Porada, 1981-82).

At the front of the deities we see Luwian hieroglyphic signs and a small seated figure with a lance in his hand, which, according to Porada, are added later by probably another artist. As pointed out elsewhere,⁵⁰⁸ these signs represent titles and names of individuals, who are thus protected by the deities. And as the importance of the successive deities will diminish, so will that of the individuals. While the first deity represents the entire community, the sun-god, because he is topped by the winged-sun disc, could only be associated with (an) Anatolian – or, more specific, Luwian – Great King(s), leading us to the conclusion that we are dealing here with (a) ruler(s) of Assuwa or Arzawa, the latter in a later period known to have been headed by Great King Tarhundaradus. The seated figure associated with the storm-god is

⁵⁰⁶ The content of this note is elaborated extensively in Woudhuizen 2009, 204-216.

⁵⁰⁷ Lambrou-Phillipson 1990, no. 350; Porada 1981-82, 47, nos 25 and 68-77.

⁵⁰⁸ See note 506.

none other than the king of Thebes, in view of the fact that the seal once had been encased in gold. This leads us to the assumption that the king of Thebes was a vassal of the Luwian Great King(s), mentioned in association with the sun-god, which means the ruler(s) of Assuwa, or Arzawa before its conquest by the Hittites.

According to the new reading by Starke of a Hittite letter (KUB XXVI 91), Aegean islands were received in loan by Kadmos, a namesake of the founding father of Thebes, from the king of Assuwa at the event of the betrothal of his daughter to that king. The sender of this letter, the great grandson of this Kadmos, is likely to be identified as Tawagalawas or Eteokles. Our reconstruction is that the cylinder seal was handed over from the Great King to Kadmos in order to facilitate the administration of the islands by Wastizitis – written in front of the goddess –, the henchman of the Great King.

Thus, the vassalage of the King of Thebes to the Great King of Assuwa as recorded by the combined evidence of the Hittite letter and the cylinder seal, while this Theban king no doubt was at the same time a vassal king of the Achaian Great King, seated in Mycenae, reflects exactly the political situation in Crete, where according to the Disc of Phaistos, king Nestor of Pylos, a vassal of his Mycenaean overlord, had territories in Crete in loan from Great King Tarhundaradus of Arzawa.

Appendix I

AN ALTERNATIVE INTERPRETATION OF THE TEXT

Kees Enzler

I.1 *Introduction*

The difference in the interpretation of some parts of the text is explained with the help of its division in 10 main items, followed by a translation based upon this analysis. Besides some minor differences, the deviation mainly concerns segments A 10 and A 11. Furthermore, this affects segments B 1 and B 18 - B 30. Based on the alternative translation, structures in the text are subsequently examined and an attempt is made to place the content in a political and historical context.

I.2 *Main Division of the Text*

Side A

- | | |
|----------------|---|
| 1. A 1 - A 2 | Place of residence of the sender or the addressee |
| 2. A 3 - A 5 | Name of the addressee of the original letter |
| 3. A 6 - A 11 | Subject of this letter, namely: |
| A 6 - A 7 | identifying the properties of Nestor: |
| a. A 8 - A 9 | in the territory of Lasithi |
| b. A 10 | in the territory of Mesara under his own management |
| c. A 11 | in the territory of Mesara through his vassal-kings |
| 4. A 12 - A 13 | Benediction |
| 5. A 14 - A 25 | Elaboration on subject 3a |
| 6. A 26 - A 31 | Elaboration on subject 3b |

Side B

- | | |
|-----------------|--|
| 7. B 1 - B 2 | Reminder of subject 3c (A 11) coming up now |
| 8. B 3 - B 4 | Benediction |
| 9. B 5 - B 17 | Elaboration on subject 3c |
| 10. B 18 - B 30 | Determination of rightful ownership of Rhytion, which issue is the main reason for drafting the letter |

I.3 Translation of the Text Starting from the Main Division in Items 1-10

Side A

1. A 1 In the Mesara is
A 2 Phaistos.⁵⁰⁹
2. A 3 : To Nestor,
A 4 : to the great (man)
A 5 in Achaia.
3. A 6 What Nestor (has),
A 7 what you (have) under [you]
 - a. A 8 in my (territory)
A 9 the Lasithi,
 - b. A 10 in (that is) yours⁵¹⁰ and
 - c. A 11 of your vassal-kings.⁵¹¹
4. A 12 In (= To) you bring
A 13 Tarhunt and His Majesty hail.
5. A 14 : Knossos (is) yours.
A 15 (It is) part of the oath-bound kingship
A 16 in the Lasithi,
A 17 in whatever (territory) where a team of oxen ploughs
A 18 for (= on behalf of) the town (= Knossos)
A 19 in the Lasithi.⁵¹²
A 20 : Knossos (is) yours.
A 21 (It is) part of the oath-bound kingship
A 22 in the Lasithi,
A 23 in which the territory (is) yours, which
A 24 (is) part of my dominion
A 25 the Lasithi.

⁵⁰⁹ This implies that Phaistos could be the residence of the sender or the residence of the addressee. In both cases the disc would be a copy of the original and therefore the original – the letter to Nestor – actually begins with the introductory particle *u* (A 3). Further elaboration on this can be found in the political historical paragraph I.5 of this Appendix.

⁵¹⁰ With “(that is) yours” is meant: in private property of Nestor (crown-land).

⁵¹¹ This must be vassal-kings (plural) and points forward to the vassal-kings who will be mentioned on side B; here *ti₃-ya-sa₂* is seen as the genitive plural of the possessive pronoun of the 2nd person singular (see also Woudhuizen, note 468).

⁵¹² Meaning that both Knossos and the agricultural land used for the support of the town (ploughland), belong to the territory of oath. The same applies to Scheria, further on in the text (A 28 - A 29). (See for the connection town – ploughland for Scheria also: Homer, *Odyssey* VI, 8-10).

6. A 26 In the Mesara (is)
 A 27 yours and for you
 A 28 Scheria,⁵¹³
 A 29 in whatever (territory) where a team of oxen ploughs
 A 30 (in) the Mesara
 A 31 (on behalf of) Scheria.⁵¹⁴

Side B

7. B 1 In (the territory) of those⁵¹⁵
 B 2 what Nestor (has).

 8. B 3 Haddu brings you
 B 4 life.⁵¹⁶

 9. B 5 “Phaistos”⁵¹⁷
 B 6 is part of your oath-bound (territory)
 B 7 and the Mesara.⁵¹⁸

⁵¹³ Scheria is probably one of the ports of Phaistos: Hagia Triada (Woudhuizen 1992a, 32-33).

⁵¹⁴ *UTNA* “territory” is meant to indicate Knossos and the ploughland around it. The sender, the Great King of Arzawa, explains how the territory of the oath-bound kingship (A 23), which comprises Knossos and the surrounding territory cultivated on its behalf (A 14 en A 17), merely forms a part of his Lasithi dominion. Here he still considers himself the big boss (feudal lord), in contrast with the following in A 26 - A 31, where there is no mention of “oath-bound” or “my dominion”. The Great King recognizes this as Nestor’s crown-domain (private property), which becomes apparent in A 27 - A 28: Scheria is yours *and* for you (privately). A 30 and A 31 are parallel to respectively A 19 and A 18.

⁵¹⁵ Following the main division of the text as indicated earlier, side B begins in B 1 - B 2 with a reminder of topic 3c on side A yet to be handled: Nestor’s properties in the Mesara territory through his vassal-kings (A 11). *a-tu i-ya-sa₂ ku na-sa₂-ta* is therefore translated as: “in (the territory) of those (namely of those vassal-kings mentioned before in A 11), what Nestor (has)”. The thought that B 1 - B 2 must be closely related to side A, is reinforced by the use of *a-tu*: it is the only appearance of this word on side B.

⁵¹⁶ With the mention of Tarhunt on side A and Haddu on side B, we can see something that seems to be a returning phenomenon for the Hittites. They call upon gods as witnesses and protectors of a treaty between a king and a vassal, mostly calling upon gods of both parties (Gurney 1990, 61). Tarhunt was the god of the Great King of Arzawa, Haddu was an important god in Scheria (= Hagia Triada), Nestor’s crown-domain; here, a building has been found consisting of three rooms, which was used as a temple for – amongst others – Haddu (Best 1994, 37).

⁵¹⁷ *wa* is an introductory particle that marks direct speech, meaning that from B 5 till B 30 the originally dictated text was reproduced literally and hence must stand between quotation-marks. The part of the text we are dealing with is obviously an important one.

⁵¹⁸ With “the Mesara” (B 7) must be meant *that* part of the Mesara besides Scheria and Phaistos that belongs to Nestor, namely *u-pa pa-ya-ta* “(the territory) behind Phaistos” east of Phaistos, on which further elaboration will follow in B 13. Otherwise it would be in opposition with A 26 - A 28. As a matter of fact, if one takes *mi₁-SARU* (partly logogram) as

- B 8 Governor of the Mesara [is]
 B 9 Idomeneus.⁵¹⁹
 B 10 Of Phaistos,⁵²⁰
 B 11 the Assuwian (town),⁵²¹
 B 12 Kuneus (is) vassal-king;
 B 13 (of the territory) behind Phaistos,⁵²²
 B 14 (so) part of (your) oath-bound territory,⁵²³
 B 15 Uwas (is) vassal-king
 B 16 and for (= in service of) my father
 B 17 Acharkis (was) vassal-king (there).
10. B 18 (The territory) that is yours <pl.> under you
 B 19 : under me
 B 20 : (under) Nestor,
 B 21 this (territory) of yours <pl.> under you (= *u-pa pa-ya₁-ta*)
 B 22 to which Rhytion

a partitive genitive, one can indeed read: “Phaistos is part of the oath-bound territory, and a part of the Mesara, namely *u-pa pa-ya-ta*, is (as well)”. On the other hand, if one would assume that after *wa* this text was literally cited from the original letter (see note 517), one could state that the Luwian Great King/feudal lord considers the Mesara in its entirety, including Scheria (= Hagia Triada), as oath-bound territory, even though Kuneus – who resides there – already knows better: “Scheria is yours *and* for you (= Nestor) privately” (A 27 - A 28).

⁵¹⁹ Idomeneus governs all of Nestor’s properties in the Mesara, *i.e.* both Scheria (private domain) and Phaistos, as well as the territory behind Phaistos (oath-bound properties).

⁵²⁰ ŠA is an Akkadian preposition followed by a genitive or $\emptyset$ with the sense: “of” or “of (it)” (substantively), which is used for additional emphasis. The fact that the scribe has *sa₂* in B 10 followed by an undeclined form and in B 24 by a dative, and further uses *sa₂* either as a preposition (in B 8, B 10, B 24 and B 25) or as a postposition (in B 27 and B 28), may indicate he was both unaware of which case should follow the Akkadian loan-element ŠA, as well as of its general application. Another possibility is, that the use of *sa₂* as preposition and postposition was intended: it creates a figure of style known as chiasma. Apart from that, ŠA – in Hittite Cuneiform – is also followed by various cases (Friedrich 1960, 342), as well as in Luwian Cuneiform (Otten 1953, 115).

⁵²¹ “The Assuwian Phaistos” indicates that Phaistos was once a member of the Assuwian League, consisting of approximately 22 Luwian states, which was defeated by the Hittites in the late 15th century BC (elaboration in paragraph I.5 below).

⁵²² B 10 - B 17 is in essence one sentence consisting of two parts, B 10 - B 12 and B 13 - B 17. The *sa₂* before *pa-ya-ta* (B 10) therefore also effects *u-pa pa-ya₁-ta* (B 13).

⁵²³ In *u-pa pa-ya₁-ta* ^{LI}*UTNA-sa* (B 13 - B 14), ^{LI}*UTNA-sa* “part of (your) oath-bound territory” is in reference with ^{LI}*ti₁-sa as+ti mi₁-SARU-ha-wa* “and the Mesara (= *u-pa pa-ya₁-ta*) ” in B 6 - B 7 (is part of your oath-bound territory as well) (see also note 518). Therefore with respect to ^{LI}*UTNA-sa* in B 14 the *ti₁-sa* of B 6 is omitted: the territory in question has been identified (Woudhuizen 1992a, 40-41; former **regio** = *UTNA*). The sender of the letter once again indicates here that *u-pa pa-ya₁-ta* is part of the oath-bound territory because this is also where the disputed Rhytion is situated, and he especially wants to clarify his authority here.

- B 23 used to belong⁵²⁴
 B 24 (is therefore) Nestor's,
 B 25 *that* (is) yours.
 B 26 This (territory) of yours <pl.> under you
 B 27 (was) of the man
 B 28 (in service) of my father,⁵²⁵
 B 29 (therefore): Rhytion
 B 30 (is) for Nestor".

I.4 Structures in the Text

In some cases, a crosswise return of two different text elements (= chiasma) can be observed. Examples of this can be found in segments A 14 - A 19 and A 26 - A 31. These in outline similar text-segments, display the sequence: town (Knossos) and territory (Lasithi) (A 14 and A 16) and the following in reversed sequence: territory (Mesara) and town (Scheria) (A 26 and A 28). The same also occurs in A 18 and A 19: town (*wa-ti*₁ = Knossos) and territory (Lasithi) versus A 30 and A 31: territory (Mesara) and town (Scheria). Side B also displays this phenomenon in segments B 5 - B 7 and B 8 - B 12 where B 5: town (Phaistos) and B 7: territory (Mesara) are in contrast with B 8: territory (Mesara) and B 10: town (Phaistos). The use of *sa*₂ as preposition in B 24 - B 25 and as postposition in B 26 - B 28 is possibly relevant in this context as well.

Furthermore, on both side A and side B of the disc, two partly identical sentences can be found. On side A it concerns segments A 14 - A 19 and A 20 - A 25; on side B, segments B 21 - B 25 and B 26 - B 28. The sender of the letter is probably doing this to emphasize that these passages are important to him. On side A he wants to clarify that the territory of Nestor is only part of his territory the Lasithi; on side B he elaborates on why the answer to the crucial question with regard to the control of Rhytion, turns out positively for Nestor. In both cases he (viz. the Great King of Arzawa) simultaneously clarifies that he holds the first claim on the territories in question.

⁵²⁴ Here, *sa*₂ is part of the verb (iterative) *sa*₂-*sa-ta*, for *sa*₂ and *sa-ta* are placed together in one segment.

⁵²⁵ In B 21 and B 26 "(territory) of yours <pl.> (= *u-wi-sa*₂)" refers to Nestor and Uwas as proprietors of the territory behind Phaistos in which Rhytion is situated. They are the two parties directly concerned with answering the question of who owns Rhytion. The fact that it concerns these two individuals, is further emphasized with the repetition of the remark that the territory once fell under the man of his father (B 26 - B 28), which is in accordance with "for my father Acharkis (was) vassal-king" (B 16 - B 17). Therefore, both remarks must have a bearing on the territory behind Phaistos and, thus, on Nestor and Uwas (see also Woudhuizen 1992a, 41).

A combination of repetition and chiasma model the segments B 13 - B 17 and B 26 - B 28, in which “this (territory)” (B 26) refers back to “*u-pa pa-ya₁-ta*” (B 13) and “of the man (in service) of my father” (B 27 - B 28) to “for (= in service of) my father Acharkis (was) vassal-king (there)” (B 16 - B 17). At the same time, these last segments form a chiasma: man – father versus father – man (Acharkis).

As far as the geographical division is concerned, side A displays a sequence from north to south, from the Lasithi (Knossos) to the Mesara (Scheria), whereas side B runs from west to east in the Mesara (Phaistos – the hinterland of Phaistos – Rhytion). Or, if one prefers to see side A and side B as continuous, the geographical sequence in the Mesara runs from west to east: Scheria – Phaistos – hinterland of Phaistos – Rhytion.⁵²⁶ Similar enumerations in a geographical order also appear in the Linear B tablets, among others on those from Knossos.⁵²⁷

Another conspicuous phenomenon is the frequent use of the preposition *a-tu* (D 02 - D 12), which can be found 12 times on side A and once on side B, and that of the pre- and postposition *sa₂* (D 07), which can be found 7 times on side B alone. As a rule, *a-tu* is – directly or indirectly – followed by a geographical notion, *sa₂* is sometimes followed or preceded by a geographical notion and then again, sometimes by a personal indication. Then again, in B 23 *sa₂* is part of the possible iterative *sa₂-sa-ta*, since *sa₂* and *sa-ta* are placed together in one and the same segment. As for the contents of the letter, in the part in which *a-tu* plays the leading role, it concerns territories where the proprietary relations had been fixed for some time, while in the part in which *sa₂* plays the leading role, we are dealing with territories where this is not yet the case. This corresponds with the idea of Woudhuizen that the intent of the part with *sa₂* is a literal citation, as would become apparent in the beginning of this section (from B 25 onwards) which is marked by the Luwian introductory particle of direct speech (*wa*). As it seems, we are dealing with a direct citation from a letter in Luwian Cuneiform, originating from Southwest Anatolia.⁵²⁸ This literal citation indicates that the contents of this part of the text is the most crucial one. It is true that side A displays another Luwian introductory particle, *a* (A 14 and A 20), but this is to introduce a more freely handled part of the text, which is translated in the local Cretan dialect. The third introductory particle, *u*, which also occurs in the citation part, merely functions as a semicolon or a colon (in A 3, B 19, B 20 and B 29).

⁵²⁶ Woudhuizen 1992a, 33.

⁵²⁷ Palmer 1965, 145.

⁵²⁸ Woudhuizen 1992a, 31-32.

1.5 *The Text and the Political Situation in Crete*

The immediate reason for sending the letter is a proprietary dispute about Rhytion with which Uwas has to deal in his own area. Not necessarily an uncommon phenomenon, as appears in a later proprietary dispute about Rhytion, when – in the Classical Period – Gortyn claims this town.⁵²⁹ The text shows that Nestor possesses an oath-bound principality in Crete, which consists of a part of the Lasithi (Knossos and ploughland) and a part of the Mesara (Phaistos and the hinterland of Phaistos), while Scheria (= Hagia Triada) and ploughland make up his crown-land. Idomeneus is his viceroy in the Lasithi, with Knossos as his base, as well as governor of his properties in the Mesara. Under the jurisdiction of Idomeneus are the local vassal-kings Kuneus of Phaistos and Uwas of the land behind Phaistos, which territories – as appears from Linear B tablets – are tributary to Knossos.⁵³⁰ Nestor is therefore in possession of part of the territories Lasithi and Mesara, but not of the whole region. His feudal lord would, as well, still be in possession of parts of these territories, and possibly even other territories in Crete, most likely through local vassal-kings. Uwas' proprietary dispute about Rhytion is with one of these vassal-kings and therefore, he addresses himself to his superior Nestor in Pylos, most likely through Nestor's governor Idomeneus. In his turn, Nestor addresses himself to his feudal lord, with the request to solve the dispute. A local vassal-king like Uwas would not simply address himself to the feudal lord of Nestor, Great Kings were more likely to address themselves only to each other. One could be reminded in this situation of the Hittites, where vassal-kings were also strictly prohibited from maintaining relations with foreign powers.⁵³¹

The feudal lord of Nestor is probably the Great King of the Luwian state Arzawa in West Anatolia, Tarhundaradus. Arzawa consisted of 4 kingdoms, the so called Arzawa Lands, of which the proper Arzawa (Arzawa Minor) was the *primus inter pares*.⁵³² The kings of this state have become the new rulers in the territories and towns in Crete which belonged to the Assuwian League. This confederation of 22 members, was defeated by the Hittite king Tudhaliyas II (c. 1425–1390 BC) and had subsequently fallen apart.⁵³³ The Great Kings of Arzawa see themselves as the heirs of the Assuwian League. Arzawa was possibly already the leading state within the Assuwian League, since it is named after the Asian field near Ephesos (= Hittite Apasa) – the capital of Arzawa. The fact that Arzawa was a powerful force in the first half

⁵²⁹ Best/Woudhuizen 1988, 76.

⁵³⁰ Best 1994, 45.

⁵³¹ Gurney 1990, 60.

⁵³² Bryce 1998, 54-55.

⁵³³ Bryce 1998, 134-136; see for the distinction between Tudhaliyas I and II, Woudhuizen, chapter 8.

of the 14th century BC, due to a temporary backslide in power by the Hittites, becomes apparent from Hittite and Egyptian sources. We can observe Tarhundaradus of Arzawa corresponding with pharaoh Amenhotep III (1391–1353 BC) – the father of Akhenaten (1353–1337 BC) – in the Hittite cuneiform script, as appears in the Amarna Letters (EA 31 and 32)⁵³⁴ (see for the given dates Woudhuizen, chapter 8).

The aforementioned Luwian Great King/feudal lord replies to Nestor and to his solicitor in Crete, the vassal-king of Phaistos, Kuneus, even though by this time he is a vassal of Nestor⁵³⁵. This is because the kings of Phaistos must have held the same function of governor in Phaistos for the Great Kings of Assuwa and Arzawa as later Idomeneus did in Knossos for Nestor. For the rulers of the Assuwian League and Arzawa, Phaistos was the most important town in Crete or in any case the capital of the Mesara territory. This appears from the addition to Phaistos: “the Assuwian (town)” (B 10 - B 11).

The Great Kings would correspond with each other in Akkadian, the *lingua franca* of that time.⁵³⁶ It could, however, in this case, also have taken place in Hittite, since the Hittite Great Kings corresponded in Hittite with the kings of Ahhiyawa, too.⁵³⁷

To Kuneus, the Great King sends a copy of the letter he sent to Nestor, written in either in Hittite as well, or – as would be more plausible – in Luwian, as Luwians amongst each other. This would explain why on side B, the section B 5 - B 30 appears to be quoted literally from the original Luwian cuneiform letter in the Luwian language of Southwest Anatolia.⁵³⁸

Kuneus is herein requested to inform Uwas about the ruling on the proprietary issue concerning Rhytion. Therefore two copies of the incoming letter were made, one for himself and one for Uwas. Since these two vassal-kings are both, in view of their name, of Luwian origin as well as Cretans, the local Cretan dialect of Luwian is applied using the local form of the Luwian hieroglyphic script (= the signs of the disc). This was a regular procedure in these days (see Woudhuizen, chapter 7). The copy intended for the archive of Kuneus, is the Disc of Phaistos. The working-method of the scribe confirms this reasoning, as it points to working according to an example.⁵³⁹ Also with the linguistically related Hittites, clay tablets were used as copies for the palace archives. Just like the disc, these do not bear a royal seal. Original texts can be written on tablets of clay, wood or precious metals (gold, silver,

⁵³⁴ Gurney 1990, 22; Woudhuizen 1992a, 31; see also Kitchen 1989, 37-55.

⁵³⁵ A comparable position is described for Wastizitis, reigning Assuwian islands in the Aegean as solicitor of an Assuwian Great King, being at the same time a vassal of a king of Thebes, probably Kadmos (Woudhuizen 2009, 209). See also chapter 8, last page.

⁵³⁶ Gurney 1990, 104.

⁵³⁷ Bryce 1998, 17.

⁵³⁸ Woudhuizen 1992a, 31.

⁵³⁹ Duhoux 1977, 42.

bronze, iron). These would always bear a royal seal, but most of them unfortunately have been lost.⁵⁴⁰

The fact that both Nestor and Uwas must have received a reply, is confirmed in the proprietary regulation concerning the possession of Rhytion at the end of the text of the disc at B 18, B 21, and B 26, where the word *u-wi-sa₂* is used up to three times in the sense of: “(the territory) of yours <pl.> (= Nestor and Uwas)”. Besides, Nestor would not have been approached in a local Creto-Luwian dialect, but rather in the international language Akkadian or – even more likely – in Hittite.

Apart from that, the first line of the text “in the Mesara is Phaistos” (A 1 - A 2) seems to reinforce the idea that the letter to Uwas was sent from Phaistos, and that the local vassal-king of that town, Kuneus, consequently must have been the sender. However, a totally different situation arises should the first line of the text of the disc “in the Mesara is Phaistos” read that Phaistos is the place of destination, rather than the place of origin. In this case, the disc would be a copy sent to Kuneus for his personal archive, which copy was sent directly from Arzawa to him as the promotor of the interests of the Great King of Arzawa in Crete and – undoubtedly – another copy was sent to Uwas as the party interested concerning Rhytion. Both copies would then have been written in Arzawa in the local Luwian dialect of Crete, which was not unusual, since texts in various languages were found in the archives of the Great Kings and some of their vassals of that time, like in the archives of Boğazköy-Hattusa and Ras Shamra-Ugarit.

The signs of the disc appear to be largely derived from the Luwian hieroglyphic signary of West Anatolia, which in its turn was adopted from the Luwian hieroglyphic signary of East Anatolia, being of Kizzuwatnean (= Cilicia Campestris) and North-Syrian origin.⁵⁴¹ As a matter of fact, the local Luwian script (and dialect) of Crete could very well be a mixture of West- and East-Luwian. The West-Luwian element is represented by the signs D 02 (the Lycian feather decoration) and D 24 (the Lycian house), whereas the East-Luwian element is represented by the sign D 39 (the symbol for the storm-god, which renders the latter in the East-Luwian way: Tarhu [nt]).

So, what image does now emerge of the political situation in Crete at the time of the Disc of Phaistos? Before the arrival of the Achaians, the Luwians seem to have played an important role there and the Cretan towns and territories seem to have been connected with their Assuwian League, in view of the expression “Phaistos, the Assuwian (town)” (B 10 - B 11). They invaded Crete after the position of the Minoans had been weakened by a series of calamities, that followed on the great volcano eruption of Santorini.

⁵⁴⁰ Gurney 1990, 61-62; Bryce 1998, 416-417.

⁵⁴¹ Gurney 1990, 108; former Hieroglyphic Hittite = Luwian Hieroglyphic.

According to recent investigations in Egypt, this occurred *c.* 1450 BC under the reign of Tuthmoses III (1479–1425 BC).⁵⁴² Shortly hereafter, a group of Achaians from Pylos invaded Crete. A part of the Lasithi, with Knossos as its centre, was conquered. For the time being, their leader formally asked the Great King of the Assuwan League to recognize him as a vassal, since the latter still possessed great power in other territories in Crete. This course of events is also attested to in the early 13th century in the *Tawagalawas Letter* (KUB XIV 3), in which Piyamaradus, a rebellious and looting subject of the Hittites, asks, after conquering part of the Lukka Lands (= Lycia),⁵⁴³ seemingly no-mans land between Achiawans and Hittites, the Great King of the Hittites to recognize him as a vassal.

It is, however, also possible that the Achaians from Pylos were hired by the Assuwan League, using Knossos as their base and – in exchange for a vassalage – helping in the defence of Crete in order to prohibit a possible attack by the Hittites, like that on the Anatolian mainland. This was, however, in vain, since the Assuwan League was defeated at the end of the 15th century BC by the Great King of the Hittites, Tudhaliyas II (*c.* 1425–1390 BC), after which the Achaians had to deal with the Luwian kings of Arzawa. The latter did in fact consider themselves, as mentioned before, the heirs of the territories of the Assuwan League and thus of the territories in Crete, too. The defeat of the Assuwan League also must have strengthened the position in Crete of the Achaians from Pylos, as reflected in Egyptian wall-paintings of that time where Cretans are dressed in Mycenaean style.⁵⁴⁴ At the same time Crete had become so important for Pylos, that out of business motives it had been moved from Kakovatos to the south, near the coast at Ano Engliano, with demonstrable Cretan influences in the new style of building. Linear B tablets in Cretan style from *c.* 1400 BC⁵⁴⁵ and later, have also been found here.

When Nestor later became king of Pylos, he continued the policy of his predecessors with Idomeneus as his viceroy. Soon, however, Nestor tried to extend his power in Crete. His first step was to capture Scheria (= Hagia Triada). With the capture of this important seaport, Nestor actually dominated the supply of commodities to Phaistos and the territory behind Phaistos. Therefore, he kept it under his own control. With his grip on Phaistos and the territory behind Phaistos, Nestor more or less forced his vassalage on these territories of the Great King of Arzawa, Tarhundaradus, a ruler contemporaneous with Tudhaliyas III (1370–1350). He still recognized feudal lordship of Tarhundaradus, because Arzawa, due to a temporary backslide in

⁵⁴² Bietak 2000, 194; cf. Kitchen 1989, 37–55.

⁵⁴³ Gurney 1990, 39–41.

⁵⁴⁴ Woudhuizen 1992a, 72, Fig. 23 b–c, and 73.

⁵⁴⁵ Best 1994, 25.

the Hittites' power, was now quickly growing as a power which established contacts with Egypt. Moreover, the Great King was also still strongly present by means of other vassals and/or countrymen. So, the vassals of Nestor in Phaistos and its hinterland, Kuneus and Uwas, would still feel strongly connected with their motherland, merely by their descent. Therefore, it is not surprising that, in the text, Kuneus appears to act as an agent of the Luwian Great King of Arzawa. The text on the disc also clarifies how since the time of the Great King's father, the hinterland of Phaistos had been ruled by a Luwian vassal-king. Consequently, it is understandable that Nestor, by way of precaution, had appointed Idomeneus as their governor. All this took place during the first half of the 14th century BC.

The issue concerning Rhytion reveals the expansive urge of Nestor in an upcoming period. He naturally wants to turn all of his territories in the Lasithi and in the Mesara into a united realm. Earlier sources bear testimony to the expansive urge of the Achaians as well, in the begin of the 14th century BC. So, the Hittites reported that Attarisiyas, who is called "man of Ahhiya (= Achaia)", repeatedly raided in their western borderland.⁵⁴⁶ This Attarisiyas, probably Atreus of Mycenae, embodies the rise to power of Mycenae in the Aegean region, meaning that Nestor of Pylos also must have been a vassal of the king of Mycenae.

Apparently, a similar incident took place in Crete as well. A local vassal-king with land bordering on the territory of Uwas and, thus, between the Lasithi and the Mesara, may have tried to get in the way of Nestor's ambition by claiming Rhytion, whereupon Uwas and Nestor had asked the Great King of Arzawa to settle the matter. According to the most recent theories, this must have taken place shortly before 1350 BC.⁵⁴⁷

If we read between the lines, we can understand, from the text of the disc, how Nestor's actions had gradually put the Luwian feudal lord Tarhundaradus in a delicate situation in Crete. The text pictures a feudal lord who tries desperately to show he is still pulling the strings. Among other things, this becomes apparent by the scribe's use of the lower title *ura* for Nestor. Yet again, by frequently emphasising the oath-bound nature of the territories, he once again displays his weakness. His remarks appear to have a mere formal significance and imply a rearguard action.

Arzawa's role in Crete is definitely finished, when a new group of Achaians from Mycenae invades Crete c. 1350 BC, conquers Knossos only to destroy it and rebuild it again, and then destroys the temples of Scheria (= Hagia Triada).⁵⁴⁸ As a corollary to this, the part that Pylos has played also comes to an end. Some decades later, Arzawa is pacified by the Hittites under Great

⁵⁴⁶ Gurney 1990, 38; Woudhuizen 1992a, 74; Bryce 1998, 140-143.

⁵⁴⁷ Kitchen 1989, 37-55.

⁵⁴⁸ Oral information by Jan Best.

King Suppiluliumas I (1350–1322 BC) and *c.* 1318 BC it is definitely defeated by Mursilis II (1321–1295 BC).⁵⁴⁹

Finally, the allocation of Rhytion to Nestor, and hence in essence to his local viceroy Idomeneus, is confirmed centuries later by Homer. He writes that Idomeneus was the leader of the inhabitants of many towns in Crete, among which Knossos, Gortyn, Phaistos and Rhytion (Homer, *Iliad* II, 645-648) (Note that the loss of time elapsed between the dates of the Disc of Phaistos *c.* 1350 BC and of the Trojan War *c.* 1280 BC, in which Nestor and Idomeneus participate, is probably due to telescoping).

⁵⁴⁹ Gurney 1990, 25-26; Bryce 1998, 210-214.

Appendix II

THE PHAISTOS DISC AND CRETAN LINEAR: IS THERE A CONNECTION?

Fred Woudhuizen

As we have noted earlier, the signary of the Disc of Phaistos (PD) is, notwithstanding its overall relationship with Luwian Hieroglyphic, of a decidedly local Cretan nature. Hence, it comes as no surprise that signs from the disc are paralleled for other inscribed objects from Crete.⁵⁵⁰ Pride of place among these objects goes to the double-axe of Arkalochori (DA, see Fig. 39), which, in a repertoire of 13 individual signs, shows at least five correspondences with the signary of the disc.

	PD	DA	VALUE
1.	02	1	<i>á</i>
2.	03	4	<i>har</i>
3.	19	3	<i>sa₁</i>
4.	22	6	<i>i</i>
5.	46	2	<i>+ti</i>

Next comes the altar-stone from Malia (MA, see Fig. 30),⁵⁵¹ which contains two signs with an equivalent on the disc.

	PD	MA	VALUE
1.	03	2	<i>har</i>
2.	24	9	<i>pa</i>

Both these inscriptions in turn contain signs attested for the repertoire of Cretan Hieroglyphic (CH, see Figs. 40 and 41).⁵⁵² In case of the double-axe of Arkalochori these concern:

⁵⁵⁰ Cf. Best/Woudhuizen 1989, 73-78, with references to the pertinent literature.

⁵⁵¹ I follow the numbering of the editor of the altar-stone, Fernand Chapouthier, even though I believe that the inscription runs from left to right instead of vice versa.

⁵⁵² I follow Olivier/Godart 1996 in their numbering of the Cretan hieroglyphic signs, unless indicated otherwise; numbers preceded by E are from Evans 1909.

	DA	CH	VALUE
1.	9	018	<i>PÁRA</i>
2.	13	031, E 92	<i>nú</i>

With respect to the altar-stone from Malia we can point to the following instances:

	MA	CH	VALUE
1.	3	056	<i>SASA, sa₅</i>
2.	4	070	<i>lu</i>
3.	5	025	<i>te</i>
4.	7	051	<i>ZITI, zi</i>
5.	14	038	<i>ya</i>
6.	15	029	<i>ta</i> ⁵⁵³

Given this situation, it clearly follows that parallels for signs from the Disc of Phaistos can be discovered among the repertoire of Cretan Hieroglyphic as well.⁵⁵⁴

	PD	CH	VALUE
1.	02	001	<i>AMU, á</i>
2.	04	006	<i>hi</i>
3.	12	074-5	<i>tu</i>
4.	14	034	<i>UTNA</i>
5.	15	043	<i>custos</i>
6.	16	E 17	<i>li</i>
7.	18	E 42	<i>sa</i>
8.	25	E 58	<i>na</i>
9.	28	E 77	<i>lí</i>
10.	30	E 67	<i>ma</i>
11.	31	E 80	<i>ra</i>

⁵⁵³ Note that this sign is the forerunner of the Cretan linear syllabic sign with the value *da*.

⁵⁵⁴ Cf. Owens 1997, 59-60.

	PD	CH	VALUE
12.	32	E 79	<i>ti</i> ₅
13.	33	E 59	<i>wa</i>
14.	45	069	<i>ná</i>
15.	47	050	determinative of a personal name

Now, Cretan Hieroglyphic in its turn is closely affiliated to the Cretan linear scripts (CL, see Fig. 42),⁵⁵⁵ as may be illustrated by the following comparisons:⁵⁵⁶

	CH	CL	VALUE
1.	045	16	<i>ze</i>
2.	070	22	<i>lu</i>
3.	012	27	<i>mu</i>
4.	029	30	<i>da</i>
5.	019	31	<i>sa</i>
6.	038	32	<i>ya</i>
7.	058	34	<i>bu</i>
8.	042	52	<i>a</i>
9.	E 80	53	<i>ra</i>
10.	092	55	<i>ru</i>
11.	021	56	<i>pi</i>
12.	069	58	<i>ra</i> ₂
13.	024	60	<i>ni</i>
14.	041	75	<i>wa</i>
15.	*156	82	<i>WAINU</i> , <i>wa</i>
16.	046	88	<i>tī</i>
17.	074-5	91	<i>qe</i>

⁵⁵⁵ For the numbering of the Cretan linear signs, see Meijer 1982, 38-47.

⁵⁵⁶ Cf. Ventris/Chadwick 1973, 33, Fig. 6; Woudhuizen 1992b, Pl. XXIV, Fig. 2; Olivier/Godart 1996, 19.

	CH	CL	VALUE
18.	025	92	<i>te</i>
19.	E 74	95	<i>ma</i>
20.	005	101	<i>zi?</i>

Stipulated for the altar-stone from Malia this same category of evidence entails the following cases:

	MA	CL	VALUE
1.	4	22	<i>lu</i>
2.	5	92	<i>te</i>
3.	6	78	<i>ti</i>
4.	14	32	<i>ya</i>
5.	15	30	<i>da</i>

Against this background, one might be tempted to look for correspondences between the Cretan linear syllabaries and that of the Phaistos Disc – a line of approach initiated by Benjamin Schwarz soon after the decipherment of Linear B and further explored by, amongst others, Werner Nahm, Ottomar Neuss and Gareth Owens.⁵⁵⁷ This approach leads to the following epigraphically sound correlations:

	PD	VALUE	CL	VALUE
1.	12	<i>tu</i>	91	<i>qe</i>
2.	31	<i>ra</i>	98	<i>ku</i>
3.	43	<i>as</i>	86	<i>ta₂</i>
4.	45	<i>ná</i>	58	<i>ra₂</i>

The problem with unravelling the text of the Phaistos Disc on the basis of related signs in the Cretan linear scripts is immediately clear from the last given table: the values of what seem to be epigraphically related signs do not necessarily match! Apparently, the relationship between the Cretan linear scripts and Cretan Hieroglyphic is of a complicated nature: signs which are still recognized by the scribes as to what meaning they convey, may receive a

⁵⁵⁷ Schwartz 1959; Nahm 1975; Neuss 1986-87; 1988-89; 1992-93; Owens 1997, 59-60.

value acrophonically derived from the word for that specific notion *in their own language*. Furthermore, one would like to see the values of the signs backed up by internal evidence. For instance, on the analogy of Linear B one would expect the counterpart of CL 91 *qe* to function as an enclitic conjunction, which is pertinently not the case: PD 12 figures in doublets and triplets indicative of case-endings. These examples may suffice to show that the attempt to read the text of the Disc of Phaistos according to Linear B values (and thus also Linear A values) is in fact a futile one.⁵⁵⁸

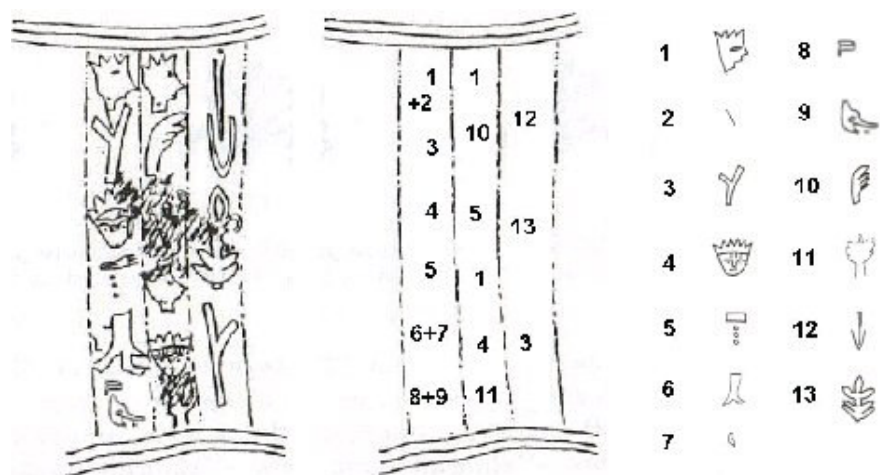


Fig. 39. The inscription of the double-axe of Arkalochori after Bouphidis 1958, adapted according to Best/Woudhuizen 1989, with at the right the numbering of the signs.

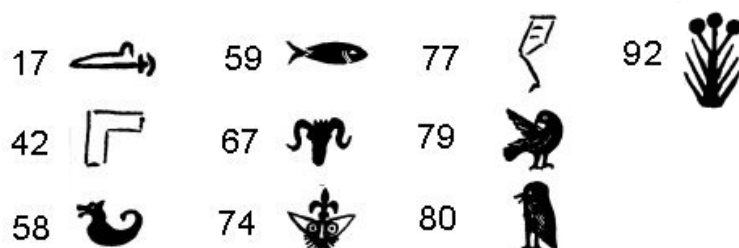


Fig. 40. Cretan hieroglyphic signs according to Evans 1909.

⁵⁵⁸ The relationship between the script of the Disc of Phaistos, Cretan Hieroglyphic and Linear A is further worked out in Woudhuizen 2006 and 2009.

001		031		051	
005		034		056	
006		038		058	
012		040		069	
018		041		070	
019		042		074	
021		043		075	
024		045		092	
025		046		*156	
029		050			

Fig. 41. Cretan hieroglyphic signs according to Olivier/Godart 1996.

16		53		86	
22		55		88	
27		56		91	
30		58		92	
31		60		95	
32		75		98	
34		78		101	
52		82			

Fig. 42. Cretan linear signs according to Meijer 1982.

Appendix III

THE DISC OF VLADIKAVKAZ

Winfried Achterberg & Jan Best

In 1992 the Disc of Vladikavkaz (VD) was found in the basement of a house in Vladikavkaz (North Ossetia, Caucasus), which was built at the end of the 19th century AD. The origin of the disc is unknown, but it must have been placed in that basement between 1880 and 1992.



Fig. 43. The Disc of Vladikavkaz, scale 2:1 (Kouznetsov, 2001).

In the present state it concerns a sherd of a round disc, made of clay; the disc itself would have had a diameter of approximately 10 cm. It seems to have been made rather sloppily: the shape is more oval than round. The thickness varies from well over 1 cm in the centre towards 0,5 cm at the outside. The

sherd measures about 5 x 5 cm. The planes of fracture do not indicate a recent fracture.

On one side the sherd contains the same inscriptions as the Disc of Phaistos (PD), be it that the signs are drawn by hand and have not been stamped as on the PD. The PD has signs on both sides, whereas the VD is blank at the other side. Furthermore the PD is slightly bigger: its diameter is about 16 cm. The VD was in the Museum of the Republic of North Ossetia, but seems to be in private hands today.⁵⁵⁹

The VD seems to contain the text of side A of the PD: on the sherd we may discern the segments A 1 - A 2 - A 3 on the outer spiral, the segments A 24 and A 14 on the second one, the segments A 21(?) - A 22 - A 23 on the third one and segment A 28 on the fourth spiral. On the picture, the first sign of segment A 1 is only partly visible. Of segment A 14 the first 4 out of 6 signs are present, of segment A 21 only the last but one sign is visible (sign D 01, the walking man) but not the attached last sign (D 46, the oblique stroke). So it could also be another segment ending on sign D 01. Of segment A 23 the first 5 out of 7 signs are present. The partitioning in regard to the number of spiral lines and the number of arc degrees per segment correspond quite well.

However, there are four remarkable differences between the PD and the VD:

1. segment A 24 (we stick to the numbering of the PD) is placed before segment A 14 on the sherd. Considering the shift compared to the PD (as caused by the insertion of segment A 24) in the text of the second and third spirals (but *not* of the fourth one), we may conclude that segment A 24 is positioned between A 13 and A 14, that is: segment A 24 does not appear again between A 23 and A 25.
2. In segment A 14 an extra sign has been placed at the start of the segment. It is a rather small sign and is indistinctly hand-carved. The sign is most likely a smaller version of sign D 12 (the round bread with – on the PD – six holes rendered as dots and a seventh in the centre). On the sherd this sign occurs four times in different sizes and with a varying number of dots (A 1: 7(?) dots with an eighth one in the centre, A 2: 5 dots with a central sixth one, A 22: 6 dots without a central one, A 23: only 2 dots). The new, small sign in A 14 is more or less round and has 2 dots. Considering the ample space there was no need to produce a reduced version of any sign, but the resemblance with D 12 in segment A 23 makes sign D 12 the most probable fit.

It is not unthinkable that the above-cited differences are connected, in other words, that the position of segment A 24 before segment A 14 would have required the extra sign D 12 at the start of A 14.

⁵⁵⁹ Kouznetsov 2001.

3. If the segment before segment A 22 is segment A 21, then it lacks sign D 46 (the oblique stroke) which is attached to D 01 on the PD. If the segment is not A 21 there is another change of order compared to the PD.
4. On the VD, three times two signs are placed above each other instead of in line next to each other as on the PD; in segment A 2 the signs D 40 and D 12, in segment A 22 the signs D 03 and D 12, and in segment A 23 the signs D 02 and D 12. In all cases the – on the PD – last one stands above the first one. In segment A 1, where the combination D 02 - D 12 also occurs, the signs do stand in line next to each other.

On the VD, in segment A 3 an extra oblique stroke can be discerned below the first sign (D 29, the lion's head). It is possibly attached to the second sign (D 45, water). It is too clearly visible as a stroke to be a scratch from damage. Surprisingly on the PD on almost the same spot, sign D 45 shows an attachment, clearly not being the oblique stroke D 46, but a somewhat thicker stocky line, considered to be a damage. It could be a coincidence, but in our opinion we have a 47th sign on both discs (see Fig. 44).

The Luwian hieroglyphic determinative sign for a person, being a stroke always put in front of the person's name in question, may have been used, because *Nasati* should be understood as being a form of the personal name Nestor, being used for the first time in segment A 3.



(a)



(b)

Fig. 44. Segment A 3 of (a) the Disc of Vladikavkaz and (b) the Disc of Phaistos.

The question arises, whether the VD is authentic or a falsification, whereby we define 'authentic' as made by someone who was familiar with the script and the language on the disc and a 'falsification' as made by someone who was not. The reasons to make a fake disc could vary from fame or wealth to a joke, a genuine disc could be a copy of the original or a preliminary sketch.

The remaining sherd of the VD, with pieces of text strongly reminiscent of those on the PD, would bring neither fame nor wealth to anybody. However, the possibility of a joke – like for instance the Mycenologist Thomas Palaima made with his fake 'historical' inscription on a sword from Troy, which he

reconstructed as *e-ko-to[-ro]* “of Hector”⁵⁶⁰ – can never be excluded. Such a ‘funny’ person may well be versed in ancient scripts and languages. Therefore the authors are very cautious in nevertheless dealing with the VD as authentic in its capacity of a preliminary sketch (for a copy there are too many differences).

On the PD, sign D 31 (the flying bird) occurs five times; in four of these the bird is headed to the right (that is to the reader – a common way to place signs of humans and animals in hieroglyphic scripts), but in segment A 22 it is headed to the left, apparently a mistake. On the VD the same mistake has been made. But one cannot tell whether that mistake has been made by the original scribe or by a swindler.

The presence of the 47th sign both on the PD and the VD, which in the latter case certainly is not a damage spot, but a clear stroke drawn by the scribe on purpose, makes us believe that the VD is authentic.

The differences between the PD and the VD can be explained as follows:

1. The text on the PD is based upon alternations of “I” and “you” and “my” and “your”. After His Majesty, the “I”, has greeted Nestor, the “you” in the segments A 12 - A 13, the sentence follows “: Knossos (is) *yours*” in segment A 14 on the PD, but on the preliminary sketch of the VD comes first segment A 24 of the PD “of *my* signet-ring (dominion)” – and then at the start of the extended A 14 – “*you* (have): Knossos (is) yours”. This introductory statement, however, is here completely out of place as in the segments A 6 - A 8 of the introductory sentence the scribe had already stated “What Nestor (has), what for *you* (is) under [you] in *my* (territory) Lasithi”. Realising this repetition, the scribe has transferred in his definitive version on the PD segment A 24 on the VD from the *start* of the description of Nestor’s possessions in the Lasithi to the *end* of the description (segments A 23 - A 25), where it is functional in the final remark about the Lasithi before the scribe continues with the introductory clause about Nestor’s *private* possession Scheria in the Mesara.
2. It is interesting that on the VD for the first time *tu* “you”⁵⁶¹ is attested as the Luwian form of the nominative of the second person singular next to the already known form of the first person singular (*a)mu* “I”. Once “of *my* signet-ring (dominion)” has been transferred after A 23, there is no need to start segment A 14 with the extra “*you* (have)”.
3. If the segment before segment A 22 is A 21 (as we assume), the scribe has either forgotten to attach the oblique stroke D 46 in segment A 21 to sign D 01 (the walking man) on the VD, or there is a slightly different meaning of this segment on the VD and the PD: without sign D 46 on the VD the expression either is “your sworn king” and including sign D 46 on the PD

⁵⁶⁰ Palaima 1980.

⁵⁶¹ Melchert 1995, 2158: Hieroglyphic Luwian *tu-u* “thee”.

the notion is more abstract: “your sworn kingship” or on the PD the extra *ti* functions as an enclitic pronoun of the second person singular and the now full expression should be interpreted as “the to you by an oath bound king”.

4. The way of placing some signs on the VD no less than three times above each other with the first sign to be read below tends to authenticity, because on the PD in segments A 5 and A 29 the signs D 02 and D 12 are placed above each other in exactly the same way as in the segments A 22 and A 23 of the VD. These ‘monograms’ are only optional abbreviations, which may be used when there is a lack of space, as on the PD there surely is.

In the Linear A and B scripts of Crete, contemporary with the VD and PD, the same practice of writing ‘monograms’ to be read from below to above was *en vogue*. In Linear A one finds *ma* (lower sign) *-ru* (upper sign) “wool” (HT 12.4; 24a.1-5) and the personal name *si* (lower sign) *-se* (upper sign) (HT 42.1; 93a.1-2; 99b.1; 116a.3), in Linear B *a* (lower sign) *-re* (central sign) *-pa* (upper sign) for *aleiphar* “fat”, and *ka* (lower sign) *-po* (upper sign) for *karpoi* “fruits”. In the latter case this writing device only concerns ideograms, not words in a sentence. So writing this kind of ‘monograms’ was common practice among Cretan scribes of three different scripts.

Appendix IV

THE ENCLITIC PERSONAL PRONOUN *-ti*

Lia Rietveld

The dative form of the personal pronoun of the second person singular in LH has been attested as orthotonic *tu* and the enclitic *-ti*. According to Woudhuizen the LH personal pronoun of the second person singular *ti*, is a nominative form.⁵⁶² On the PD, which records Luwian, we have several forms of *ti* functioning as a dative (A 7, A 12, A 27 and B 3). These forms should thus be read as enclitic personal pronoun, because in LH an enclitic personal pronoun needs to be attached to the first word of the sentence or to a conjunction. On the PD, this leads to the following attachments:

To the first word of the sentence: A 7: *ku-ti*₄,⁵⁶³ A 12: *atu-ti*₂, B 3: *adu-ti*₁.

To a conjunction: A 27: *ta+ti*.

The enclitics in *KATA[+ti]* (in A 7; *KATA+ti* in B 18, B 21, B 26), like *KATA-mi*₁ (in B 19),⁵⁶⁴ form a special case. Here it concerns a standard expression, also attested in Hittite.⁵⁶⁵

It is even possible that there is another enclitic dative form *-ti* present on the PD, in an alternative reading of segments A 15 and A 21.

On side A segment 15, which is repeated in A 21, can be interpreted grammatically in another way, with a slightly different meaning.

The word ^L*SARU+ti*, a noun which means “part of the kingship of the oath”, can also be split into two words: ^L*SARU* and *ti*, as follows:

- | | |
|---------------------------------|--|
| 15. ^L <i>SARU+ti</i> | “(There is) an oath-bound king for you” |
| ^L <i>SARU</i> | : noun, undeclined, “oath-bound king”;
^L : abbreviation of the Hittite concept
<i>lingai</i> - “oath”, used as determinative;
<i>SARU</i> : “king” |
| + <i>ti</i> | : enclitic personal pronoun, 2nd person
singular, dative, “you” |

This alternative reading has some implications on the reading of the part of the text which starts with A 14 and ends with A 25:

⁵⁶² Woudhuizen 2005, 96.

⁵⁶³ Here *ti*₄ can also be interpreted as the nominative of the orthotonic personal pronoun of the second person singular. The translation of the sentence is: “what you (have)...”.

⁵⁶⁴ Enclitic personal pronoun of the first person singular, dative.

⁵⁶⁵ See note 413, and chapter 7, remark 2.

- 14-16. “: Knossos (is) yours.
(There is) an oath-bound king for you in Lasithi, ”
- 17-19. “in whatever (territory) where a yoke of two oxen ploughs for the town in Lasithi.”
- 20-22. “: Knossos (is) yours.
(There is) an oath-bound king for you in Lasithi, ”
- 23-25. “in what territory of yours, what (is) part of my dominion, (namely:) Lasithi. ”

The writer of the letter states that Nestor has a king under his oath in the Lasithi, who is – his name is mentioned on side B – Idomeneus. In this interpretation it is clear that the oath concerns Nestor and Idomeneus, Nestor’s representative in Knossos and the Lasithi. This region is owned by the writer of the letter.

The interpretation of ^USARU and -ti as two words instead of one is supported by the same sequence on the Disc of Vladikavkaz (see Appendix III), where A 21 lacks the sign D 46 (the oblique stroke) which, on the Disc of Phaistos, is attached to D 01. The word “kingship of the oath” is therefore not possible here, and it is not unthinkable that this is also the case in A 21 (and A 15) of the Disc of Phaistos.

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In this study, all aspects of the famous Discus of Phaistos, running from its archaeological find-context to its proper place in Aegean history, receive an in-depth treatment. The authors, forming together the Alverna Research Group, believe that the script and language of the discus are basically related to Luwian Hieroglyphic of southern and western Anatolia (= present-day Turkey). Working from this line of approach, they reach the conclusion that it contains a letter, transcribed in the local script of Phaistos, from Great King Tarhundaradus of Arzawa in Anatolia to king Nestor of Pylos in Achaia (= Mycenaean Greece), who had conquered dependencies of the former in the island of Crete. As long as a bilingual text of the Cretan variant of Luwian Hieroglyphic with a better known script and language is lacking, the readings presented here cannot be proved beyond any shade of doubt, but the least that can be said is that they are underpinned from all possible corners of incidence in an astonishing and detailed way thus far unparalleled.



